



Decentralized Crypto World Bank

A Blockchain-Based Lending Platform
with AI-Enhanced Security

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by

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in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree of
B.Sc. in Computer Science

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Declaration

It is hereby declared that

1. The report submitted is our own original work while completing degree at BRAC University.
2. The report does not contain material previously published or written by a third party, except where this is appropriately cited through full and accurate referencing.
3. The report does not contain material which has been accepted, or submitted, for any other degree or diploma at a university or other institution.
4. We have acknowledged all main sources of help.

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Ethics Statement

This project operates exclusively on public blockchain test networks using test tokens with no real monetary value. No real financial transactions, personal banking data, or user financial records are involved at any stage of development or evaluation. Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning (AI/ML) model training and evaluation are **not executed in pre-thesis 1**; they are planned for the final thesis phase after pre-thesis 2, using synthetically generated or publicly available anonymized datasets. The platform prototype does not process Know Your Customer (KYC) or Anti-Money Laundering (AML) data in its current scope, and all wallet addresses used during testing are disposable testnet addresses. We acknowledge the ethical considerations inherent in AI-assisted financial decision-making and have incorporated explainability mechanisms (SHapley Additive exPlanations, or SHAP) to ensure that automated risk assessments remain transparent and auditable by human reviewers. Future phases plan to incorporate a privacy-preserving ZKP-based identity compliance layer in which users prove KYC status without exposing personal data on-chain; the ethical implications of this design will be evaluated in the final thesis.

Abstract

Global development finance relies on multilayered institutional structures to distribute capital across borders and communities, yet these systems often struggle with fragmented transparency, procedural friction, and uneven access to credit. Although decentralized finance has demonstrated that programmable infrastructures can automate lending and enhance auditability, existing models largely employ flat architectures that do not reflect institutional hierarchies or structured governance. As a result, there remains limited exploration of how tiered financial systems might be represented within decentralized environments while preserving oversight and adaptability. Here we present *Crypto World Bank*, a formally specified, planning-phase research prototype that specifies a blockchain-based institutional finance platform coordinating capital allocation across a four-tier hierarchical governance structure on EVM-compatible Layer 2 infrastructure. The primary contribution is a smart-contract hierarchy with a *specified* oracle-mediated risk-analytics pipeline (Random Forest, Isolation Forest, SHAP via Chainlink Functions—training and benchmarking after pre-thesis 2); an optional conversational agent (MCP tool server) provides an alternate UI path while core banking remains form- and wallet-driven. The architecture spans six functional domains—deposit mobilization, credit allocation, payment settlement, risk intermediation, liquidity management, and ancillary financial services. Smart contracts, frontend, and oracle integration are specified in this pre-thesis; implementation and testnet deployment are planned across four phases in the final thesis stage. This hybrid design illustrates how institutional finance and decentralized systems may converge, contributing an open-source, hierarchically governed crypto financial services architecture as a foundation for further research.

Keywords: Blockchain, Decentralized Finance, Institutional DeFi, Hierarchical Lending, Smart Contracts, Oracle-Mediated Risk Analytics, Explainable AI, Group Lending, Multi-Entity Co-Lending, Deposit Mobilization, Reserve Management, Financial Sustainability

Dedication

Dedicated to our families for their unwavering support throughout our academic journey.

Acknowledgment

We would like to express our sincere gratitude to our panel members for their guidance and support throughout this project. We also thank our supervisor, Mr. Annajiat Alim Rasel, Senior Lecturer at the Department of Computer Science and Engineering, BRAC University, for his guidance and support. Finally, we thank the Department of Computer Science and Engineering at BRAC University for providing us with the resources and academic environment to pursue this work.

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List of Formulas

Utilization Rate (U): $U = \frac{L}{L+B}$ (lending utilization; L is lent amount, B is available balance/liquidity)

Collateral Ratio (CR): $CR = \frac{C}{D}$ (collateral-to-debt ratio)

Loan-to-Value (LTV): $LTV = \frac{\text{Loan Amount}}{\text{Collateral Value}}$

APR (simple): $APR = r_{\text{period}} \times N$ (annualized simple rate over N periods)

Compound Interest (Savings): $A = P \left(1 + \frac{r}{n}\right)^{nt}$ (deposit growth; P principal, r annual rate, n compounding frequency)

EMI (Installment Payment): $EMI = \frac{P \cdot r \cdot (1+r)^n}{(1+r)^n - 1}$ (installment for principal P , periodic rate r , n installments)

Health Factor (HF): $HF = \frac{C \times LT}{D}$ (liquidation trigger for *over-collateralized retail loans only*; if $HF < 1.0$ liquidation is triggered, where LT is liquidation threshold; see Section 3.17 for tier-specific HF variants and the group-loan pool-level formulation)

Reserve Ratio (RR): $RR = \frac{\text{Reserves}}{\text{Total Deposits}}$ (solvency constraint enforced at each tier; governs the maximum downward capital that may be allocated, *not* a money-creation parameter)

Platform Solvency Ratio (PSR): $PSR = \frac{\text{TotalReserveBalance}}{\text{TotalOutstandingLoans}}$ (on-chain analogue of capital adequacy, measuring whether the system's reserve cover exceeds outstanding loan obligations; replaces the Basel III CAR formula, which is undefined for this platform because USDC assets have no regulatory risk-weight classification under Basel III and "Tier 1 Capital" in the Basel sense cannot be computed from an on-chain USDC balance alone)

Credit Velocity (CV): $CV = \frac{\text{Capital Recycled per Period}}{\text{Total Reserve}}$ (rate at which reserve capital flows through the lending hierarchy and returns as repayment; replaces the inapplicable fractional-reserve money multiplier, which presupposes new money creation and does not apply to fixed-supply USDC)

FX Conversion: $\text{Amount}_B = \text{Amount}_A \times \left(\frac{P_A}{P_B}\right)$ (oracle-priced conversion between assets A and B)

Group Loan Individual Share: $\text{Share}_i = \frac{\text{LoanTotal}}{N_{\text{members}}}$

On-Chain Credit Score (conceptual): $CS = \sum_i w_i \cdot \text{feature}_i$ (weighted features learned off-chain and stored as a score on-chain)

Isolation Forest Anomaly Score: $s(x, n) = 2^{-\frac{E(h(x))}{c(n)}}$ (anomaly scoring for instance x ; where $h(x)$ is the path length of instance x from the root of an isolation tree and $c(n)$ is the average path length for n samples)

Random Forest Fraud Probability: $P(\text{fraud} \mid x) = \frac{1}{T} \sum_{t=1}^T f_t(x)$ (ensemble average over T trees; where $f_t(x)$ is the binary fraud prediction of the t -th decision tree)

Platform Net Interest Allocation: $\text{NetInterest} = \text{InterestCollected} - \text{DepositorYield} - \text{InsuranceAllocation}$

SHAP (Shapley value): $\phi_i = \sum_{S \subseteq F \setminus \{i\}} \frac{|S|!(|F|-|S|-1)!}{|F|!} [f(S \cup \{i\}) - f(S)]$

List of Abbreviations

AA: Account Abstraction (ERC-4337)

ALM: Asset-Liability Management

AI: Artificial Intelligence

AI/ML: Artificial Intelligence / Machine Learning

AML: Anti-Money Laundering

APR: Annual Percentage Rate

API: Application Programming Interface

BRAC: Bangladesh Rural Advancement Committee

CAR: Capital Adequacy Ratio (Basel III; not directly applicable to this platform — see Platform Solvency Ratio, PSR, in List of Formulas)

CBDC: Central Bank Digital Currency

CCIP: Cross-Chain Interoperability Protocol (Chainlink)

CCS: ACM Computing Classification System

CR: Collateral Ratio

CVL: Certora Verification Language

DeFi: Decentralized Finance

DID: Decentralized Identifier (W3C)

DON: Decentralised Oracle Network (Chainlink)

EIP: Ethereum Improvement Proposal

EIP-7702: Ethereum Improvement Proposal 7702 — Session Key standard enabling scoped, time-bound wallet authorisations for an autonomous agent

EMI: Equated Monthly Installment

ERC: Ethereum Request for Comments (token / interface standard)

EVM: Ethereum Virtual Machine

FL: Federated Learning

FATF: Financial Action Task Force

FX: Foreign Exchange

GNN: Graph Neural Network

HF: Health Factor

KYC: Know Your Customer

LLM: Large Language Model

L2: Layer 2

LTV: Loan-to-Value Ratio

MFI: Microfinance Institution

MiCA: Markets in Crypto-Assets Regulation (EU)

ML: Machine Learning

MCP: Model Context Protocol — tool-calling interface used by the AI agent to interact with CWB banking operations

NIM: Net Interest Margin

PRISMA: Preferred Reporting Items for Systematic Reviews and Meta-Analyses

PoS: Proof of Stake

PoR: Proof of Reserve (Chainlink on-chain reserve verification)

PSR: Platform Solvency Ratio (on-chain capital adequacy analogue; see List of Formulas)

QRC: QR code

RBAC: Role-Based Access Control

RLS: Row-Level Security (PostgreSQL policy feature enforcing append-only access on audit tables)

RR: Reserve Ratio

SAR: Suspicious Activity Report

SBT: Soulbound Token (non-transferable ERC standard)

SHAP: SHapley Additive exPlanations

SOFR: Secured Overnight Financing Rate

SSE: Server-Sent Events

SSI: Self-Sovereign Identity

SoK: Systematization of Knowledge

SWC: Smart Contract Weakness Classification

TVL: Total Value Locked

U: Utilization

UUPS: Universal Upgradeable Proxy Standard (ERC-1822)

VC: Verifiable Credential (W3C)

XAI: Explainable Artificial Intelligence

ZKP: Zero-Knowledge Proof

zkAML: Zero-Knowledge Anti-Money-Laundering proof

zkEVM: Zero-Knowledge Ethereum Virtual Machine — a ZK rollup that inherits Ethereum L1 security via cryptographic validity proofs

zk-SNARK: Zero-Knowledge Succinct Non-Interactive Argument of Knowledge

Chapter 1

Introduction

The Crypto World Bank is a Final Year research prototype demonstrating a blockchain-based institutional finance platform. Where existing DeFi protocols address isolated functions—Aave (lending), Uniswap (exchange), MakerDAO (stablecoins)—this work formally specifies a hierarchically governed platform spanning deposit mobilization, credit allocation, installment repayment, interbank liquidity, FX facilitation, solidarity group lending, syndicated co-lending, reserve enforcement, and risk-based governance across four institutional tiers mirroring real-world development finance. The Tier 1 World Bank Reserve and core lending hierarchy are specified in Solidity; the multi-entity contract suite is fully specified in Chapter 3 and scheduled across Phases II–III.

The system serves three participant categories: a programmable global reserve (Tier 1), national and local development banks (Tiers 2–3), and retail clients (Tier 4) with savings, group loans, and installment lending. Unbanked and MSME financing gaps [9, 15] motivate hierarchical intermediation; this thesis does not claim a specific geographic deployment target. Design artifacts are available in our GitHub repository. Blockchain provides shared-state visibility, tamper-evident audit trails, and programmable rule enforcement among institutions with competing interests—as demonstrated by the World Bank FundsChain programme and JPMorgan Kinexys, which show that open ledger infrastructure and institutional hierarchy are not mutually exclusive.

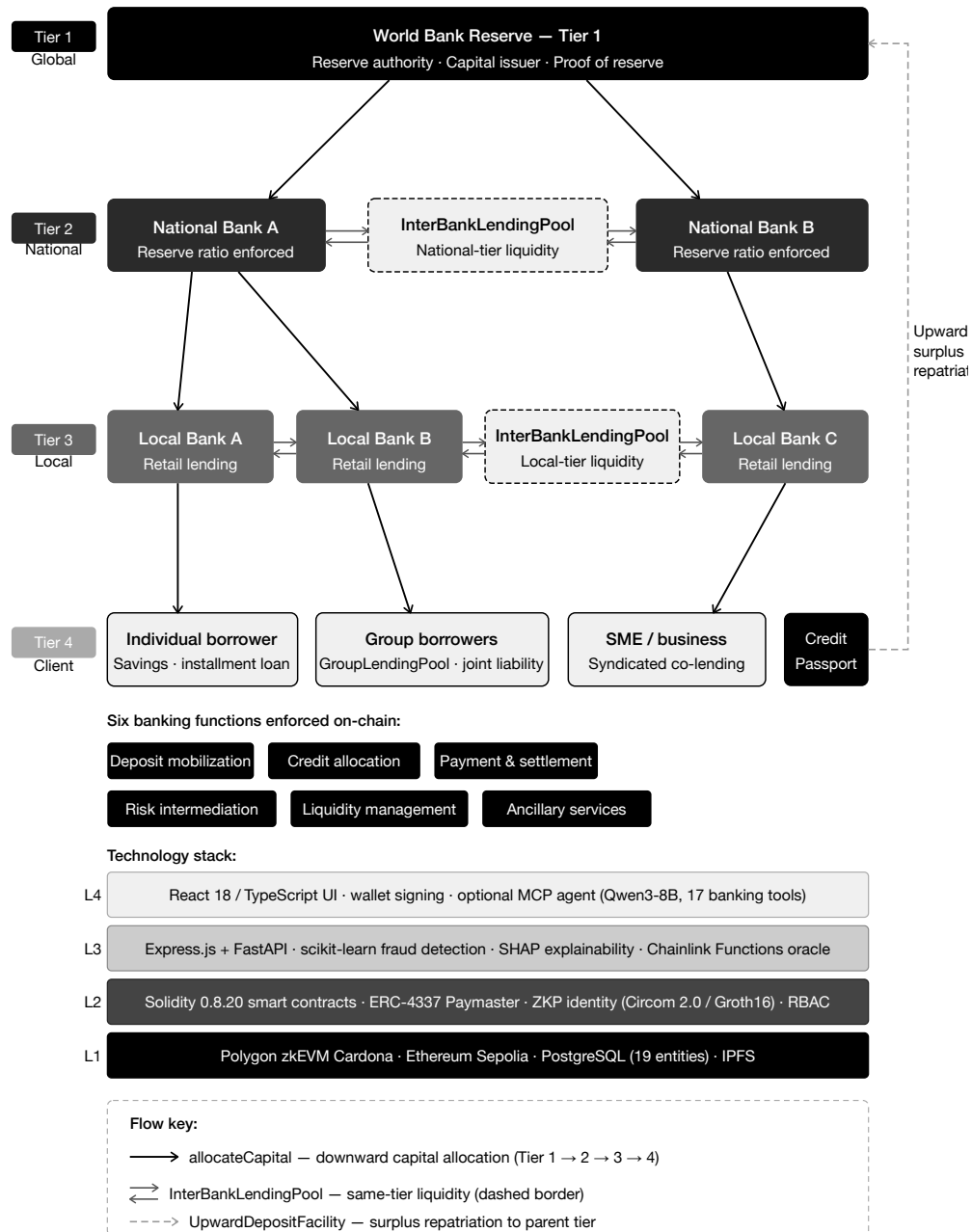


Figure 1.1: Crypto World Bank system overview

1.1 Background

Development finance channels capital through layered institutions—supranational bodies, national intermediaries, and local lenders—but this model carries structural costs. Correspondent banking locks idle capital in pre-funded nostro/vostro accounts [18], settles cross-border payments in two to five days at roughly \$42 per transaction [19], and charges remittance corridors 6.49% on average—above the UN SDG target of 3% [20]. Meanwhile, 1.4 billion adults remain unbanked [9] and MSMEs face a \$4.5 trillion annual financing gap [15].

DeFi has shown that lending, collateral, and interest can be automated transparently on-

chain: Aave v3 holds \$26.3 billion TVL [21] and the broader DeFi lending market exceeds \$55 billion [8] (accessed March 2026). Yet these protocols use flat pool designs that ignore institutional hierarchy, inter-tier capital movement, and the client-via-Local-Bank lending path typical of development finance.

What smart contracts and blockchain provide. **Smart contracts** enforce lending rules as immutable, atomic, trustless, and auditable on-chain logic. **Blockchain** replaces bilateral ledger reconciliation with a single shared record—when a Local Bank disburses a loan, the World Bank Reserve’s reserve ratio updates in the same transaction [19]. **DeFi** extends this to financial services without licensed custodians. The Crypto World Bank adds three dimensions absent from existing protocols: *institutional hierarchy* (four-tier capital flows), *multi-entity operations* (solidarity groups, syndicated loans, tranching pools), and connection to the development-finance framework identified as structurally absent in the literature [1].

Optional conversational interface. Primary interaction is through the React UI and wallet signing. An optional locally hosted agent (Qwen3-8B + MCP, 17 banking tools) provides an alternate path with mandatory human confirmation; it does not gate core banking (Chapter 4).

1.2 Rationale and Motivation

Real development finance depends on layered institutions, yet settlement friction, opaque reserves, and correspondent-banking idle capital leave both intermediaries and unbanked clients underserved [9, 15, 18, 20]. Flat DeFi protocols automate lending at scale but ignore institutional hierarchy, cross-tier flows, and the Local-Bank-to-client path that microfinance and development banks use in practice [1]. This study is motivated by the opportunity to encode that hierarchy on a programmable ledger—with enforced reserves, role-based governance, and auditable capital movement—while supporting (not replacing) human credit judgment through lightweight analytics and an optional conversational interface. The thesis specifies a reusable architecture; it does not claim a particular national deployment target.

1.3 Problem Statement

Three forces motivate this study: development-finance inefficiencies restricting transparency and settlement; absent multi-tier banking functions in DeFi (deposits, solidarity lending); and the opportunity to combine blockchain auditability with lightweight analytics. Development finance routes funds through national and local banks to individual borrowers, creating six structural inefficiencies:

1. **Lack of transparency.** Lower tiers cannot independently verify capital management, reserve levels, or lending decisions above them; reserve adequacy is self-reported and audited at most quarterly.
2. **Sluggish settlements and idle capital.** Cross-border transfers take two to five days, lock capital in pre-funded correspondent accounts [18], and cost roughly \$42 per transaction [19].

3. **Inconsistent risk evaluation.** Fraud and credit assessment rely on human judgment; borrowers are re-evaluated at each tier without a unified verifiable credit history.
4. **Access and trust barriers.** Inter-institutional trust requires expensive legal and audit processes; developing-country investors earn returns roughly three percentage points below developed markets [22].
5. **No programmable savings.** Depositors in developing economies lack real-time visibility into how savings are deployed.
6. **No on-chain group credit.** Borrowers without individual collateral cannot access programmable mutual-liability group lending, despite microfinance precedents (BRAC, Grameen, ASA).

DeFi automates lending transparently at scale—Aave v3 (\$26.3 billion TVL, \$17.7 billion borrows) [21], Compound v3 (\$1.4 billion) [23], MakerDAO/Sky (\$10.5 billion stablecoin issuance) [24]—yet exhibits four limitations for institutional development finance:

- **Flat lending models.** Aave and Compound use risk-parameterized sub-markets but not institutional hierarchy, cross-tier allocation, or role-differentiated governance; CWB models *institutional relationships*, not asset buckets within one pool.
- **No AI risk analytics.** Decisions rely on collateral ratio and utilization curves without behavioral fraud detection or explainable credit support.
- **No tiered governance.** Token-weighted voting lacks the role distinctions (regulator, wholesale lender, retail lender, client) of hierarchical finance.
- **Single-level institutional DeFi.** Maple Finance (\$2.6–3.8 billion TVL) [25] and Goldfinch (\$680 million originations in 18+ countries) [26] lack hierarchical capital flows and interbank facilities.

1.4 Objectives

The objectives of this project are:

1. **Design and specify** a four-tier lending architecture (World Bank → National Bank → Local Bank → Client) on an EVM-compatible blockchain; full testnet deployment is planned for Phases I–IV.
2. **Specify** an extended banking product suite—deposits, savings, and solidarity group lending—on the hierarchical foundation.
3. **Investigate** a lightweight off-chain analytics layer (fraud detection, anomaly detection, explainable review) and an optional MCP-based conversational agent as an alternate UI path.
4. **Specify** programmable lending with borrowing limits, installments, and role-based access control via smart contracts.
5. **Plan** testnet deployment (Polygon zkEVM Cardona, Ethereum Sepolia) and evaluate hierarchical controls in the final thesis phase.
6. **Document** governance, security, regulatory considerations, and a controlled rollout toward sandbox piloting.

1.5 Research Questions

The research questions are:

1. **RQ1:** Does a hierarchical blockchain lending architecture reflect development-finance capital flows more faithfully than flat DeFi protocols?
2. **RQ2:** Can on-chain transparency, reserve controls, and role-based governance reduce opacity and friction across tiers?
3. **RQ3:** Does a lightweight off-chain analytics layer offer practical, auditable fraud and lending support?
4. **RQ4:** Can the architecture deploy on public testnets with the RBAC, capital-flow, and reserve properties required for institutional banking? *Scope: prototype viability only—not production readiness or regulatory compliance.*
5. **RQ5:** Can deposit-funded and solidarity group lending be represented as programmable, auditable on-chain mechanisms feasible for retail users?

1.6 Research Contribution

This work makes four original and precisely scoped research contributions:

Contribution 1 — Four-Tier Hierarchical DeFi Architecture. No prior work combines (a) a four-tier lending hierarchy with reserve-ratio enforcement at every tier, (b) oracle-mediated explainable ML credit governance, and (c) programmable mutual-liability group lending in one open architecture. Partial counterexamples exist on individual axes—Maple Finance, Goldfinch, Morpho V2, Aave Arc ($\approx \$50$ k TVL in February 2026 despite permissioned architecture [65])—but none model multilateral development-finance capital flows with enforced reserves at all four tiers [1, 37, 90]. *Scope:* Tier 1–3 contracts and the lending workflow are specified in Solidity (Appendices B, D); cross-tier automation and testnet deployment are scoped to Phases I–II (Appendix C).

Contribution 2 — On-Chain Solidarity Group Lending. No prior academic work specifies programmable mutual-liability group lending with group consent, installment splitting, and over-indebtedness controls in EVM smart contracts (Section 3.17.3). Goldfinch provides partial precedent without per-member liability; Jaffer [91] and Sherratt [92] ground the economic and social-risk context. *Scope honesty:* the design implements *programmable joint liability* (closer to cosigning than BRAC/Grameen solidarity groups). Minimal PoC deployment is scoped to Phase II.

Contribution 3 — Oracle-Mediated AI/ML Integration with Explainability. An architectural pattern integrates off-chain fraud detection, anomaly detection, and SHAP-based explainability (Section 4.3.2) into on-chain lending via a trusted oracle relay, with three integration options (centralized relay, Chainlink Functions, commit-reveal) and audience-specific outputs for clients, approvers, and compliance reviewers. *Scope:* pipeline and datasets are specified in pre-thesis 1; all training, benchmarking on BCCC-DeFiFraudTrans-2025 [83] and Elliptic [84], and oracle wiring begin after pre-thesis 2 (Phases II–III). Optionally extended by a conversational agent add-on (Chapter 4; Phase III–IV Could).

Contribution 4 — Compliance-Aware ZKP Identity Pathway. A two-circuit architecture combines zk-SNARK KYC verification (Groth16 via Circom 2.0) with a zkAML circuit [59] and W3C DID/VC identity [64], grounded in Piper et al. [58]. *Scope:* KYC age-range circuit specified for Phase I deployment; full AML circuit scoped to Future Work.

Positioning against institutional DeFi. Sygnum’s *Institutional DeFi in 2025* report notes that allocators require *legal enforceability*, not just technology [65]. CWB is a planning-phase prototype for development-finance and MFI use cases, positioned as a composable lending layer compatible with emerging CBDC and tokenized-deposit rails (Section 1.9) rather than a replacement for traditional banking.

Section 1.10 maps where each topic introduced in this chapter is expanded across Chapters 2–6 and the appendices.

1.7 Blockchain Justification

The root cause is a **multi-party coordination and trust problem**: institutions must share financial state and enforce shared rules without fully trusting one another or a central administrator—otherwise requiring a trusted central authority (systemic risk) or bilateral agreements (2–5 day delays, \$42 per transaction). Blockchain provides consensus-enforced shared state, programmable rule enforcement, cryptographic auditability, and atomic multi-party settlement—properties a cloud database cannot replicate without reintroducing a trusted central operator.

1.7.1 Blockchain Fundamentals and the EVM Execution Model

A. Blockchain consensus. An append-only ledger with cryptographic linking; immutability is consensus-enforced and holds while no coalition controls $>50\%$ of stake [63]. Polygon PoS finality via Heimdall (Tendermint BFT) assumes fewer than one-third Byzantine validators—a stated design constraint.

B. EVM execution [50]. Stack-based deterministic bytecode with fixed gas costs per opcode. Storage writes (SSTORE) dominate cost; a 12-installment loan involves ≈ 24 storage operations and 27–32 total state changes (Section 5.8.1).

C. State machines. Lending contracts follow `PENDING` $\rightarrow$ `APPROVED` $\rightarrow$ `ACTIVE` $\rightarrow$ `REPAYING` $\rightarrow$ `COMPLETED/DEFAULTED`, with role-authorized transitions and `nonReentrant` atomicity.

D. The oracle problem [54, 55]. Smart contracts cannot access off-chain data natively. Three options bridge ML risk scores to on-chain decisions: (1) centralized relay (simple, trusted); (2) Chainlink Functions (decentralized, 30–60 s latency); (3) commit-reveal (hash before, reveal after). Pre-thesis 1 documents the relay design only; live ML scoring and Chainlink Functions wiring begin after pre-thesis 2 (Phase III). Price Feeds, Automation, and Proof of Reserve serve FX, overdue detection, and reserve verification.

E. Polygon zkEVM. Cardona is the primary deployment target (Section 3.2); ZK validity proofs on Ethereum L1 provide stronger security than PoS alone.

1.8 Proposed Solution

The Crypto World Bank uses a **four-tier on-chain lending model**: Tier 1 (World Bank reserve custodian) $\rightarrow$ Tier 2 (National Banks) $\rightarrow$ Tier 3 (Local Banks processing retail loans) $\rightarrow$ Tier 4 (clients building on-chain credit history). Supporting mechanisms include rolling borrowing limits, automatic installment generation, and planned off-chain AI/ML analytics.

1.8.1 Banking Functions of the Platform

The platform implements six standard banking functions across the four-tier hierarchy, enforced on-chain rather than by discretionary audit (Figure 1.2):

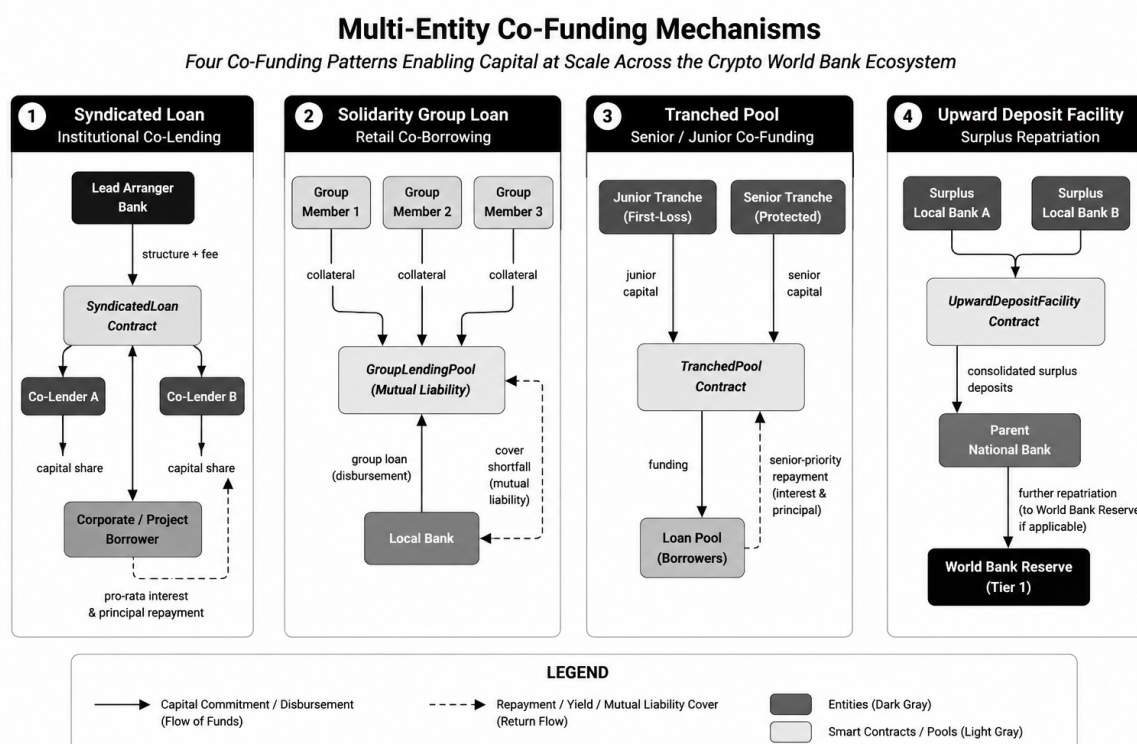


Figure 1.2: Six banking functions of the platform

- **Deposit mobilization** — savings vaults with reserve-ratio checks on withdrawal.
- **Credit allocation** — downward capital allocation plus syndicated multi-bank co-funding.
- **Payment & settlement** — atomic transfers without nostro/vostro in-transit state.
- **Risk intermediation** — reserve buffers, approver workflows, liquidation, oracle-mediated ML.
- **Liquidity management** — same-tier interbank pools and upward surplus repatriation.
- **Ancillary services** — FX oracles, group lending, syndicated/tranched products, decentralized identity.

1.8.2 Cross-Tier Lending System

Real banking capital flows in multiple directions: same-tier interbank lending (SOFR, SONIA), upward surplus deposits to parent institutions, and syndicated co-funding of large exposures. CWB encodes all three as on-chain contracts—a **multi-directional, multi-entity coordination system** (Figure 1.3). Downward allocation distributes capital through four tiers; interbank pools balance same-tier liquidity; upward facilities repatriate surpluses; syndicated, group, and tranched contracts enable multi-entity co-funding. Full specifications are in Section 3.14; literature context in Section 2.2.

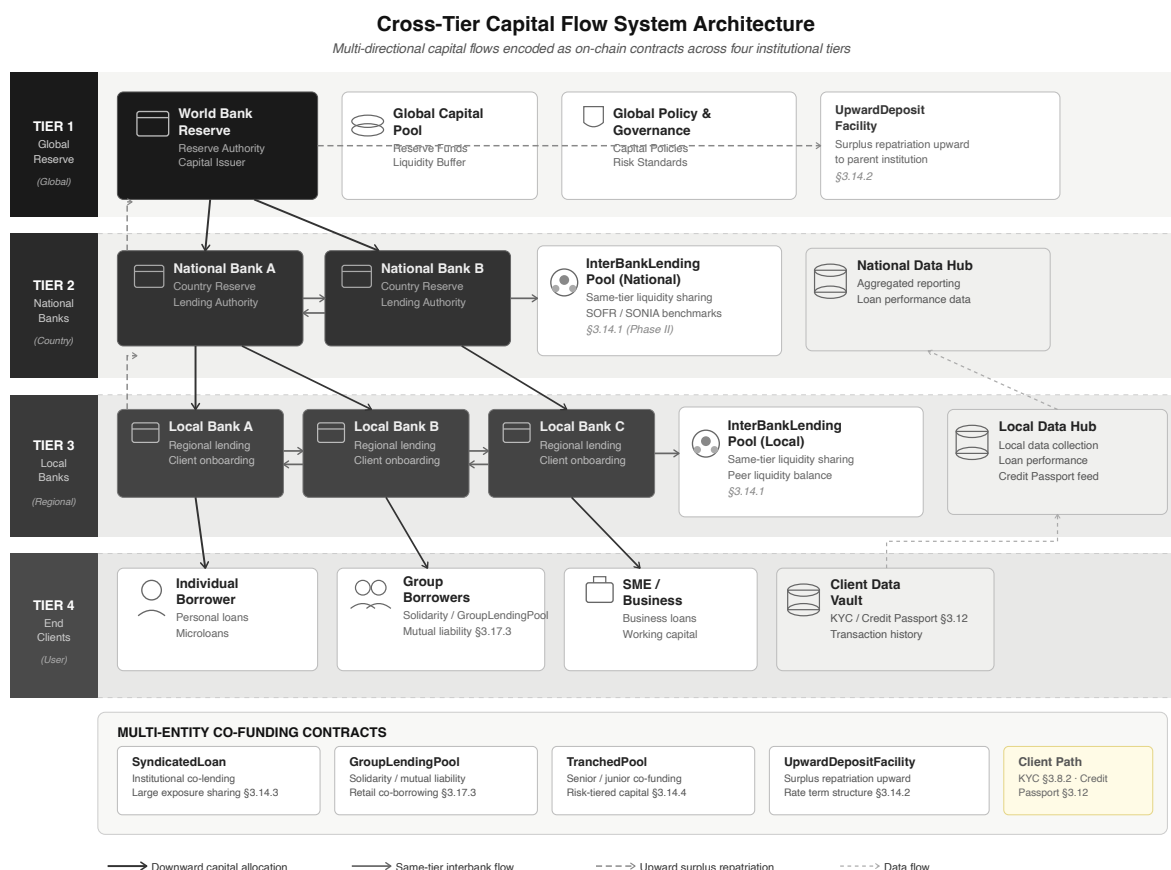


Figure 1.3: Cross-tier lending flow directions

Can a group of entities lend or fund together? Yes—via institutional syndicated loans (Section 3.14), retail solidarity groups (Section 3.17.3), tranching pools (Section 3.14), and upward surplus deposits (Section 3.14). **Same-tier** interbank pools balance peer liquidity (Section 3.14; Phase II stretch). **Upward** deposits create a natural rate term structure. **Client path:** all borrowers enter through Local Banks; KYC (Section 3.8.2), Credit Passport (Section 3.12), and borrowing limits constrain access; large exposures trigger syndication. Full specifications in Section 3.14.

1.9 Methodology in Brief

Our approach combines lightweight Agile delivery with a four-phase SDLC. **Pre-thesis 1** (this report) covers requirements, architecture, and design—including the AI/ML pipeline specification but *no model training or live inference*. After **pre-thesis 2**, Phases I–IV implement, verify, and validate. Phase I deploys the four-tier contract scaffold, wallet auth, frontend skeleton, PostgreSQL schema (20 entities), and Proof of Reserve. Phase II implements lending lifecycle, borrowing limits, deposits, group lending, and multi-entity treasury (stretch). Phase III begins all AI/ML workload—dataset ingest, model training, FastAPI scoring, and Chainlink Functions oracle wiring (Section 3.3.2)—plus syndicated/tranching/netting contracts, Foundry tests, and Tenderly monitoring. Phase IV adds Certora formal verification. Stack: Solidity 0.8.20, React 18/TypeScript, Express.js + FastAPI, scikit-learn, Circom 2.0; optional MCP agent (Phase III–IV Could). Deployments target Polygon zkEVM Cardona and Ethereum Sepolia testnets.

1.10 Scopes and Challenges

Scope. Pre-thesis 1 delivers formal specification and a four-phase plan covering four-tier lending, loan lifecycle, borrowing limits, and the *design* of oracle-mediated fraud analytics—not trained models or live ML inference (those begin after pre-thesis 2). Mainnet deployment, retail payments, fiat on/off-ramps, production KYC/AML, and stress testing are excluded—supported as post-MVT work by literature (Section 2.2; Section 6.1).

Challenges. Unlabeled fraud data may require synthetic or transfer-learning approaches; regulatory uncertainty is mitigated by testnet-only operation; gas costs are managed by off-chain ML; interpretability via SHAP; economic sustainability analyzed in Chapter 5.

Economic sustainability. A 10 ETH loan at 8% APR yields \$1,600 interest; 10–15 on-chain transactions cost under \$0.15 on Polygon zkEVM—sustainable on L2, requiring optimization for mainnet micro-loans.

Institutional capture. Mitigated by real-time reserve verification, algorithmic rates, tamper-evident audit trails, open-source governance, and programmatic borrowing caps with syndication for large exposures.

Stablecoin-first lending. ETH-denominated micro-loans expose borrowers to liability-side volatility [60, 61]; CWB requires stablecoin lending at retail tiers (USDC \$77.3B, USDT \$189.5B circulating). Regulatory anchors: EU MiCA [75, 76], US GENIUS Act [77], BIS *mBridge/Agora* settlement rails [78, 79]. Supply via stablecoin pools, multi-chain L2 deployment (Section 3.13), and four-tier reserve ratios promoting credit velocity (Formula CV).

1.11 Market Analysis and Partnership Ecosystem

TAM spans DeFi lending (> \$55B TVL [8]) plus correspondent-banking inefficiencies [16, 20]; SAM covers hierarchical institutional lending (\$5–15B); SOM covers sandbox pilots (\$50–200M)—full sizing in Table 5.1. CWB targets Tier 1–3 institutions and Tier 4 retail clients (Table 5.3), with five partner categories: regulators, banks, oracle providers, academics, and field pilots (Table 5.5). On-chain incentives include tamper-evident repayment records, transparent reserve verification, and programmable fee distribution.

1.12 Thesis Organization

Chapter 1 states the problem, objectives, and proposed approach at overview level. Subsequent chapters expand each thread as follows:

- **Chapter 2 — Literature Review:** PRISMA methodology and evidence base (Section 2.1); domain survey across DeFi, ML, hierarchy, security, and retail rails (Section 2.2); protocol comparison (Section 2.4); design implications (Section 2.5).
- **Chapter 3 — System Architecture:** four-tier contracts, oracle stack, and platform selection (Section 3.2); data model and on/off-chain partitioning (Sections 3.4, 3.5); ZKP identity and tiered onboarding (Sections 3.7.1, 3.8.2); cross-tier and multi-entity lending (Section 3.14); banking products and group lending (Section 3.17); governance and defense-in-depth security (Sections 3.18, 3.19); closing compliance and impact notes (Sections 3.21–3.22).

- **Chapter 4 — Methodology:** Agile SDLC phase plan; MVT deliverable boundary (Section 4.1); oracle-mediated ML pipeline (Sections 4.3, 4.3.1, 4.3.2); optional MCP agent (Section 4.4; Appendix B).
- **Chapter 5 — Feasibility:** market sizing, customer segments, and partner ecosystem (Tables 5.1–5.5); economic, technical, and regulatory analysis including MiCA/GENIUS mapping (Section 5.10).
- **Chapter 6 — Conclusion:** contribution summary, limitations, and post-MVT future work (Section 6.1). Smart-contract interfaces and deployment manifest appear in Appendices B–D.

Department CO mapping. For examiner traceability against the programme rubric: Chapter 1 (CO1 — problem formulation); Chapter 2 (CO9 — literature survey); Chapter 3 architecture plus Sections 3.21–3.22 (CO2 specifications, CO3 societal impact, CO4 environmental impact, CO12 ethical issues); Chapter 4 (CO5 design process, CO10 project and risk planning); Chapter 5 (CO6–7 evaluation framing, CO11 economic analysis). Measured implementation evidence (testnet deployment, ML benchmarks, formal proofs) is scheduled after Pre-Thesis 2.

Chapter 2

Literature Review

2.1 Preliminaries

Core terms—DeFi, smart contracts, over-collateralization, XAI, PoS, CBDC, solidarity/group lending, ALM, flash loans, ZKP, and Health Factor—are defined in the **Glossary** appendix (Appendix D in the final thesis assembly; the current pre-thesis build temporarily carries the WorldBankReserve interface as Appendix D). Platform-specific terms (*Platform Solvency Ratio*, *Provisional Credit Tier*, *Cold-Start Credit Pathway*) appear there as well. Readers may skip to Section 2.2 if already familiar with blockchain fundamentals (Section ??).

2.1.1 Review Methodology (PRISMA-Style Frame)

Evidence is synthesized under a PRISMA-style frame [66], not a narrative summary alone. Inclusion required: (i) peer-reviewed or formal institutional reports (2017–2026); (ii) relevance to at least one of eight CWB modules—DeFi lending, ML fraud/anomaly detection, ZKP/DID identity, group/microfinance literature, smart-contract security, institutional DeFi, regulation, or retail payments/remittance/on-ramps; and (iii) methodological transparency sufficient to reuse design parameters (reserve invariants, gas accounting, F1 scores). Databases searched: ACM, IEEE, Elsevier, MDPI, arXiv (venue-checked), and BIS/World Bank portals, using blockchain, DeFi, lending, fraud detection, ZKP, institutional DeFi, hierarchical, development finance, plus microcredit, remittance, and on-ramp. The bibliography contains 120 entries; Table 2.1 ranks the top ten. Figure 2.1 shows screening counts. PRISMA-based banking reviews [17] confirm this as the expected synthesis standard.

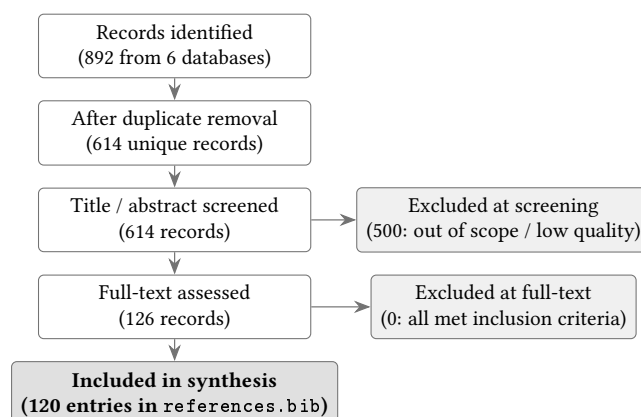


Figure 2.1: PRISMA-style literature screening flow

Table 2.1: Top-10 ranked literature sources

#	Source / Module / Operationalized In	Headline Finding
1	Werner et al. 2022 [1] · DeFi mechanics · Ch. 3	DeFi lending is uniformly flat, pool-based, overcollateralized
2	Tan 2023 (IMF) [5] · CBDC & hierarchy · Ch. 3	Two-tier CBDC distribution (central bank → commercial banks → users); hierarchical infrastructure is the key design choice
3	Palaiokrassas et al. 2024 [3] · Fraud detection · Sec. 4.3	Multi-chain ML on 54M tx, F1 0.76–0.85 with behavioral features
4	Adom et al. 2022 [4] · Explainable AI · Sec. 4.3	SHAP outperforms LIME on lending datasets
5	Weber et al. 2019 / Elliptic [85] · Graph fraud · Sec. 4.5	Graph-structured fraud signal in BTC transactions
6	McMahan et al. 2017 / FedAvg [68] · Federated learning · Sec. 4.6	Privacy-preserving model averaging across institutions
7	BIS WP 905 [61] · Stablecoin risk · Secs. 1.9, 5.10	Algorithmic stablecoins unsuitable for EM DeFi; USDC/USDT recommended
8	Atzei et al. 2017 [7] · Smart contract security · Sec. 3.19	SoK of EVM attack vectors
9	EU MiCA + GENIUS Act [75, 77] · Regulation · Sec. 5.10	Stablecoin issuer authorization, reserve disclosure
10	Bangladesh Bank SP2025-02 [80] · MFI precedent · Sec. 3.17.3	Female-to-male account parity 49%/49% in 2025; 89% BRAC loans to women

2.2 Review of Existing Research

This chapter surveys peer-reviewed work, institutional reports, and industry data across twelve domains that shape the Crypto World Bank design: DeFi lending, ML fraud detection and explainable AI, hierarchical development finance and cross-tier flows, group/microfinance literature, smart-contract security, gas and Layer 2 scalability, correspondent banking, retail payments and remittance, monetary-policy distributional effects, real-world asset tokenization, stablecoin regulation and institutional settlement rails, and optional LLM/MCP interfaces.

2.2.1 Decentralized Lending and DeFi Protocol Design

DeFi lending automates deposit funding and credit allocation through public smart contracts: utilization curves set rates, oracles trigger liquidations, and settlement is atomic. The model’s strengths—real-time auditability, per-block interest, reduced loan-officer discretion—come with structural limits for development finance: participants are fungible (no institutional roles), borrowing is over-collateralized (excluding many unbanked adults), and capital flows one way through flat pools with no inter-tier allocation or multi-entity

co-funding.

Werner et al. [1] systematize DeFi as homogeneous, pool-based, and over-collateralized with no institutional hierarchy—the core gap this thesis addresses. Bastankhah et al. [2] show adaptive dual fast/slow rate control outperforming static Aave/Compound curves [51], informing the kinked-rate model (Section 3.9). Chen et al. [39] validate multi-chain lending for throughput; Yang and Cui [40] supply evaluation metrics (utilization stability, liquidation efficiency, rate responsiveness). Hartmann and Hasan [41] analyse gas and identity in P2P lending; Dao et al. [52] adapt credit scoring to DeFi borrowing limits.

2.2.2 Machine Learning, Explainable AI, and Extended AI Security

Palaiokrassas et al. [3] achieve F1 0.76–0.85 on 54M multi-chain DeFi transactions using behavioral features versus 0.08 with raw transaction data alone—direct input to Random Forest feature engineering. Liu et al. [6] supply Isolation Forest for unsupervised detection when labeled fraud is scarce. Hasan et al. [42] train fraud classifiers via federated learning on encrypted features, informing cross-bank intelligence without raw data sharing.

Adom et al. [4] find SHAP more consistent than LIME for loan explanations; Yuan [49] reaches AUC >0.92 with SHAP on credit-default models—motivating SHAP waterfall review before approvals. Beyond the core pipeline, graph features from Palaiokrassas et al. [3] support GNN ring detection; federated learning [42] suits National/Local Bank boundaries; ContractWard [43] and SoliAudit [44] enable real-time exploit monitoring; RL rate tuning and NLP income extraction remain future-work options.

2.2.3 Hierarchical Distribution, Cross-Tier Flows, and Group Lending

Tan [5] models two-tier CBDC distribution (central bank → commercial banks → users), paralleling the four-tier hierarchy. BIS [46] prefers two-level retail CBDC with interoperability constraints, informing the dual-currency facility. Asaduzzaman et al. [47] report up to 60% admin-cost reduction from smart-contract microcredit—literature precedent for GroupLendingPool, not a deployment-jurisdiction claim.

Policy literature establishes hierarchical distribution but sparse programmable *multi-directional* coordination. Kiff et al. [106] distinguish multi-tier CBDC with supervised intermediaries; Bindseil [105] analyses tiered remuneration for UpwardDepositFacility rate spreads (Section 3.14); Auer and Böhme [107] hybrid CBDC mirrors client-via-Local-Bank access with Tier 1 reserve authority. *Project Pine* [103] validates layered contract factories for reserve and collateral dependencies extended by InterBankLendingPool and SyndicatedLoan. Dong et al. [104] model cross-tier direct financing in supply chains—parallel to downward allocation to capital-constrained retail clients (Figure 1.3).

Grameen/BRAC solidarity groups achieve >95% repayment through social monitoring that on-chain mutual liability cannot fully replicate; GroupLendingPool encodes multi-signature consent and pool claims at pre-thesis stage. Güçük et al. [53] review privacy and trust in blockchain microlending.

2.2.4 Smart Contract Security and Layer 2 Scalability

Atzei et al. [7] catalogue reentrancy, access-control, and overflow vectors—motivating OpenZeppelin guards, Solidity 0.8.20, RBAC, Slither, Mythril, and Phase IV formal ver-

ification. Wang et al. [43] (ContractWard) reach F1 0.96/0.93 on bytecode vulnerability classes; Liao et al. [44] (SoliAudit) cut audit time $\approx 70\%$ via ML-prioritized fuzzing; So et al. [45] (VERISMART) report 98.4% precision with zero false positives on arithmetic safety—candidate for reserve-ratio invariants.

Kim and Kim [48] show batching and calldata compression save 30–50% mainnet gas, supporting Polygon zkEVM Cardona deployment where multi-step four-tier lifecycles multiply savings.

2.2.5 Correspondent Banking, Retail Payments, and Settlement Rails

BIS [16] and FSB [27] document nostro/vostro idle capital, MT103 routing, and 2–5-day settlement. World Bank remittance data [20] average 6.49% on a \$200 transfer (Sub-Saharan Africa $> 8\%$). Cerutti et al. [116] and Du et al. [110] show digital and stablecoin rails can undercut legacy costs but depend on corridor off-ramp depth—scoped separately (Section 6.1).

Retail literature examines stablecoin remittance, merchant checkout, and on/off-ramps for post-MVT modules (CurrentAccount, P2PTransfer). Ante [108] finds 26% U.S. remittance-user stablecoin adoption, supporting tiered KYC gating. Du et al. [110] document the fiat–stablecoin–fiat “sandwich” pattern. Li et al. [109] (CLEAR framework) find programmable settlement advantages but weak open-loop dispute recourse; Zhang et al. [112] warn on refund volatility; Fröhlich et al. [111] show on-ramp friction dominates POS UX. Lin et al. [113] (SecurePay) and BIS *Project Sela* [119] validate Local-Bank-sponsored multi-intermediary flows; Cimaszewski et al. [118] blueprint jurisdictional DLT settlement. CPMI [114], BIS Papers 170 [115], and FATF [117] define ramp and VASP compliance for platform-mediated P2PTransfer—not permissionless unhosted-wallet remittance. No prior work composes four-tier development-finance lending with closed-loop retail rails in one architecture.

2.2.6 Monetary Policy, Tokenization, and Institutional Landscape

Cross-country evidence links QE to wealth inequality [28]; Federal Reserve metro analysis [29] shows low-income harm from tightening—motivating algorithmic, transparent rate and reserve parameters rather than opaque committee discretion. Tier-uniform utilization rates reduce loan-officer price discrimination; the Cantillon effect does not apply where USDC is fully reserved and the platform creates no new money [30].

R3 Corda reports \$17B tokenized RWAs [31]; Centrifuge exceeds \$1B across eight chains [32]; World Bank FundsChain tracks disbursements on 13 projects scaling to 250 [33]—institutional precedent for hierarchical on-chain finance beyond fund tracking alone.

Sygnium [65] notes institutional allocators require legal enforceability (Aave Arc $\approx \$50k$ TVL). mBridge [78] and *Project Agora* [79] are settlement rails, not retail lending hierarchies; 94% of central banks research CBDCs [71]. CWB positions as a lending-layer specification compatible with these rails.

2.2.7 Graph ML, Federated Learning, Regulation, and Identity Primitives

DeFi fraud is relational: Cheng et al. [93], Chang et al. [93], and DeFiGuard [67] outperform flat ML on graph structure—motivating a GNN extension with hierarchical tier edges (Section 4.5). Federated learning [42, 97] and PrivChain-AI (94.7% accuracy) suit banks that

cannot share raw records; FedAvg aggregation at National tier is architecturally natural (Section 4.6).

MiCA [75, 76] and the U.S. GENIUS Act [77] anchor stablecoin-first retail design (Section 1.9; mapping in Section 5.10). Buterin et al. [69] introduce non-transferable SBTs for portable credit passports [70] (Section 3.12).

2.2.8 Oracle-Mediated ML and Optional LLM Interfaces

Luo et al. [94] survey AI fraud detection across the DeFi lifecycle; Caldarelli [95] identifies ML-score oracle delivery as under-researched beyond price feeds. BCCC-DeFiFraudTrans-2025 [83] (1,026,867 labeled transactions) is the planned primary training corpus after pre-thesis 2 (Section 4.3.1); Fazliani et al. [96] and Alhasawi et al. [97] supply semi-supervised and federated baselines.

The optional conversational add-on uses an 8B open-weight LLM with QLoRA, RAG, and refusal layers. Finance LLM studies [72, 73, 74] report productivity gains but document regulatory-hallucination risks—motivating the red-team protocol in Section 4.13.1.

2.3 Literature Review Summary

Table 2.3 (Parts A–F) summarizes reviewed works by methodology, findings, and project relevance, following the synthesis table format recommended by Michigan State University Libraries [17].

Table 2.2: Literature review summary (Part A)

Author & Focus	Methodology	Key Findings	Relevance to Our Project
Palaiokrassas et al. (2024) [3] · DeFi fraud detection	XGBoost, NN classifiers on 54M+ multi-chain transactions	F1: 0.76–0.85 vs. 0.08 with features alone	Informs Random Forest fraud modeling
Adom et al. (2022) [4] · XAI in loan approval	LIME / SHAP comparison on lending datasets	SHAP provides deeper, more consistent explainability; LIME is faster	Justifies SHAP as our primary explainability method
Tan (2023) [5] · CBDC hierarchical distribution	Model for developing nations	Two-tier CBDC distribution (central bank → commercial banks → users); hierarchical infrastructure is the decisive design choice	Informs four-tier architecture and dual-currency facility
Liu et al. (2008) [6] · Anomaly detection	Isolation Forest on synthetic and real datasets	Isolation via recursive partitioning; shorter paths	Specified as secondary unsupervised detection for wallet behaviour
Atzei et al. (2017) [7] · Smart contract security	SoK of Ethereum attack vectors	Over-reliance, access control vulnerabilities	Directly informs our security primitives and planned formal verification

Table 2.4: Literature review summary (Part B)

Author & Focus	Methodology	Key Findings	Relevance to Our Project
Werner et al. (2022) [1] · DeFi protocol systematisation	SoK survey of 12+ DeFi protocol categories	Lending platforms are uniformly pool-based and overcollateralised; no institutional hierarchy exists	Identifies the core gap our four-tier architecture addresses
Bastankhah et al. (2024) [2] · Adaptive DeFi lending	Dual fast/slow control; simulation on historical data	Dynamic rate adjustment outperforms static utilisation curves	Validates algorithmic lending parameter optimisation

Table 2.6: Literature review summary (Part C)

Author & Focus	Methodology	Key Findings	Relevance to Our Project
Hartmann and Hasan (2021) [41] · Blockchain P2P lending	Smart contract-mediated loan origination framework	Eliminates intermediary overhead; gas cost minimisation analysis	Informs four-tier architecture for peer-to-peer lending
Hasan et al. (2022) [42] · Privacy-preserving fraud detection	Federated learning on encrypted blockchain features	ML achieves comparable accuracy to centralised models	Informs future privacy-preserving fraud detection extensions
Wang et al. (2020) [43] · Smart contract vulnerability detection	ML classifiers on bytecode features	F1: 0.96 for access control; 0.93 for data leakage	Supports our planned security verification models
Liao et al. (2019) [44] · Smart contract audit automation	Hybrid classification + fuzz testing	Reduces audit time by 70% vs. manual review	Informs our security audit strategy for three-contract architecture

Table 2.8: Literature review summary (Part D)

Author & Focus	Methodology	Key Findings	Relevance to Our Project
BIS et al. (2020) [46] · CBDC design requirements	Analysis of retail CBDC distribution architecture	Two-tier model preferred; interoperability challenges identified	Informs dual-currency facility design
Kiff et al. (2020) [106] · CBDC operating models	IMF survey of retail CBDC architectures	Multi-tier models delegate distribution to supervised intermediaries	Supports four-tier wholesale-to-retail capital path
Bindseil (2020) [105] · Tiered CBDC remuneration	ECB policy analysis of two-tier CBDC rates	Tiered rates preserve bank intermediation; control disintermediation risk	Informs upward/downward asymmetric rate spread
Dong et al. (2023) [104] · Cross-tier supply-chain finance	Three-tier game-theoretic MSOM model	Blockchain cross-tier direct financing reaches capital-constrained deep tiers	Parallel to downward client lending without wholesale bypass
Project Pine (2025) [103] · Hierarchical smart contracts	NY Fed / BIS tokenized policy toolkit prototype	Factory-to-facility contract hierarchy for reserves and collateral	Validates layered contract design for IBLP / SyndicatedLoan
BIS/FSB [16] · Cross-border settlement infrastructure	Analysis of cross-border payment costs and capital trapped in nostro accounts	2–5 days avg. settlement; \$42/transfer avg. cost	Motivates four-tier settlement with near-instant finality
Beyer et al. (2025) [28] · Monetary policy and inequality	Cross-country analysis (1999–2019)	QE increases wealth inequality; effects more persistent than monetary parameters	Motivates transparent, algorithmic monetary parameters
World Bank (2025) [33] · Blockchain for development finance	Pilot on 13 projects, 10 countries	Blockchain tracking reduces reporting burden for fund distribution	Supports our planned multi-chain deployment strategy

Table 2.10: Literature review summary (Part E)

Author & Focus	Methodology	Key Findings	Relevance to Our Project
Chen et al. (2024) [39] · Multi-chain DeFi lending	Cross-chain model design and implementation	Multi-chain distribution improves throughput and reduces congestion	Supports our planned multi-chain deployment strategy
Yang and Cui (2023) [40] · DeFi lending protocol evaluation	Quantitative risk metrics for lending protocol assessment	Utilisation ratio, liquidation efficiency, and reserve responsiveness as key metrics	Provides benchmarks for evaluating our hierarchical tiers
Asaduzzaman et al. (2020) [47] · Smart micro-credit (MFI literature)	Smart contract-based microfinance	Reduces admin overhead by 60% vs. manual processes	Informs GroupLendingPool economic case
Kim and Kim (2024) [48] · DeFi gas fee optimisation	Transaction batching and calldata compression analysis	Gas savings of 30–50% through optimisation strategies	Validates Layer 2 deployment and mainnet optimisation
Yuan (2024) [49] · SHAP-based credit default models	SHAP, Random Forest, and Gradient Boosting classifiers	AUC above 0.92 with full interpretability	Informs per-client risk explanation methodology

Table 2.12: Literature review summary (Part F)

Author & Focus	Methodology	Key Findings	Relevance to Our Project
Ante (2025) [108] · Stablecoin remittance adoption	Survey ($n=866$) of U.S. remittance users	26% stablecoin adoption; literacy drives uptake; continuance tied to usefulness	Informs KYC ladder and UX for P2PTransfer
Du et al. (2026) [110] · Competing payment rails	Harmonized all-in cost comparison across corridors	Stablecoin sandwich can undercut banks/MTOs; off-ramp depth is binding	Motivates PSP on/off-ramp future work
Li et al. (2026) [109] · Stablecoin retail payments SoK	CLEAR framework vs. card networks	Closed-loop / cross-border advantage; weak open-loop dispute recourse	Frames merchant checkout and InsuranceFund design
Zhang et al. (2024) [112] · Retail stablecoin checkout	Analytical operations model	Stablecoin refunds create consumer volatility disutility	Supports fiat-display FXModule and auto-conversion
Fröhlich et al. (2022) [111] · Crypto POS usability	Mixed-methods Lightning checkout study	Friction at on-ramp, not tap-to-pay	Prioritises fiat-funded CurrentAccount balances
Lin et al. (2025) [113] · Platform-economy payments	Permissioned chain + regulated money prototype	≈ 256 TPS; multi-intermediary escrow	Parallel to Local-Bank-sponsored merchant flows
CPMI / BIS [114, 115] · Stablecoin policy	Cross-border and monetary-system analysis	On/off-ramps gate acceptance; reserve transparency critical	Regulatory anchor for ramp integration
FATF (2021) [117] · VASP / P2P guidance	Risk-based AML standards for virtual assets	Platform-mediated transfers require originator data; pure unhosted P2P out of scope	Compliance model for sponsored P2PTransfer

2.4 Comparative Protocol Analysis

No surveyed protocol combines multi-tier hierarchy, oracle-mediated explainable ML, and compliance-aware identity. Table 2.4 compares CWB against Aave, Compound, Maker, Maple, and Goldfinch on eleven architectural dimensions.

Feature	Aave	Comp.	Maker	Maple	Gfinch	CWB
Institutional hierarchy	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	●
Cross-tier capital flow	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	⌚
Same-tier interbank lending	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	⌚
Syndicated / co-lending	✗	✗	✗	Part.	Part.	⌚
Upward capital repatriation	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	⌚
Solidarity group lending	✗	✗	✗	✗	Part.	●
AI/ML fraud detection	✗	✗	✗	Man.	Man.	●
SHAP explainability	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	●
ZKP KYC compliance	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	●
Kinked interest rate curve	✓	✓	Gov.	✓	✗	⌚
Role-based access control	Part.	Part.	Gov.	✓	Part.	●
Institutional / L2 focus	✗	✗	✗	✓	Part.	●
TVL / Status (2026)	\$26B	\$1.4B	\$10B	\$2.6B	\$680M	Planning

Table 2.14: Protocol comparison on eleven architectural dimensions

This answers RQ1: Aave v3 and Compound v3 sub-markets differentiate assets within flat pools, not institutional relationships or inter-bank flows; Maple, Goldfinch, and Morpho V2 [117, 90] lack multilateral development-finance capital allocation. CWB’s compound novelty (Section 1.6) holds across hierarchy, explainable ML governance, and group lending axes.

ERC-3643 (T-REX) alignment. Tiers 1–3 use bespoke RBAC (Section 3.19) functionally equivalent to ERC-3643 token-level KYC gating [82]; production under MiCA [75] could migrate to full T-REX interoperability without redesigning the role registry.

Contrast with opaque custody failures. FTX’s 2022 collapse exposed commingled client funds with no real-time solvency proof—the class of failure CWB addresses via enforced per-tier reserve ratios readable on-chain. The platform targets banking (savings, credit, interbank lending), not speculative exchange activity.

2.4.1 Literature Synthesis

Six design decisions follow directly from the survey: (1) Gudgeon et al. [56] on utilization crises → kinked-rate model (Section 3.9); (2) Piper et al. [58] → ZKP identity path (Section 3.7.1); (3) Tan [5], BIS [46], Kiff [106], Auer and Böhme [107] → four-tier capital flows; (4) Bindseil [105], Project Pine [103], Dong et al. [104] → multi-directional lending (Section 1.7.2); (5) Asaduzzaman et al. [47] → GroupLendingPool; (6) Ante [108], Du et

al. [110], Li et al. [109], Lin et al. [113], CPMI [114], FATF [117] → post-MVT retail stack (Section 6.1).

2.4.2 Agent Harness Engineering and Production Safety

Alizadeh et al. [87] show income uploads and language-preference fields as prompt-injection vectors in banking agents—fields present in CWB context assembly. OWASP LLM Top 10 [88] ranks prompt injection (LLM01) highest for agentic finance, framing evaluation of the scanning middleware.

2.5 Summary of Key Findings

The literature review yields the following design-relevant conclusions:

- **Flat DeFi vs. tiered finance.** Pool-based protocols exceed \$55B TVL [8] but lack institutional hierarchy; CBDC research confirms tiered distribution as a workable pattern [5]. No prior work models four-tier reserve-enforced lending.
- **Settlement and retail rails.** Correspondent banking traps idle capital [18], settles in 2–5 days at $\approx$ \$42/transfer [19], and costs remittance users \$48–56B annually [20]. Stablecoin rails can compress costs [116, 110] but need ramp infrastructure; retail studies [109, 112, 111, 113, 119] favour Local-Bank–sponsored closed-loop flows over open permissionless checkout.
- **ML, XAI, and security.** Behavioral DeFi features lift fraud F1 to 0.76–0.85 [3]; Isolation Forest [6] covers unlabeled cases; SHAP beats LIME for regulatory explainability [4]. Contract vulnerabilities are well catalogued [7]; ML audit tools reach F1 >0.93 [43], cut review time 70% [44], and formal verifiers such as VERISMART reach 98.4% precision [45].
- **Hierarchy, groups, and institutions.** Cross-tier CBDC and Project Pine literature [106, 105, 107, 103, 104] supports multi-directional programmable flows; analogue MFIs report $>95\%$ group repayment [47] with on-chain mutual liability still an open gap. FundsChain [33], Corda RWAs [31], and Kinexys [34] show rising institutional blockchain adoption.
- **Scalability, privacy, and regulation.** Multi-chain lending [39] and L2 gas optimization [48] cut costs 30–50%; federated learning [42, 97] enables cross-bank fraud intelligence without raw data sharing. MiCA and GENIUS [75, 77] anchor stablecoin-first design; algorithmic parameters mitigate distributional opacity from discretionary monetary policy [28, 29].
- **Deposit-funded sustainability.** Sustainable MFIs rely on mobilized deposits, not donor capital alone—motivating savings vaults at the Local Bank tier alongside GroupLendingPool.

These findings justify the four-tier architecture, cross-tier lending modules, Random Forest / Isolation Forest / SHAP analytics, governance structure, and phased security verification pipeline developed in later chapters.

Chapter 3

System Architecture and Design

3.1 Prototype Scope

Table 3.1: Prototype scope and implementation status

Feature	Status
Four-tier role system (RBAC)	⌚ Specified
World Bank Reserve contract (Tier 1)	⌚ Specified (Phase I)
Tier 2 National Bank contracts	⌚ Specified (Phase I)
Tier 3 Local Bank contracts	⌚ Specified (Phase I)
Cross-tier fund transfer	● Planned (Phase II)
Loan request / approval workflow	⌚ Specified (Phase II)
Installment EMI auto-generation	● Planned (Phase II)
SavingsVault contract	● Planned (Phase II)
FixedDeposit contract	● Planned (Phase II)
GroupLendingPool contract	● Planned (Phase II)
InterBankLendingPool	● Planned (Phase II)
AI/ML fraud detection (Random Forest)	● Planned (Phase III)
SHAP + anomaly explainability	● Planned (Phase III)
Oracle integration (Chainlink Functions)	● Planned (Phase III)
ZKP KYC compliance layer	● Planned (Phase IV)
Testnet deployment (Polygon zkEVM Cardona)	● Planned (Phase IV)
AI Agent / MCP tool server (17 tools)	● Optional (Phase III–IV)
EIP-7702 session key management	● Optional (Phase III)
Authority Brief UI (SHAP for approvers)	● Planned (Phase III)
Chainlink Automation (installment triggers)	● Planned (Phase II)
Chainlink Proof of Reserve	● Planned (Phase I)
The Graph subgraph (event indexing)	● Planned (Phase III)
SAR workflow (AML → freeze queue)	● Planned (Phase III)
sessions table schema	⌚ Specified (Phase I)
agent_action_log table schema	● Optional (Phase III)
300-client Foundry simulation	● Planned (Phase IV)

Chapter organisation. The remainder of this chapter is organised as follows. Sections 3.2–3.3.2 describe the platform stack, contract inventory, blockchain selection, and oracle architecture. Sections 3.4–3.5 present the relational data model and on-chain/off-chain partitioning. Sections 3.6–3.8.3 cover operating context, identity, onboarding, and the retail conversion funnel. Sections 3.9–3.13 specify interest-rate, liquidation, deposit, credit-passport, and cross-chain designs. Section 3.14 details multi-entity capital operations. Sections 3.15–3.17 provide UML-style models and the banking product suite. Sections 3.18–3.20 close with governance and the five-layer security architecture.

Specification voice. Throughout this chapter, **specified** denotes a formally documented design in pre-thesis 1; **planned** denotes a Phase I–IV implementation deliverable after pre-thesis 2; and **optional** denotes the conversational agent add-on, which mirrors the same

Express.js API and smart contracts as the primary React interface but is not required for core platform operation. **All AI/ML training and live inference begin after pre-thesis 2** (Section 4.3.1). Architectural descriptions use the present tense for specification clarity; Table 3.1 takes precedence when scope could be ambiguous.

3.2 High-Level Architecture

The system employs a **four-layer decentralised application architecture** (Figure 3.1): a presentation layer (React + wallet integration), a smart-contract layer (fifteen modular EVM contracts centred on the four-tier lending hierarchy), an off-chain services layer (Express REST API, PostgreSQL, planned FastAPI ML scoring after pre-thesis 2, Chainlink oracle integration, event listener, and Redis cache), and a Chainlink infrastructure layer (Chainlink Functions, Automation, Price Feeds, and Proof of Reserve). An optional conversational agent (Qwen3-8B + MCP tool server) attaches to the same API endpoints as the React UI and does not alter on-chain logic. Figure 3.2 elaborates this view with external integrations.

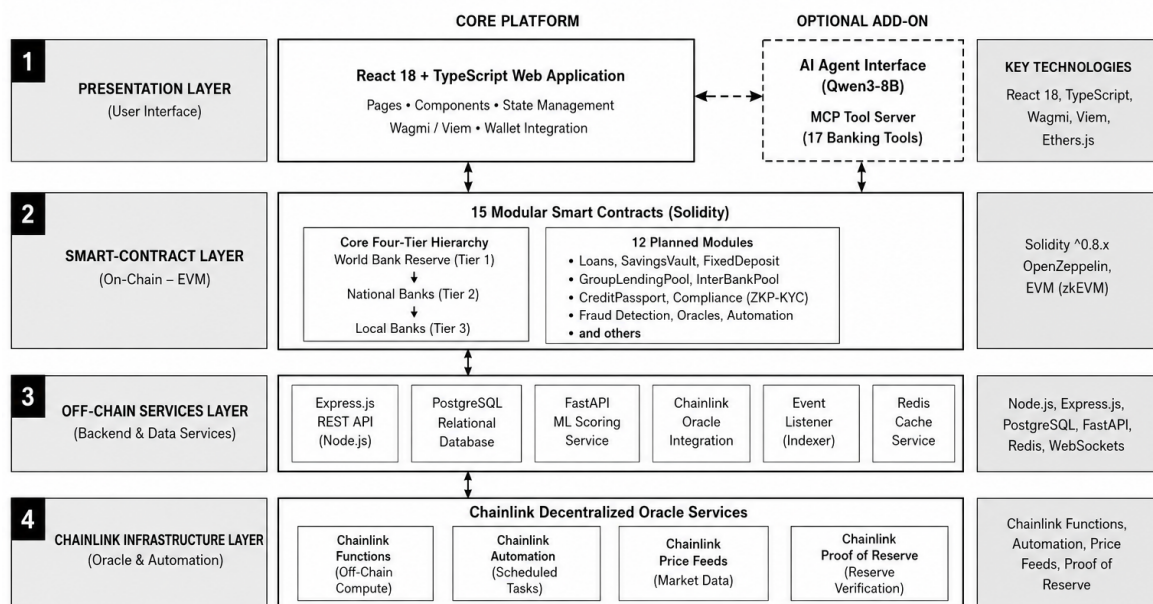


Figure 3.1: Four-layer application architecture

The architecture **specifies** fifteen modular contracts. Phase I targets the three-tier lending core (World Bank Reserve, National Bank, Local Bank). The remaining twelve split into two suites: *banking products* (SavingsVault, FixedDeposit, GroupLendingPool, FXModule, InsuranceFund, CurrentAccount) and *multi-entity operations* (InterBankLendingPool, UpwardDepositFacility, SyndicatedLoan, TranchPool, TreasurySwap, NettingEngine)—the latter enabling same-tier lending, upward funding, syndicated co-lending, treasury FX, and multilateral netting (Section 3.14, Figure 3.19). All are planned across Phases II and III.

Figure 3.2 shows component interactions. Core lending contracts are specified in Phase I; extended modules are planned extensions documented in Appendix B.

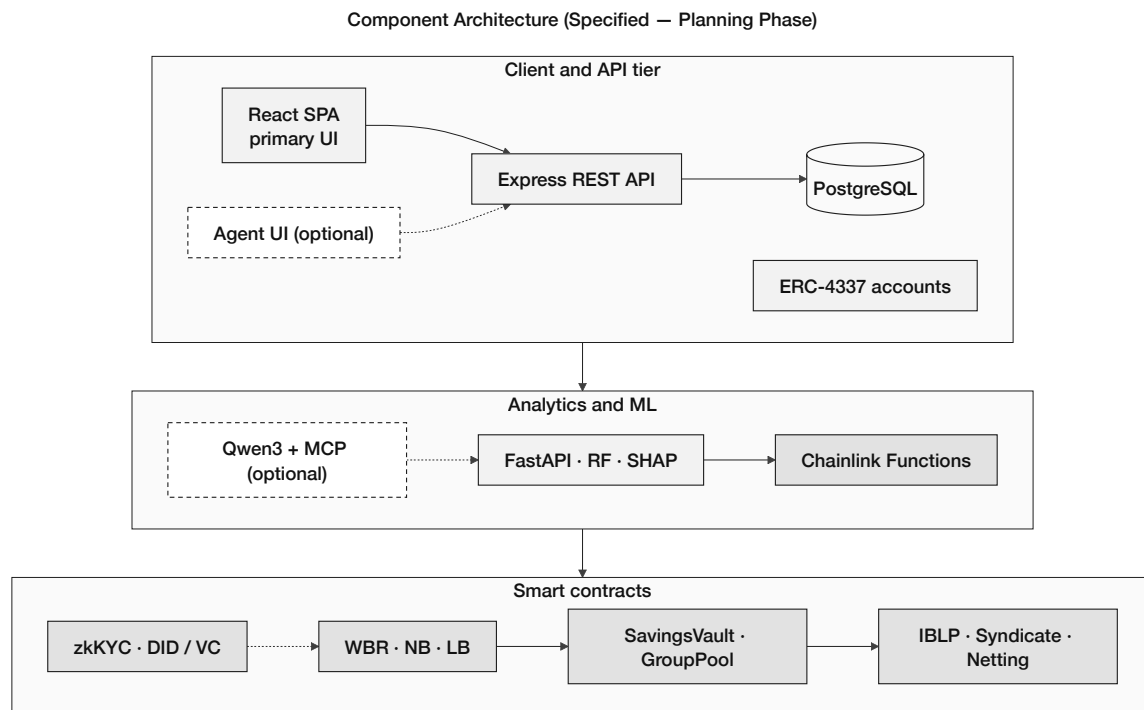


Figure 3.2: Component diagram (planning phase)

Contract	Module	Status	Primary responsibility
WorldBankReserve	Tier 1 core	Specified (Phase I)	Global reserve custody, national-bank registration, downward capital allocation.
NationalBank	Tier 2 core	Specified (Phase I)	Local-bank registration, upward borrowing, downward allocation.
LocalBank	Tier 3 core	Specified (Phase I)	Client onboarding, loan lifecycle, installments, freezeAccount.
SavingsVault	Deposits	Specified (Phase II)	Variable-yield savings, reserve-gated withdrawals.
FixedDeposit	Deposits	Specified (Phase II)	Term deposits with deterministic early-withdrawal penalty.
GroupLendingPool	Group credit	Specified (Phase II)	Solidarity-group formation, consent, mutual liability.
FXModule	Treasury / FX	Specified (Phase II)	Oracle-priced retail FX with disclosed spread.
InsuranceFund	Risk buffer	Specified (Phase II)	Default coverage buffer; Chainlink Proof of Reserve.
CurrentAccount	Payments	Specified (Phase II)	Transactional accounts and atomic peer transfers.
InterBankLendingPool	Multi-entity	Specified (Phase II)	Same-tier interbank liquidity pools per tier.
UpwardDepositFacility	Multi-entity	Specified (Phase II)	Upward surplus repatriation with yield spread.
SyndicatedLoan	Multi-entity	Planned (Phase III)	Multi-lender syndicate consent and disbursement.
TranchedPool	Multi-entity	Planned (Phase III)	Senior/junior tranching and waterfall recovery.
TreasurySwap	Multi-entity	Specified (Phase II)	Institutional oracle-priced asset swaps.
NettingEngine	Multi-entity	Planned (Phase III)	Multilateral settlement netting batches.

3.3 Blockchain Platform Selection

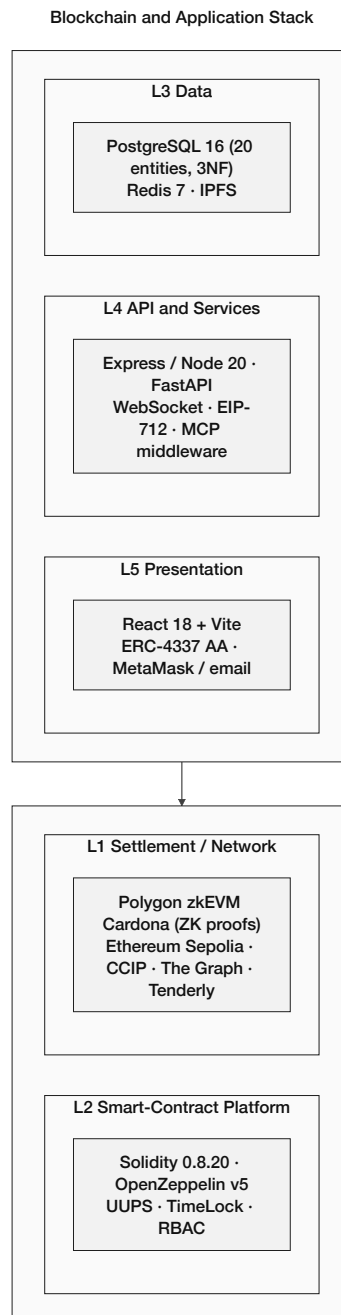


Figure 3.3: Layered blockchain and application stack

Table 3.3: Blockchain platform selection criteria and justification

Criterion	Selection	Justification
Platform	Ethereum Virtual Machine (EVM)	Largest developer ecosystem; battle-tested security model; extensive tooling.
Network	Polygon zkEVM Cardona / Ethereum Sepolia	Zero-cost deployment; production-equivalent behaviour; free faucet access.
Consensus	ZK validity proofs (Polygon zkEVM L2, Ethereum L1 settlement)	Every batch of transactions is accompanied by a zero-knowledge proof verified on Ethereum L1, so security derives from cryptographic validity rather than a validator set assumption.
Smart contract language	Solidity 0.8.20	Industry standard; mature compiler with overflow protection; rich library ecosystem.

Table 3.5: Blockchain platform selection (continued)

Criterion	Selection	Justification
Gas cost	\$0.001–\$0.01 per transaction	Orders of magnitude cheaper than Ethereum mainnet (\$5–\$50); enables micro-loan economics.
Block finality	≈2 seconds	Sub-second practical finality for retail UX; checkpointed to Ethereum for security.
Developer tooling	Hardhat + OpenZeppelin	Automated test suite, deployment scripts, and audited security primitives.
Testnet availability	Cardona (Polygon zkEVM), Sepolia (Ethereum)	Free faucets; EVM-identical behaviour; no real cryptocurrency required for prototype.
Security model	ZK validity proofs	Every batch verified by a ZK proof anchored to Ethereum L1 (vs. PoS validator assumption on Amoy).
Migration path	EVM-compatible	Same Solidity contracts deploy to any EVM chain; reduces future L2 migration cost.

3.3.1 Transaction Verification and Consensus

- **Polygon zkEVM Cardona:** ZK validity proofs anchor batches to Ethereum L1 (cryptographic security vs. PoS validator assumption on Amoy).

- **On prototype testnets:** Cardona and Sepolia use equivalent consensus models at no financial cost, enabling incremental development and testing without exposure to real-asset risk.

Gas-cost sustainability. The hierarchical loan lifecycle generates multiple on-chain state transitions per client; on Polygon zkEVM Cardona the **projected** cost remains well below 0.01% of interest earned on a representative retail loan (Section 5.8.1), to be validated by the Phase IV Foundry simulation. This margin underpins the micro-loan economics that motivate Layer 2 deployment in the platform selection above.

3.3.2 Oracle Architecture: Off-Chain AI to On-Chain Decision

The Crypto World Bank requires a mechanism to convey off-chain AI/ML risk assessments into the on-chain loan approval workflow. This is an instance of the oracle problem [54, 55].

Chainlink Functions oracle (primary). The final thesis phase uses **Chainlink Functions** as the primary oracle mechanism. Chainlink Functions operates via a Decentralised Oracle Network (DON): the ML risk score is fetched independently by multiple Chainlink nodes, consensus across the DON is required before the result is committed on-chain, and no single compromised node can manipulate the risk score. This is a fundamental trust improvement over the earlier commit-reveal relay, which required trusting a single FastAPI service key. The source code executed by the DON is:

```
// Chainlink Functions source (runs in decentralised DON)
const clientId = args[0];
const response = await Functions.makeHttpRequest({
  url: 'https://your-ml-service.com/score/${clientId}',
  method: "POST"
});
const score = response.data.risk_score;
// 6 decimal precision
return Functions.encodeUint256(Math.round(score * 1e6));
```

The DON adds 30–60 seconds of latency and \$0.10–\$1.00 per oracle call, both acceptable for the loan approval lifecycle where decisions are not time-critical. This architecture closes the oracle trust assumption noted in the prototype design (the 2-of-3 Safe multisig attestation was the interim mitigation; Chainlink Functions removes the need for that mitigation entirely).

Commit-reveal relay (prototype fallback). After pre-thesis 2, during the prototype phase and prior to Chainlink Functions being wired (Phase III), the system will use a commit-reveal relay as a fallback. The off-chain ML service commits a hash $h = \text{keccak256}(s \parallel \text{nonce})$ to the LoanController contract, then reveals s and the nonce within the decision window. The contract verifies $h = \text{keccak256}(s \parallel \text{nonce})$ and stores s immutably. This pattern prevents score manipulation between commitment and decision and creates an immutable on-chain audit trail of every risk score used in a lending decision, while Chainlink Functions integration is completed.

Chainlink Automation: trustless installment triggers. Chainlink Automation replaces the centralised cron job for overdue installment detection and interest accrual. The entire loan lifecycle from application to overdue flagging runs without a trusted operator:

```
// In LocalBankPool.sol
function checkUpkeep(bytes calldata) external view override
    returns (bool upkeepNeeded, bytes memory performData) {
    uint256[] memory overdueLoans = getOverdueLoans();
    upkeepNeeded = overdueLoans.length > 0;
    performData = abi.encode(overdueLoans);
}

function performUpkeep(bytes calldata performData) external override {
    uint256[] memory overdueLoans =
        abi.decode(performData, (uint256[]));
    for (uint i = 0; i < overdueLoans.length; i++) {
        _markInstallmentOverdue(overdueLoans[i]);
    }
}
```

This removes the last centralised component from the loan lifecycle — the entire process from application to overdue flagging runs without a trusted operator.

Chainlink Price Feeds: fiat and crypto pairs. The FXModule contract uses Chainlink’s production-grade AggregatorV3Interface price feeds for ETH/USD, USDC/USD, and governance-selected fiat pairs (e.g. EUR/USD), replacing the earlier “forex oracle approved by governance” pattern. Optional fiat-equivalent display in the frontend flows through:

```
// In LocalBankPool.sol
AggregatorV3Interface internal fiatUsdFeed; // e.g. EUR/USD
AggregatorV3Interface internal ethUsdFeed;

function getFiatEquivalent(uint256 usdcAmount)
    public view returns (uint256) {
    (, int fiatRate,,) = fiatUsdFeed.latestRoundData();
    // USDC tracks USD 1:1; Chainlink uses 8 decimals
    return usdcAmount * uint256(fiatRate) / 1e8;
}
```

The 8-decimal precision convention is the Chainlink standard for fiat-pair feeds. Chainlink price feeds are a planned Phase I integration for optional fiat-equivalent display in the frontend.

Chainlink Proof of Reserve. The WorldBankReserve contract publishes its reserve balance to **Chainlink Proof of Reserve (PoR)**, making the reserve cryptographically verifiable by any external auditor without trusting CWB’s administrator. This is the “free PoR” advantage over FTX: any external system can verify reserve solvency without relying on CWB’s admin claims.

```
// WorldBankReserve.sol
function getReserveSummary() external view returns (
    uint256 totalDeposited,
    uint256 totalLoaned,
    uint256 reserveRatio,    // scaled 1e4 (e.g. 5000 = 50%)
    uint256 insuranceFundBalance
) {
    return (
        totalDeposited,
        totalLoaned,
        (totalDeposited - totalLoaned) * 1e4 / totalDeposited,
        insuranceFund.balance()
    );
}
```

This function is the FTX commingling safeguard described in Section 3.19. Adding Chainlink’s PoR job on top turns it into a market-standard verifiable proof, and it is specified in full in Appendix D.

Chainlink Oracle Architecture - Off-Chain AI to On-Chain Decision

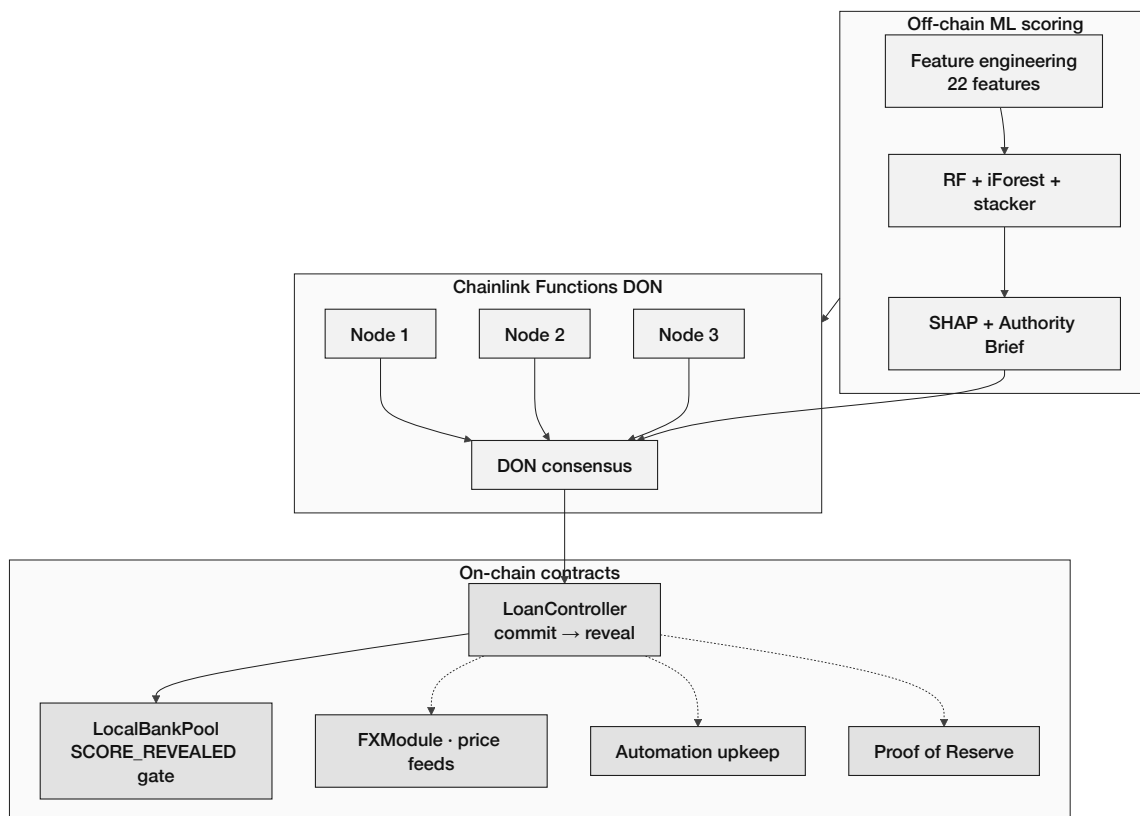


Figure 3.4: Chainlink oracle architecture

3.4 Data Model and Database Design

The relational database schema comprises 20 normalized entities in Third Normal Form (3NF). Figure 3.5 presents the core entity-relationship overview, Figure 3.6 presents ex-

tended product and multi-entity entities, and Figure 3.7 presents the Enhanced Entity-Relationship (EER) diagram with specialisation and weak-entity constructs.

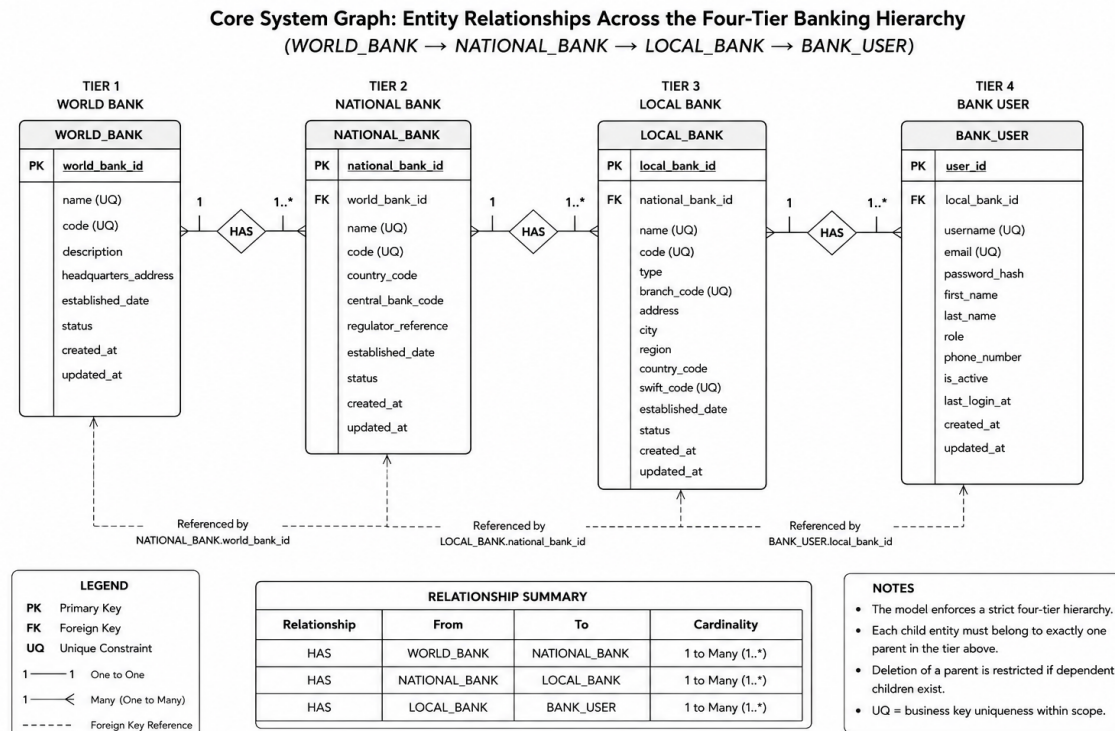


Figure 3.5: Core system entity graph

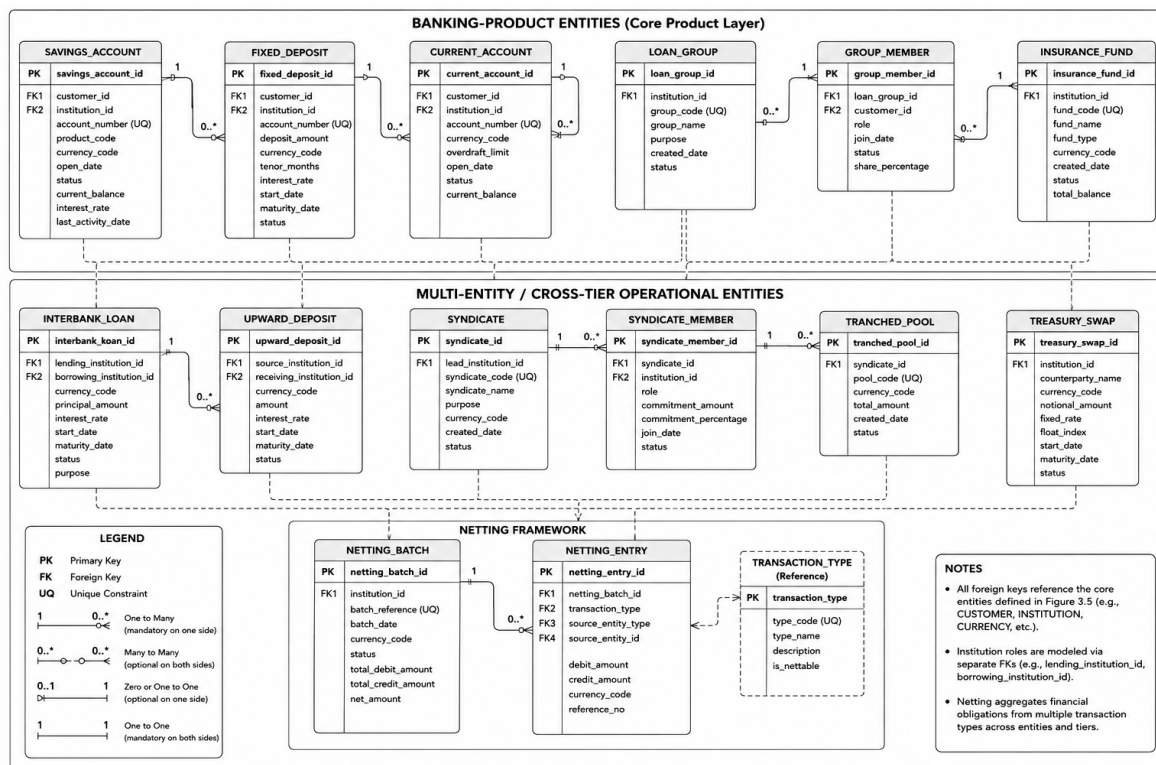


Figure 3.6: Extended ERD entities

The current ERD covers the core lending and governance entities. Figure 3.6 presents the extended banking entities (SavingsAccount, FixedDeposit, LoanGroup, GroupMember, CurrentAccount, and InsuranceFund) and the multi-entity / cross-tier operational entities described in Section 3.14: INTERBANK_LOAN, UPWARD_DEPOSIT, SYNDICATE and SYNDICATE_MEMBER, TRANCED_POOL, TREASURY_SWAP, and NETTING_BATCH with NETTING_ENTRY. Their foreign-key relationships into the core lending entities (LOAN, BANK_USER, REPAYMENT) are detailed in Section 3.14. The data model remains in one-to-one consistency with the contract architecture and implementation phase plan.

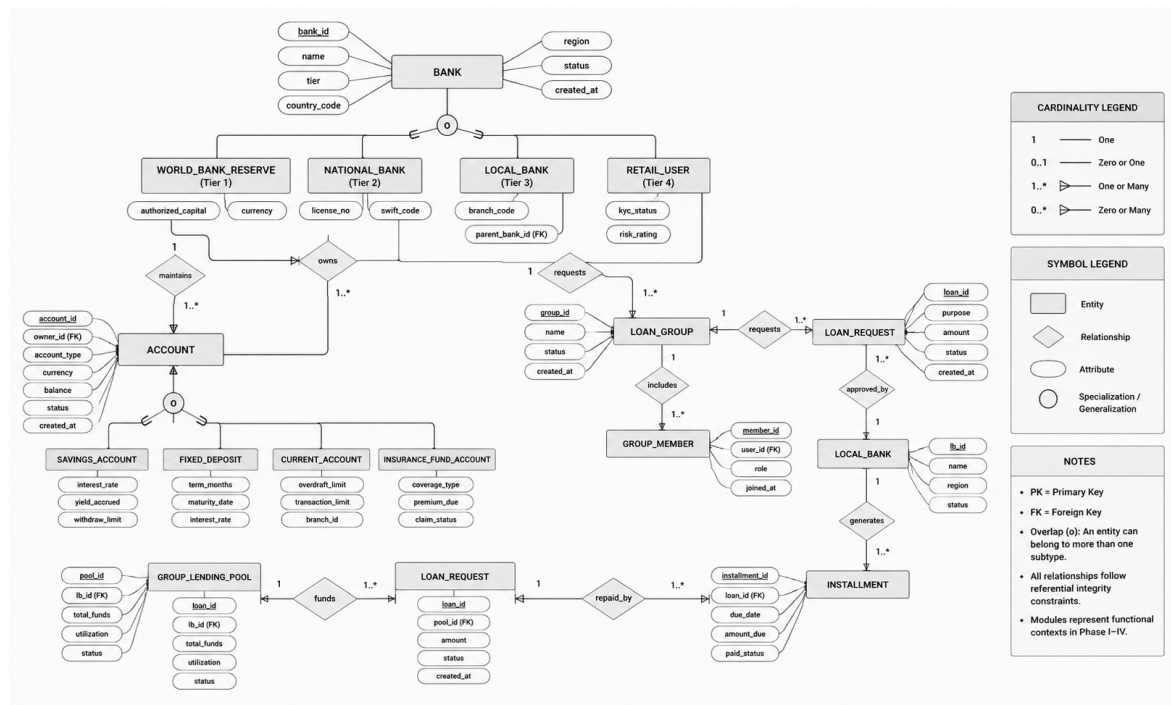


Figure 3.7: Enhanced EER model

3.4.1 Entity Summary

Table 3.7: Database entity summary (20 entities)

Entity	Primary key	Role / Description
WORLD_BANK	world_bank_id	Top-level reserve holder; global lending parameters.
NATIONAL_BANK	national_bank_id	Country-level banks; borrow from World Bank.
LOCAL_BANK	local_bank_id	City-level banks; borrow from National Bank and lend to users.
BANK_USER	bank_user_id	Bank staff with role-based permissions (approve/reject loans).
BORROWER (CLIENT)	borrower_id	End clients requesting and repaying loans (UK: wallet_address). Renamed CLIENT in the final migration; prototype retains BORROWER.
LOAN_REQUEST	request_id	Loan applications and approval workflow tracking.
LOAN	loan_id	Active loan after disbursement; FK loan_request_id → LOAN_REQUEST; collateral and loan asset references.
INSTALLMENT	loan_id, installment_number	Repayment schedule (weak entity on LOAN; composite PK).
TRANSACTION	transaction_id	Financial transaction records.
BORROWING_LIMIT	limit_id	Per-client limits with 6-month and 1-year rolling windows (UK: borrower_id).

Table 3.9: Database entity summary (continued)

Entity	Primary key	Role / Description
INCOME_PROOF	proof_id	Income verification documents (multi-valued per client).
CHAT_MESSAGE	message_id	Client-bank communication; FK to LOAN_REQUEST and/or LOAN.
AI_CHATBOT_LOG	log_id	AI chatbot interaction records.
AI_ML_SECURITY	security_log_id	Two logically distinct domains aggregated for the prototype: (1) LOAN_RISK_ASSESSMENT per-loan scores and SHAP vectors; (2) SECURITY_EVENT_LOG for system-wide events. Final thesis splits into separate tables.
MARKET_DATA	market_data_id	Cryptocurrency price feed cache (Express.js cron). Read-only auxiliary; no FK into core lending tables. Key attributes: symbol, price_usd, source, recorded_at.
PROFILE_SETTING	profile_id	Client and bank-user interface preferences. FK client_id → BORROWER (1:1). Attributes: language_setting, display_currency, notification_enabled.

Table 3.10: Database entity summary (continued)

Entity	Primary key	Role / Description
SESSIONS	session_id	Wallet session registry: device/IP hash, EIP-7702 session-key scope and TTL, parent lineage, compression summary, end reason, and delivery source. Audit FK for agent write tools.
AGENT_ACTION_LOG	action_id	Append-only agent write-tool log (tool, parameters, confirmation-message FK, tx hash, status). Separate from AI_CHATBOT_LOG; INSERT-only RLS policy.
INTEREST_RATE_T	tier_id	Normalised kinked-rate parameters (base_rate, kink_utilisation, rate_above_kink, max_rate); Section 3.4.
ASSETS	asset_id	Collateral and loan asset registry (UK: symbol); referenced by LOAN via collateral_asset_id and loan_asset_id.

3.4.2 EER Constructs Applied

Table 3.12: EER constructs applied

EER Construct		Applied To	Notes
Specialisation (dis-joint)		BANK_USER $\rightarrow$ NationalBankUser, LocalBankUser	A bank user belongs to exactly one bank type; enforced by CHECK constraint.
Generalisation		WORLD_BANK, NATIONAL_BANK, LOCAL_BANK share institution attributes	Avoids attribute duplication across institution types.
Weak entity		INSTALLMENT depends on LOAN	Existence and identity determined by parent loan.
Multi-valued attribute	at-	INCOME_PROOF per BORROWER	Modelled as separate entity to maintain 1NF.
Aggregation		TRANSACTION, CHAT_MESSAGE $\rightarrow$ AI_ML_SECURITY_L	AI_ML_SECURITY_LOG aggregates monitoring signals from both sources.
Association entity		LOAN_REQUEST links BORROWER + LOCAL_BANK	LOAN_REQUEST is a strong entity with primary key request_id and foreign keys to BORROWER and LOCAL_BANK, capturing the many-to-many relationship between borrowers and lending banks. It is <i>not</i> a weak entity and is not an aggregation in the ER-theoretic sense; “association entity” or “junction entity” is the correct ER classification.
Participation constraint	con-	BORROWER must have ≥ 1 LOAN_REQUEST to access services	Enforced at application layer; architecturally planned for on-chain.
Append-only (policy)	table	AGENT_ACTION_LOGS, AUDIT_LOGS	DB-level INSERT-only role + Row-Level Security policy enforces that no UPDATE or DELETE is permitted on audit records. Provides immutable tamper-evident trail for regulatory review and agent action accountability.

3.4.3 Normalization

The schema has been normalized to Third Normal Form (3NF) and checked against Boyce-Codd Normal Form (BCNF):

- **1NF:** There are no repeating groups in any of the attributes. Separate entities store multi-valued attributes, such as proof of income.
- **2NF:** There are no partial dependencies. The full composite key (`loan_id`, `installment_number`) determines the non-key attributes of `INSTALLMENT`.
- **3NF:** No dependencies that go through other dependencies. Instead of storing redundant values like `total_borrowed` in bank entities, they are calculated at query time.
- **BCNF:** All determinants are candidate keys. A `CHECK` constraint on `BANK_USER` enforces that the generalization hierarchy's specializations are not the same.

A transitive dependency was identified during schema review: `interest_rate_parameters` $\rightarrow$ `bank_tier_id` (interest rate values were stored as columns in the World Bank, National Bank, and Local Bank entities, making them dependent on a non-key attribute via the tier relationship). This violates 3NF. The fix is to extract these parameters into a dedicated `INTEREST_RATE_TIER` table keyed by `tier_id`, which each bank entity references via FK. This normalisation change ensures that updating a base rate does not require touching multiple bank-tier rows.

3.4.4 Physical Schema Reference

Indexing strategy and representative functional dependencies are documented in Appendix A to keep this chapter focused on conceptual design. B-tree indexes are chosen for range queries on rolling borrowing-limit windows and overdue-installment detection; the authoritative enforcement of borrowing limits remains on-chain.

The `parent_session_id` self-referential foreign key in `SESSIONS` introduces a recursive relationship within a single entity. This does not violate 3NF (the dependency is `session_id` $\rightarrow$ `parent_session_id`, not a transitive dependency), but it requires an acyclicity constraint to prevent circular ancestry chains: a session cannot be its own ancestor. This is enforced by a `CHECK` constraint in conjunction with a trigger that walks the ancestry chain before `INSERT` (see Section 3.4).

3.4.5 Relational Integrity Constraints

Table 3.14: Relational integrity constraints

Constraint Type	Examples
Primary Key	One surrogate or composite key per Table ??: e.g. world_bank_id, national_bank_id, local_bank_id, bank_user_id, borrower_id, request_id (LOAN_REQUEST), loan_id (LOAN), (loan_id, installment_number) (INSTALLMENT), transaction_id, limit_id, proof_id, message_id, log_id, security_log_id, market_data_id, profile_id, session_id, action_id, tier_id, asset_id.
Foreign Key	local_bank_id in LOAN_REQUEST references LOCAL_BANK; loan_request_id in LOAN references LOAN_REQUEST; loan_id in INSTALLMENT references LOAN.
UNIQUE	wallet_address in BORROWER; blockchain_tx_hash in LOAN_REQUEST; borrower_id in BORROWING_LIMIT; symbol in ASSETS.
CHECK	BANK_USER: (bank_type='national' AND national_bank_id IS NOT NULL) OR (bank_type='local' AND local_bank_id IS NOT NULL).
NOT NULL	Core attributes: name, wallet_address, status.
APPEND-ONLY (DB policy)	AGENT_ACTION_LOG: CREATE ROLE audit_writer; GRANT INSERT ON agent_action_log TO audit_writer; REVOKE UPDATE, DELETE FROM PUBLIC. AUDIT_LOGS: same policy applied via Row-Level Security (ALTER TABLE audit_logs ENABLE ROW LEVEL SECURITY; CREATE POLICY audit_insert_only ON audit_logs FOR INSERT WITH CHECK (TRUE)).
FOREIGN KEY (new)	LOAN.collateral_asset_id REFERENCES assets(asset_id); LOAN.loan_asset_id REFERENCES assets(asset_id); AGENT_ACTION_LOG.session_id REFERENCES sessions(session_id); AGENT_ACTION_LOG.confirmation_turn_id REFERENCES chat_message(message_id).
UNIQUE (new)	assets.symbol (asset ticker is globally unique across the platform asset registry).

3.5 On-Chain and Off-Chain Data Partitioning

Table 3.16: Data partitioning between on-chain and off-chain storage

Data Category	Storage	Rationale
Reserve balances, loan requests, approval/rejection events, repayment transactions	On-chain	Immutability, public auditability, trustless verification.
User profiles, income verification documents, chat messages, AI/ML inference logs	Off-chain (database)	Data privacy, query flexibility, storage cost optimisation.
Borrowing limit computations	Off-chain with on-chain enforcement	Complex temporal aggregation; results committed as on-chain constraints.
Cryptocurrency market data	Off-chain (cached)	High-frequency updates; external API dependency.
Agent action execution log	Off-chain (append-only DB)	Immutable audit trail of every agent write-tool call, linked to on-chain tx hash; not stored on-chain to save gas.
Session key material	Off-chain (sessions table)	EIP-7702 session key hash, scope JSON, and TTL stored off-chain; the scope restrictions are enforced on-chain by the session key contract at signing time.
Chainlink oracle price data	Off-chain (MARKET_DATA)	Chainlink Price Feed results are cached in MARKET_DATA with source = Chainlink feed address; the on-chain AggregatorV3Interface is the authoritative source.
Session lineage chains (SESSIONS, message history, compression summaries)	Off-chain (PostgreSQL)	Full transcript history is too large for on-chain storage. The lineage chain enables searchable long-term memory without gas cost. AGENT_ACTION_LOG provides the on-chain audit link via confirmed transaction hashes.

On-Chain vs Off-Chain Data Partitioning

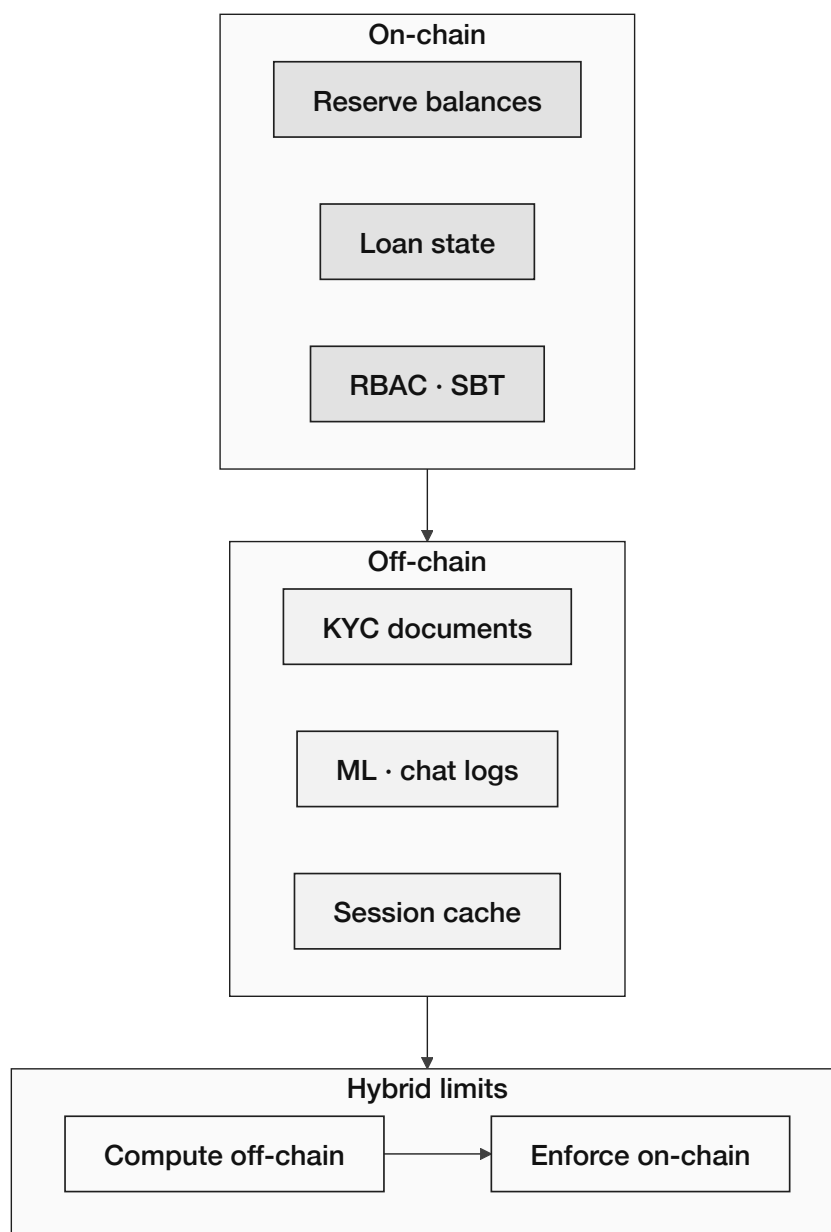


Figure 3.8: On-chain versus off-chain data partitioning

3.6 Operating Context

The Crypto World Bank is specified as a **blockchain-based institutional finance platform** on EVM Layer 2, not as a geographic pilot for a single rural market. The primary contribution is programmable hierarchical banking—reserve enforcement, tiered capital flow, on-chain auditability, and modular lending products—deployable on public testnets (Polygon zkEVM Cardona, Ethereum Sepolia) and portable to any EVM chain.

Three design choices anchor the operating context. First, **stablecoin-denominated retail lending** (Section 1.9) limits liability-side volatility when collateral and loans use different asset types. Second, **low per-transaction gas cost** on zkEVM L2 makes high-frequency in-

stallment and reserve operations economically viable relative to Ethereum mainnet. Third, **optional account abstraction** (Section 3.8.1) can simplify wallet onboarding for crypto-naïve retail users without changing smart-contract role logic. Solidarity group lending (Section 3.17) is a programmable product module informed by microfinance literature (BRAC, Grameen); it is not scoped to a specific country deployment. Institutional onboarding is planned through academic pilots, open-source replication, and regulatory sandbox partnerships (Section 3.18.2).

3.7 Digital Identity System

The platform's identity model operates across two layers, combining wallet-based authentication with off-chain document verification, and is designed to accommodate compliance requirements in future phases.

- **Identity based on wallets:** Users authenticate via Ethereum wallet signatures (MetaMask, WalletConnect), eliminating the need for centralised credential storage.
- **Role binding:** In the smart contract permission system, wallet addresses are linked to hierarchical roles like Owner, National Bank, Local Bank, Approver, and Retail Client.
- **Limits of wallet-based identity:** Wallet ownership proves transaction history and cryptographic control but cannot independently prove legal identity, jurisdiction, or age. This distinction is critical for regulated banking operations. A compromised or lost wallet requires an off-chain recovery process and on-chain role revocation followed by re-binding to a replacement address, a governance workflow that must be carefully designed to prevent unauthorized role escalation.
- **On-chain versus off-chain identity layers:** The system maintains two identity layers. On-chain identity consists of the wallet address, assigned role, and transaction history recorded permanently on the blockchain. Off-chain identity consists of document-verified income, KYC credentials, and AML screening results stored in the PostgreSQL database and linked to the wallet address by hash reference. The planned ZKP-based compliance extension would allow users to prove off-chain KYC status to the smart contract without exposing personal documents on-chain.
- **EIP-7702 session key authorisation:** For agent-executed banking operations, the client authorises a scoped, time-bound session key at login. The session key is restricted to a named set of MCP write tools (e.g., only `submit_loan_application` and `pay_installment`), a value cap (e.g., 500 USDC per transaction), and a 24-hour TTL after which it auto-expires. The session key cannot transfer funds to external addresses or perform any operation outside its approved scope. Every session key usage is logged in `AGENT_ACTION_LOG` with the conversation turn ID of the client's confirmation message as the audit reference.

3.7.1 ZKP KYC and zkAML Compliance Architecture

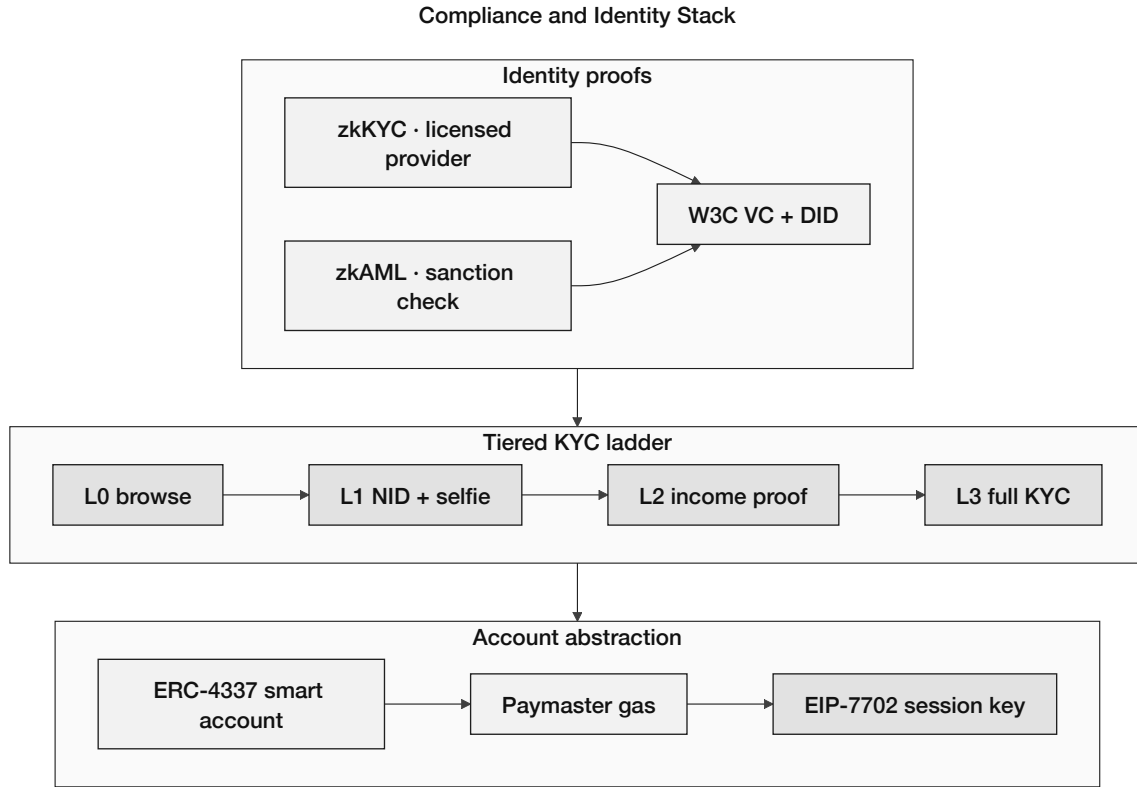


Figure 3.9: Compliance and identity stack

The compliance gateway uses two cooperating zero-knowledge circuits rather than a single KYC verifier: a **KYC circuit** and an **AML circuit**, both expressed as zk-SNARKs (Groth16 proofs via Circom 2.0 + snarkjs). KYC proves that the user owns a valid identity credential; AML proves that the user’s wallet has not interacted with sanctioned addresses and stays within velocity limits. Decoupling the two circuits makes it possible to revoke AML certification without invalidating the KYC credential, and matches the actual structure of regulator-mandated compliance.

KYC circuit (identity). An off-chain KYC provider validates the user’s government-issued ID and issues a signed credential $credential = \text{Sign}_{\text{KYC}}(wallet_address, country, age_over_18, kyc_pas)$. The user generates a zk-SNARK proof that (a) they possess a valid signed credential from an approved KYC provider, (b) their age is over 18, and (c) their country is in the permitted jurisdiction list—without revealing the underlying credential, ID number, or personal data. The smart contract verifies the proof: `KYCVerifier.verify(proof, [wallet, country, age_over_18])` returns true. Piper et al. (2025) [58] report proof generation in 1–4 s on consumer hardware; on-chain verification costs $\approx 200\text{--}300\text{ k gas}$, within a one-time registration budget.

zkAML circuit (anti-money-laundering). The zkAML circuit [59] (IACR ePrint 2025/465) proves three properties of a wallet without revealing its transaction graph: (1) the wallet has not transacted with any address on a public sanctions list (Chainalysis / TRM Labs); (2) the wallet’s 30-day inflow does not exceed a governance-set velocity threshold;

and (3) the wallet has not received funds from addresses flagged in the platform's on-chain risk registry within the preceding 90 days. The published benchmark for zkAML is 55 TPS on public networks with 226 ms proof-generation latency, both compatible with retail-tier flows on Polygon. The on-chain verifier is a sibling of `KYCVerifier` that exposes `AMLVerifier.verify(proof, [wallet, blockHeight])`. Both verifiers must return true before a wallet's CLIENT role is activated.

W3C DID / VC anchoring. The KYC credential issued off-chain is shaped as a W3C Verifiable Credential (VC) bound to a W3C Decentralized Identifier (DID) [64] rather than a free-form signed blob. The DID is anchored on-chain (`did:ethr:0x...` per the EIP-1056 standard), and the smart contract checks possession of the VC by means of the zk-SNARK proof rather than by storing the VC itself. This places the platform's identity layer inside the Self-Sovereign Identity (SSI) framework and aligns it with the European Blockchain Services Infrastructure (EBSI) reference architecture.

Privacy posture. A 2025 ResearchGate study reports a 97% reduction in exposed user data versus conventional on-chain KYC; Decker (2025) [59] gives the same finding under a different threat model. Phase IV implementation will target deployment of both Circom 2.0 circuits to Polygon zkEVM Cardona testnet, tested with synthetic credential data from a mock KYC provider.

3.8 User Taxonomy and Onboarding Flows

The platform defines nine actors (A1–A9) following the project systems-analysis convention [102]: five primary roles that take action, and four external systems or authorities. Tables ??–?? and Figure 3.10 summarise who each user is, what they may do, and where their data lives.

User Type		Tier	KYC Level		Wallet Type	Data Residence	
Anonymous	Visitor	—	None		None	Session only (Redis)	
Registered User	Retail	Tier 4	Level 1 (gov. ID + selfie)		MetaMask or optional ERC-4337	Off-chain primary; on-chain role only	
Group Client		Tier 4	Level 1 + group verification		ERC-4337 abstracted	Off-chain + on-chain group contract	
Local Bank Operator		Tier 3	Full institutional KYC		MetaMask (institutional)	Off-chain + on-chain role binding	
Local Bank	Approver	Tier 3	Full institutional + background check		MetaMask + Safe co-signer	Off-chain + on-chain role binding	
National Bank Admin		Tier 2	Full institutional + regulatory license		Safe multisig mandatory	Off-chain + on-chain role binding	
World Bank	Admin (Governance)	Tier 1	Founding team + supervisor attestation		Safe 3-of-5 multisig	On-chain governance only	

Label	Actor	Role
<i>Primary Actors (initiate actions)</i>		
A1a	Retail Client (pre-KYC)	Browsing only; no banking transactions.
A1b	Retail Client (KYC Tier 1)	Bronze/Silver credit tier; small loans up to the KYC-1 cap.
A1c	Retail Client (KYC Tier 2)	Gold/Platinum/Diamond; larger limits, group lending.
A2	Local Bank Admin (Approver)	Loan approver; risk officer; reviews AML alerts.
A3	National Bank Admin	Capital allocator; compliance officer; SAR review; freeze authority.
A4	World Bank Admin (Governance)	Parameter governor; system operator via multi-sig.
A5	AI Agent (optional)	Conversational add-on; read tools always permitted; write tools require explicit human confirmation gate before execution.
<i>Secondary Actors (external systems or authorities)</i>		
A6	Regulatory Authority	Read-only audit access via encrypted data package.
A7	Chainlink DON	Oracle, price feeds, automation.
A8	Blockchain Validator	Polygon zkEVM validity proof generation.
A9	External Auditor	Chainlink PoR verification.

Action	Client	LB Ad-min	NB Ad-min	WB Ad-min	AI Agent
View own loan status	YES	YES*	YES*	YES*	READ
Submit loan application	YES	NO	NO	NO	WRITE†
Pay installment	YES	NO	NO	NO	WRITE†
Submit KYC documents	YES	NO	NO	NO	NO
Approve loan application	NO	YES	NO	NO	NO
Reject loan application	NO	YES	NO	NO	NO
Freeze client account	NO	YES	YES	YES	NO
Set borrowing rate	NO	NO	YES	YES	NO
Change reserve ratio	NO	NO	NO	YES	NO
Upgrade LB borrowing cap	NO	NO	YES	YES	NO
View audit logs (all)	NO	YES*	YES*	YES	NO
Generate SAR report	NO	YES	YES	YES	NO
View reserve summary (public)	YES	YES	YES	YES	READ

† Agent write tools require human confirmation. * Own tier only.

	Client (React UI / MCP Agent)	Local Bank (Tier 3)	National Bank (Tier 2)	World Bank Reserve (Tier 1)	AI Agent (Optional)
Action / Tool					
Submit loan request	✓	✓	○	○	---- ✓
Pay installment	✓	✓	○	○	---- ✓
Approve loan	○	✓	✓	○	---- ○
Approve account	○	✓	✓	○	---- ○
Freeze accounts	○	○	✓	✓	---- ○
View all rates	✓	✓	✓	✓	---- ✓
Read tools freely	✓	✓	✓	✓	---- ✓
Write tools (humans only)	○	✓	✓	✓	---- ○
✓ Allowed ○ Not allowed —— Full access (as per role) ----- Optional / limited (AI Agent)					

Figure 3.10: Actor permission matrix (primary actions)

3.8.1 ERC-4337 Account Abstraction for Retail Onboarding

Most retail users will not manage seed phrases or buy ETH for gas. Tier 4 clients therefore get an **ERC-4337 smart account** on first sign-in: they register with email or Google (Firebase Auth), recover access through a trusted contact, and never handle a mnemonic. A Paymaster funded by the World Bank Reserve covers gas on Polygon zkEVM Cardona (EntryPoint v0.7); Biconomy or Alchemy Account Kit supplies bundler infrastructure in the planned build. MetaMask remains available for users who prefer self-custody—account abstraction is optional, not mandatory, and on-chain role logic is unchanged.

Free gas can invite abuse, so sponsorship is gated. Before KYC, the Paymaster pays only for account creation and submitKYCHash (capped at 0.001 ETH-equivalent per wallet). After `kycVerified[wallet] = true`, normal sponsorship applies, with a lifetime cap per verified identity and rate limits on IP and device fingerprint.

For the optional AI agent, **EIP-7702 session keys** limit what the agent may sign: named tools only, 24-hour expiry, 500 USDC per transaction, and client revocation at any time. ERC-4337 still pays gas; EIP-7702 only scopes agent authority.

3.8.2 Tiered Risk-Based KYC

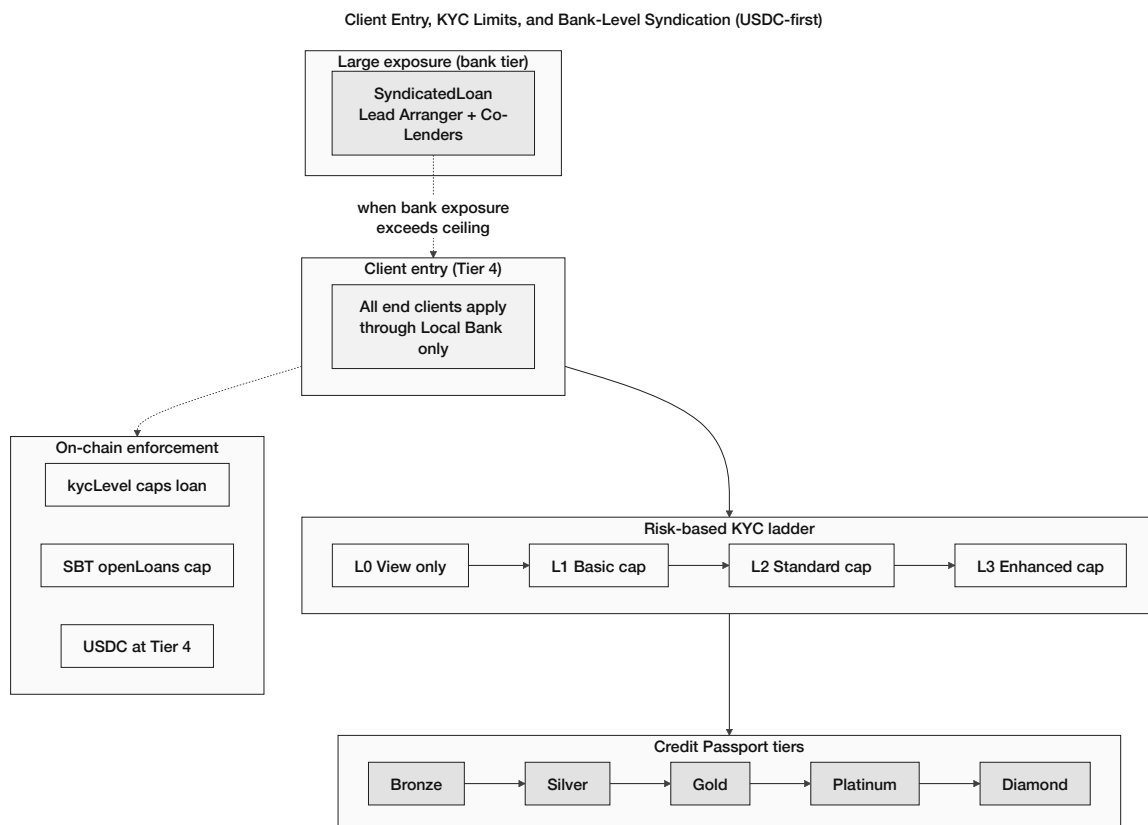


Figure 3.11: Client limits and bank-level syndication

KYC follows a four-step risk ladder (Table ??): higher limits require more documents and longer review. After approval the contract sets `kycVerified`, `kycLevel`, and a one-year `kycExpiry`; only document hashes and zk proofs go on-chain—never raw ID or biometrics.

Table 3.18: Tiered, risk-based KYC ladder

Risk Level	Required Documents	Borrow Limit	Verify Time
Level 0 (Un-verified)	None	View only	Instant
Level 1 (Basic)	Government ID photo + selfie liveness check	Up to 0.1 ETH-equivalent (USDC)	2–5 min (automated)
Level 2 (Standard)	Government ID + proof of income + bank statement	Up to 2 ETH-equivalent	24 h (human review)
Level 3 (Enhanced)	Full document set + video interview	Up to 10 ETH-equivalent	48–72 h

3.8.3 Five-Stage Retail Onboarding Funnel

Retail onboarding moves users through five steps (Figure 3.12): browse without an account, create a wallet or smart account, complete KYC (about 2–5 minutes at Level 1), take a first loan with plain-language terms and USDC repayments, then unlock advanced features (MetaMask, explorer views, group lending). The React dashboard is the main path; the agent in Section 4.4 is an optional alternate.

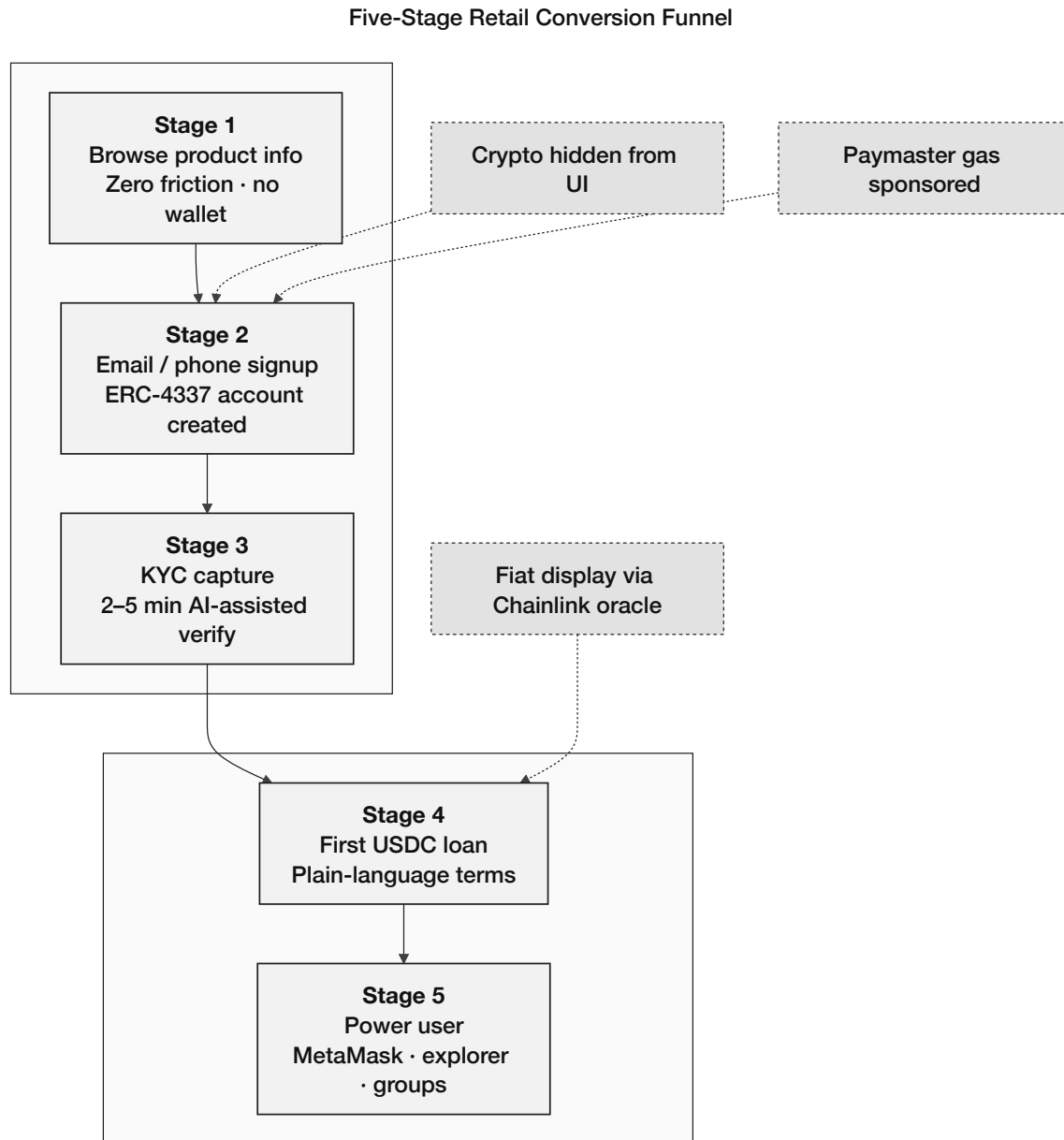
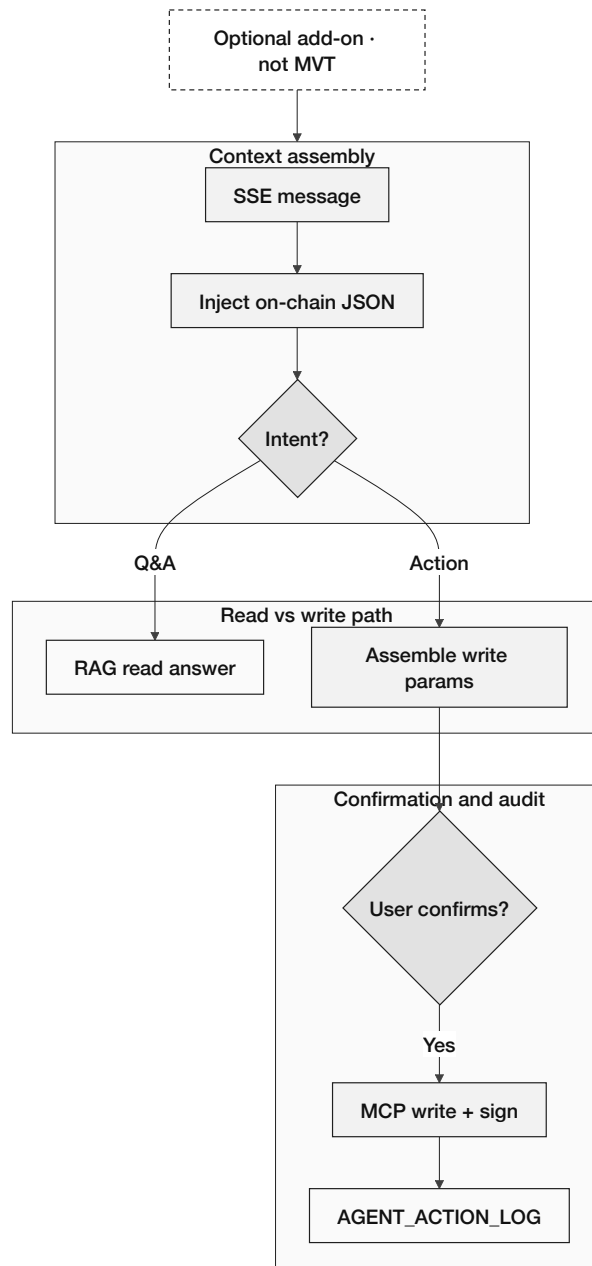


Figure 3.12: Five-stage retail onboarding funnel

3.8.4 Optional Conversational Interface (Add-On)

The MCP agent is an **optional add-on**—same APIs and contracts as the web UI, never required for banking. Figure 3.13 shows the flow: load context, route reads and writes, require human confirmation before any write, then log every action to `AGENT_ACTION_LOG`.

Optional AI Agent Add-On — Six-Step Pipeline (Phase III–IV)

**Figure 3.13:** Optional AI agent add-on (Phase III–IV, excluded from MVT)

3.9 Kinked Interest Rate Model

Borrowing cost follows a kinked utilization model (Compound/Aave pattern [56]) with optimal utilization $U^* = 80\%$ for retail pools. Utilization is $U = L/(L + B)$, where L is lent amount and B is available liquidity.

Below the kink ($U \leq U^*$), the rate rises gently:

$$r_b(U) = r_0 + \frac{U}{U^*} \cdot r_1, \quad U \leq U^* \quad (\text{Formula 18})$$

At $U = 0$ the rate is base r_0 ; at $U = U^*$ it reaches $r_0 + r_1$ (r_1 = below-kink slope).

Above the kink ($U > U^*$), the rate rises steeply to incentivise repayment and new deposits:

$$r_b(U) = r_0 + r_1 + \frac{U - U^*}{1 - U^*} \cdot r_2, \quad U > U^* \quad (\text{Formula 19})$$

r_2 is the jump multiplier above the kink. On-chain guards enforce $r_2 \geq \text{MINIMUM_JUMP_MULTIPLIER}$ and $U_{\text{star}} \leq \text{MAXIMUM_KINK_POINT}$ before any parameter update.

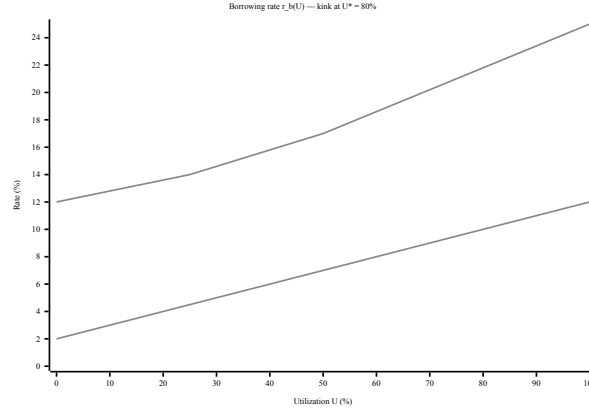


Figure 3.14: Kinked utilization-based borrowing rate

3.10 Liquidation Engine

The **LiquidationEngine** contract monitors health factor (HF) and pays third-party liquidators a 5–8% bonus when $HF < 1.0$. HF models vary by loan type:

Tier 4 over-collateralized retail.

$$HF = \frac{C \times LT}{D} \quad (3.1)$$

Collateral value C (oracle-priced) times liquidation threshold LT , divided by debt D ; liquidate when $HF < 1.0$.

Tier 4 group lending.

$$HF_{\text{group}} = \frac{\text{total_group_collateral} \times LT}{\text{total_group_outstanding_debt}} \quad (3.2)$$

Pool-level health score; liquidation loss is shared across all group members.

Tier 4 credit-based (no collateral). HF is not applicable. Default triggers SBT riskTier downgrade and lastDefault timestamp [69]; no collateral to seize.

Tier 1–3 institutional.

$$HF_{\text{inst}} = \frac{\text{on_chain_reserve} - \text{min_reserve}}{\text{outstanding_borrowing}} \quad (3.3)$$

Parent-tier reserve surplus above the mandatory minimum acts as effective collateral.

Liquidation life-cycle.

1. Chainlink price feed updates collateral each block; HF recomputed (view-only).
2. Any participant calls `liquidate(loanId)` when $HF < 1.0$.
3. Contract transfers debt plus 5–8% bonus in collateral to the liquidator; credit record updated.
4. `LoanLiquidated(loanId, liquidator, bonusBps)` event indexed by The Graph.

When a Local Bank's reserve ratio falls below 15%, authorized liquidations queue at National Bank level, lowest HF first.

LiquidationEngine — Tier-Specific Health Factor and Lifecycle

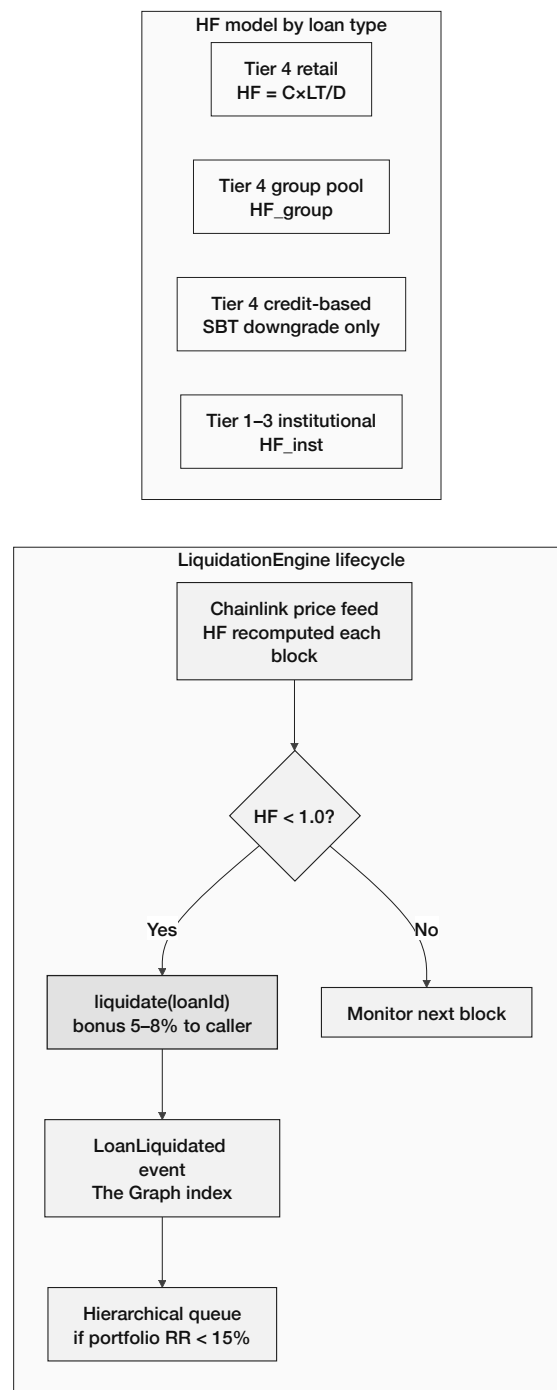


Figure 3.15: LiquidationEngine tier models and lifecycle

3.11 SavingsVault and FixedDeposit Modules

SavingsVault. Users deposit USDC (or other ERC-20 tokens) and earn variable interest based on pool usage (Section 3.9). Withdrawals are allowed only if the Local Bank still meets its reserve rule. Interest accrues every second via a cumulative index (Compound/Aave pattern); the vault uses ERC-4626 so shares work with other DeFi tools [82].

FixedDeposit. Users lock funds for 30, 90, 180, or 365 days at a fixed APY and receive a non-transferable receipt. Early withdrawal forfeits accrued interest. Fixed terms align deposit duration with installment lending; redemptions follow the ERC-7540 time-gated pattern [82].

Loan interest is split (Formula NetInterest) between depositors, the InsuranceFund, and protocol revenue—funding savings and lending without outside subsidies.

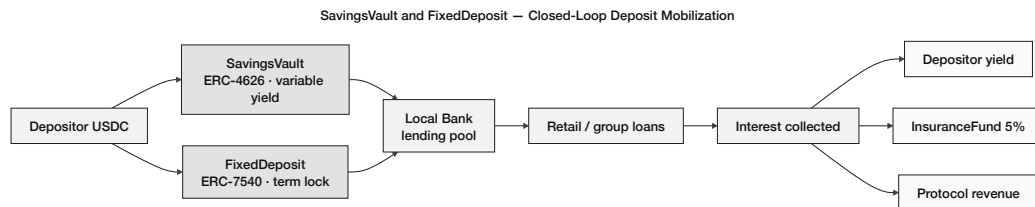


Figure 3.16: SavingsVault and FixedDeposit closed loop

3.12 On-Chain Credit Passport (Soulbound Token)

Each KYC-verified client receives a non-transferable Soulbound Token (SBT) [69] encoding repayment history (creditScore, openLoans, completedCycles, lastDefault, riskTier). The credential upgrades on full installment repayment and is permanently downgraded (never revoked) on default. It enables portable credit across Local Banks, enforces cross-platform simultaneous-loan caps (Section 3.17.3), and is exposed read-only via `ICreditPassport.getScore(wallet)` for external protocols and cross-chain mirroring (Section 3.13).

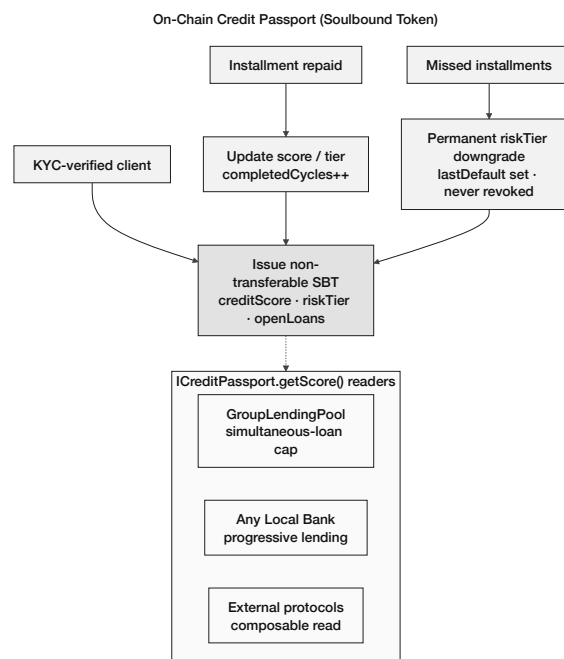


Figure 3.17: On-chain Credit Passport SBT lifecycle

Credit tier schedule. Table 3.5 governs maximum loan limits and interest modifiers by tier.

Table 3.19: Credit Passport tier schedule

Tier	Label	Score Range	Max (USDC)	Loan	Interest Modifier
1	Bronze	0–299	50		Base rate
2	Silver	300–549	250		Base – 0.5%
3	Gold	550–749	1,000		Base – 1.0%
4	Platinum	750–899	5,000		Base – 1.5%
5	Diamond	900–1000	25,000		Base – 2.0%

3.13 Cross-Chain Bridge Architecture

The prototype spans Polygon zkEVM Cardona and Ethereum Sepolia. Without shared cross-chain state, a client could bypass borrowing limits by opening loans on two chains—so the bridge design is explicit, not assumed.

Bridge protocol selection. One audited bridge handles all cross-chain messages. The spec uses Chainlink CCIP because oracles, FX feeds, and automation already run on Chainlink (Section 3.3.2)—one provider for the full stack. Bridge exploits caused the largest crypto losses in 2022–2024; a single trusted bridge suits a thesis prototype.

Cross-chain hierarchy invariant. Each client’s loans stay on one chain—their Local Bank’s home chain. Cross-chain traffic is limited to reserve-ratio updates and read-only Credit Passport mirroring. Borrowing limits remain single-chain, avoiding cross-chain debt consensus.

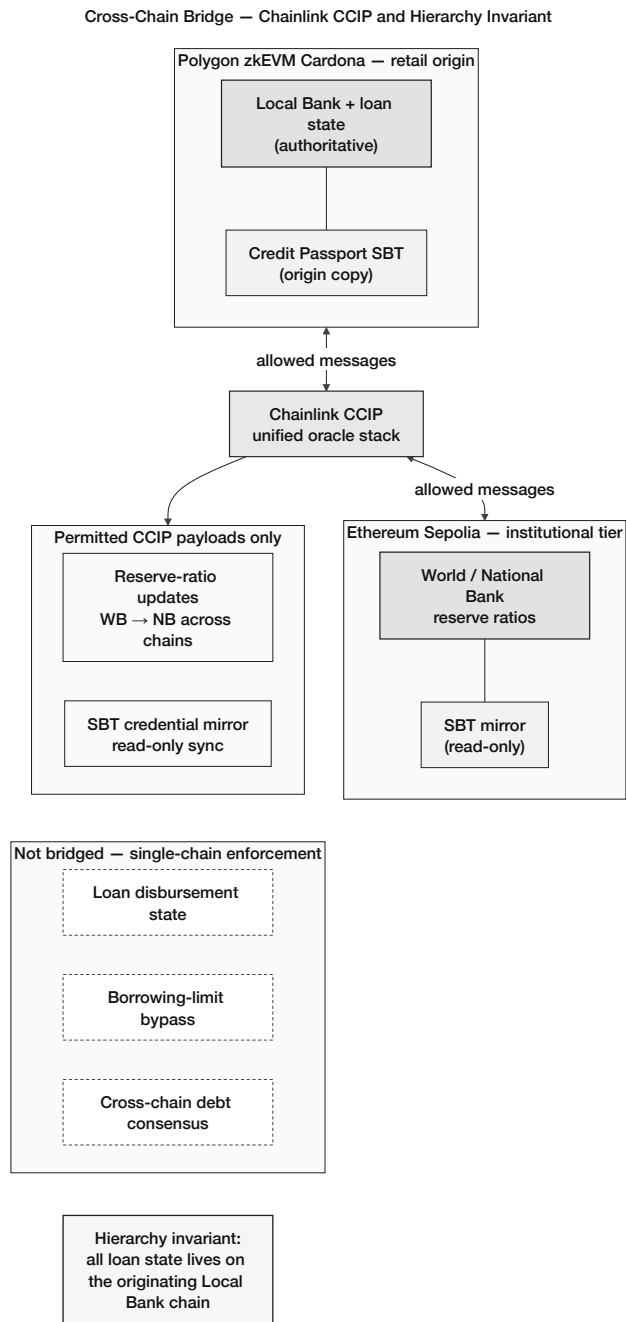


Figure 3.18: Chainlink CCIP cross-chain hierarchy invariant

3.14 Multi-Entity and Cross-Tier Capital Operations

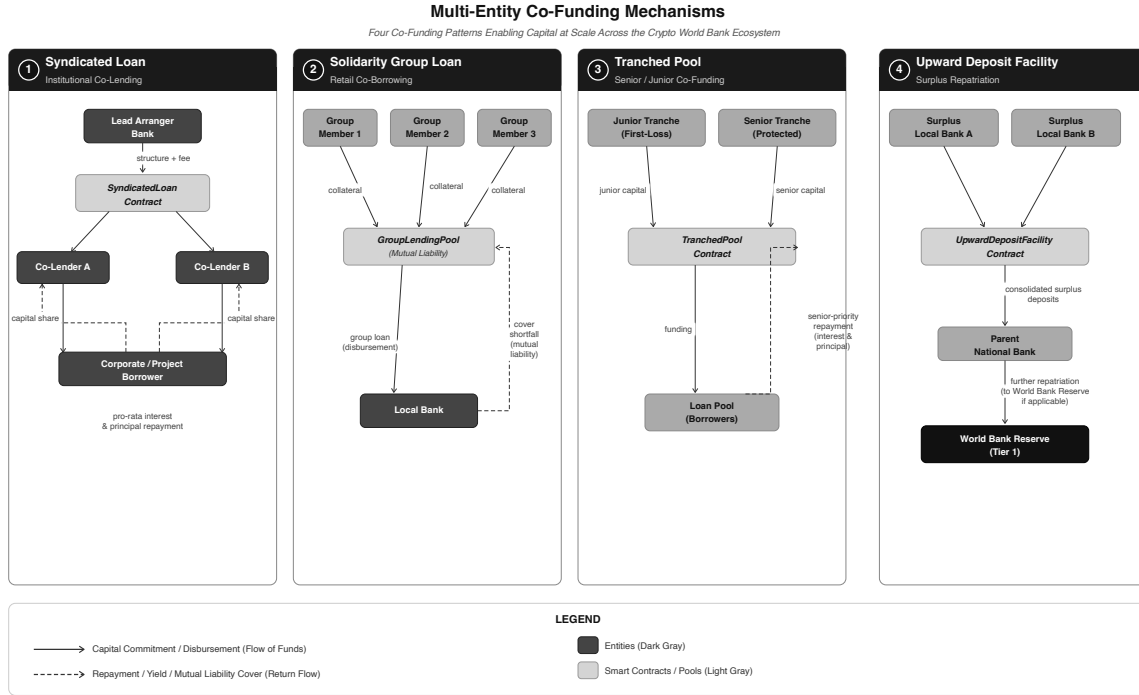


Figure 3.19: Multi-entity and cross-tier capital operations

Chapter 1 promised lending in all directions—downward, same-tier, upward—plus syndication for large loans. Earlier drafts only sketched same-tier and upward flows. This section specifies six modules at the same depth as downward lending: InterBankLendingPool (Section 3.14), upward surplus deposits (Section 3.14), syndicated lending (Section 3.14), senior–junior tranches (Section 3.14), treasury FX swaps (Section 3.14), and multilateral netting (Section 3.14). Matching ERD entities and phase plans are defined downstream for a consistent system.

3.14.1 InterBankLendingPool: Fully Specified Same-Tier Lending

Each tier gets one InterBankLendingPool (IBLP_NB, IBLP_LB) where peer banks lend USDC to each other for 1, 7, or 30 days. Only banks with an active tier role may participate (Section 3.19).

Rate model. The interbank rate $r_{IB}(U)$ uses the kinked curve from Section 3.9 (Formulas 18–19) with kink $U_{IB}^* = 0.90$, capped below the parent-tier downward rate:

$$r_{IB}(U) \leq r_{\text{downward}}(U) - \delta \quad (3.4)$$

δ is a governance spread that prevents arbitrage against the tier above; enforced live via `getCurrentBorrowRate()`.

Default cascade. On default at maturity: reserve buffer first, then InsuranceFund, then parent tier absorbs the rest and queues role suspension via TimeLock.

3.14.2 Upward Surplus Repatriation

Banks holding reserves 20% above the minimum may park surplus with their parent tier through UpwardDepositFacility and earn deposit yield. The upward rate stays below the downward rate:

$$r_{\text{up}} < r_{\text{down}} - \delta \quad (3.5)$$

Withdrawals fail if they drop the bank below its reserve minimum; daily caps are 20% of upward liabilities; total upward exposure is capped at 30% of on-chain assets.

3.14.3 Syndicated and Club Lending

When one bank cannot cover a large loan alone, several banks co-fund it via SyndicatedLoan—Lead Arranger, Co-Lenders, and Borrower (client through a Local Bank). Funding needs $\geq 90\%$ committed and $\geq 75\%$ Co-Lender approval by capital share. Each lender's shareBps determines its pro-rata share of principal, interest, and recovery.

3.14.4 Senior–Junior Tranched Lending Pools

TranchedPool splits capital into senior (safer, lower yield) and junior (higher yield, first-loss) tranches. Repayments flow senior interest $\rightarrow$ junior interest $\rightarrow$ senior principal $\rightarrow$ junior principal; losses hit junior first. The junior/senior ratio is set at deposit between 10/90 and 30/70.

3.14.5 Cross-Tier Treasury FX Swap

TreasurySwap lets banking-role wallets swap assets atomically at oracle prices:

$$\text{Amount}_{\text{to}} = \text{Amount}_{\text{from}} \times \frac{P_{\text{from}}}{P_{\text{to}}} \times (1 - \text{spread}) \quad (3.6)$$

P is the Chainlink price; spread is 5–10 bps. Post-swap reserves must stay above the tier minimum; swaps over \$1M need Safe two-signature approval.

3.14.6 Multilateral Settlement Netting Engine

NettingEngine batches bilateral IBLP and TreasurySwap debts into one settlement. Netting cuts $O(n^2)$ bilateral transfers to $O(n)$ via a Merkle-root settleBatch call. If a bank cannot pay its net debit, settlePartial settles the rest and queues the shortfall for the next cycle or the IBLP default cascade (Section 3.14). A WORLD_BANK_ADMIN Safe acts as off-chain Settlement Coordinator.

3.14.7 Database, Phase, and Contract Consistency for Multi-Entity Operations

Eight ERD entities extend Figure 3.6; six contracts complete the 15-contract architecture—Phase II deploys InterBankLendingPool, UpwardDepositFacility, and SyndicatedLoan; Phase III adds TranchedPool, TreasurySwap, and NettingEngine.

3.15 System Modeling

This section presents the system analysis diagrams that model the platform's structure, behavior, and data flow. Loan and transaction state transitions are formalised in the on-chain state machine of Section 4.11; the diagrams below show actor interactions and operational flows at the use-case and sequence level.

3.15.1 Use Case Diagram

The system involves nine actors across 20 representative use cases (Figure 3.20). Four **core primary** actors initiate banking operations: Retail Client (A1, three KYC sub-types), Local Bank Admin (A2), National Bank Admin (A3), and World Bank Admin (A4). A5 (AI Agent) is an **optional add-on** actor with restricted write permissions gated by the human confirmation protocol; it is shown in the diagram for completeness but is excluded from MVT scope (Table ??). Four secondary actors are external systems or authorities: Regulatory Authority (A6), Chainlink DON (A7), Blockchain Validator (A8), and External Auditor (A9). Note that the primary actor classes in the use-case diagram are a condensation of the formal nine-actor taxonomy defined in Table ??: Visitor and Registered Retail User are pre-conditions for the CLIENT (BORROWER) role rather than independent diagram actors, and Local Bank Operator / Approver are merged into the Bank Approver role at the diagram level.

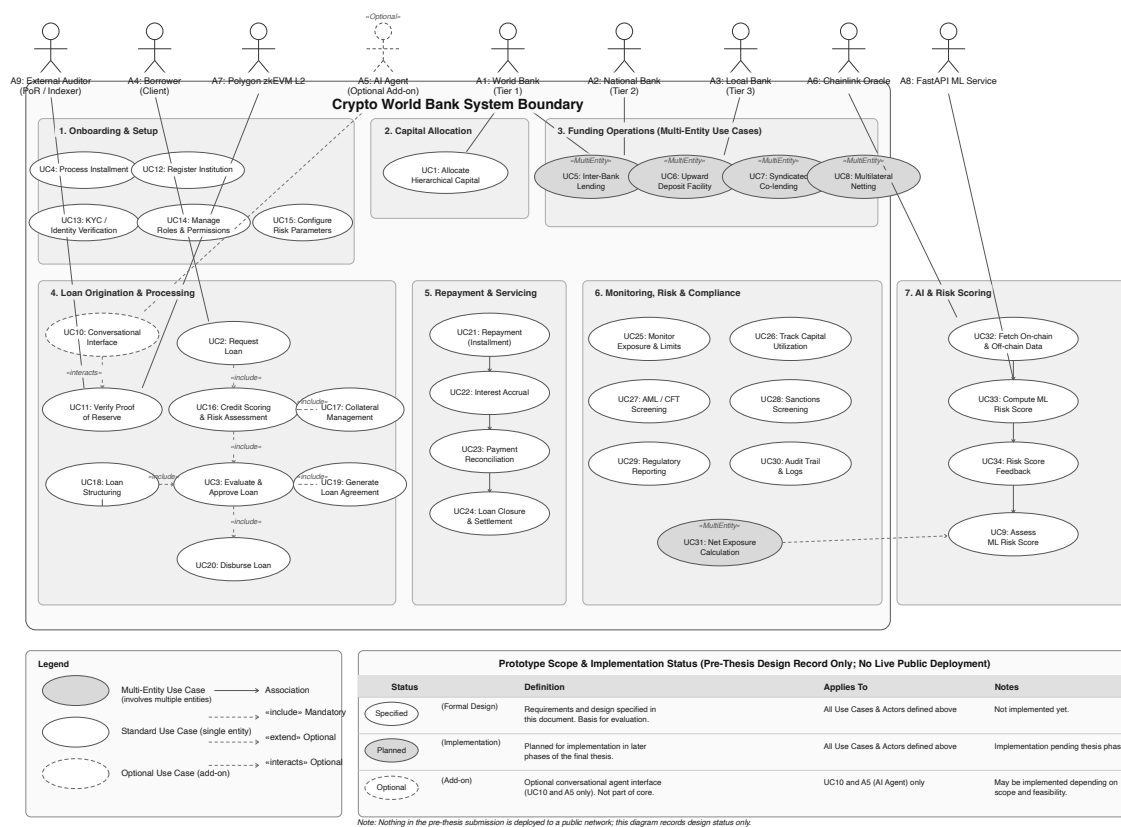


Figure 3.20: Use-case diagram (nine-actor taxonomy)

3.15.2 Activity Diagrams

Figures 3.21–3.23 present three end-to-end activity flows aligned with the phase plan (Section 4.1): Phase II eligibility and origination, Phase III oracle-mediated scoring (specified at pre-thesis 1, implemented after pre-thesis 2), and optional agent paths excluded from MVT. Each diagram has a single start and a single end node; decision diamonds route exceptional paths (limit exceeded, rejection, verification retry) back to the terminal state without spawning parallel lifelines.

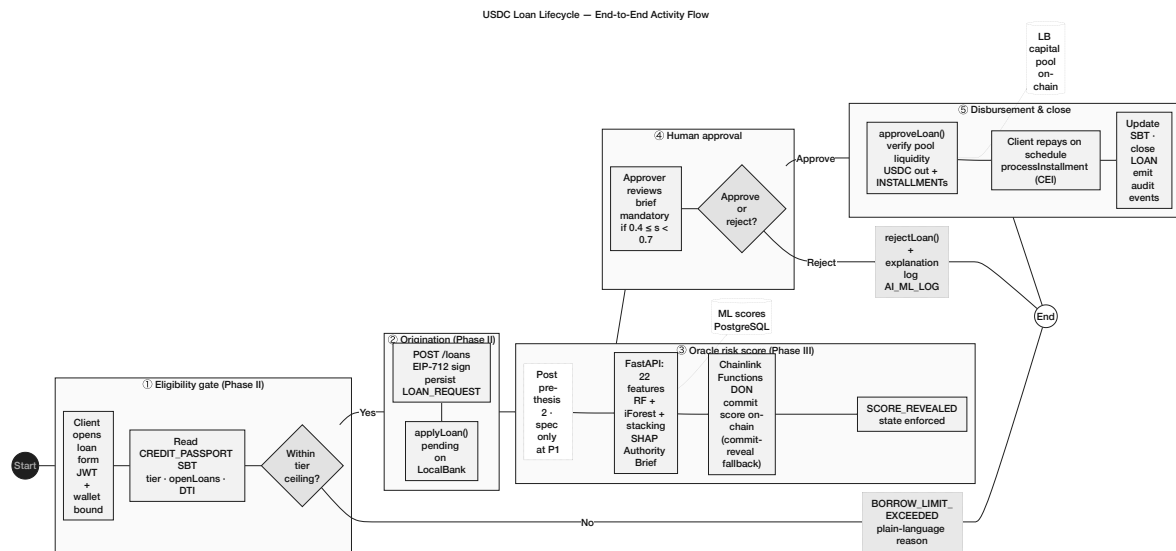


Figure 3.21: USDC loan lifecycle activity flow

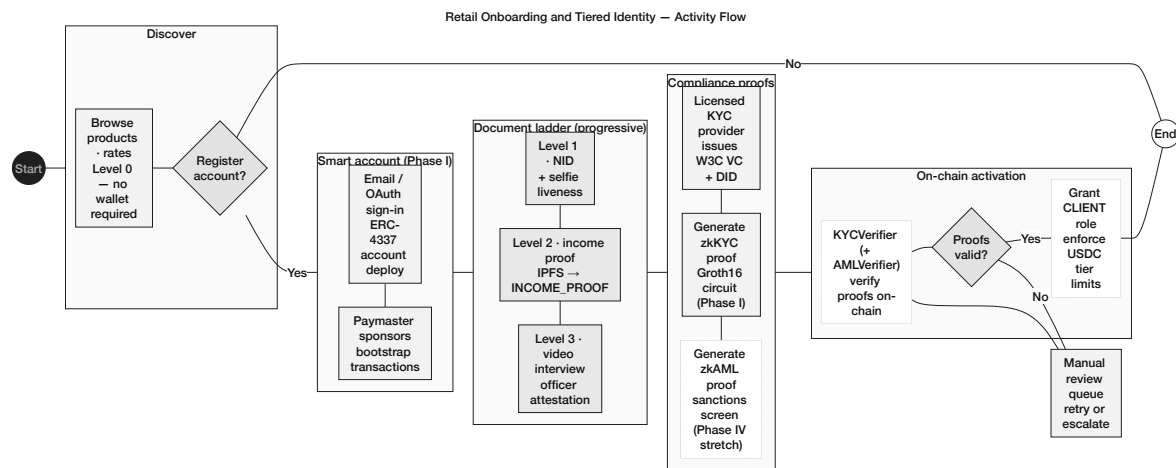


Figure 3.22: Retail onboarding and identity activity flow

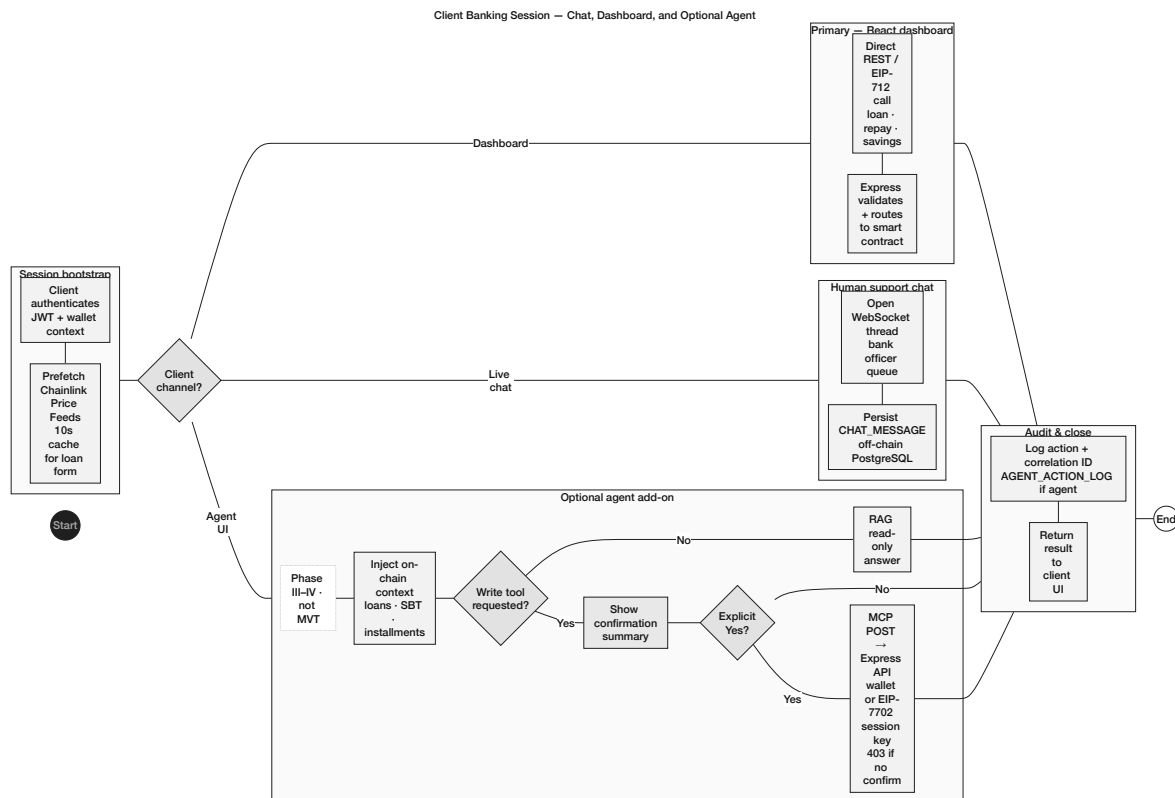


Figure 3.23: Client banking session activity flow

SAR activity flow. The Suspicious Activity Report (SAR) workflow is triggered when the Isolation Forest anomaly detector (Section 3.20) flags a wallet with an anomaly score above the 0.75 threshold. The five-step flow is:

1. Isolation Forest flags the wallet: $\text{anomaly_score} > 0.75$.
2. `AI_ML_LOG` records the detection event (wallet, score, timestamp, feature vector).
3. Express.js backend emits a planned event-bus message (`aml-alert` topic); the compliance dashboard consumes it.
4. Bank officer reviews the alert in the admin compliance queue:
 - **False positive:** Dismiss and document reason (audit trail in `audit_logs`).
 - **Confirmed:** Generate SAR record in `audit_logs`; notify the tier above (National Bank); freeze wallet via `LocalBank.freezeAccount(clientId)`.
5. The `freezeAccount` function is gated by the `onlyApprover` modifier and is Foundry-tested (Phase III invariant suite). A frozen wallet cannot initiate new loan disbursements or installment payments until the freeze is lifted by the tier above.

3.15.3 Data Flow Diagrams

Figure 3.24 consolidates the Level-0 context diagram with the Level-1 decompositions of the core lending subsystem and the deposit / interbank / FX / netting subsystems on a single page.

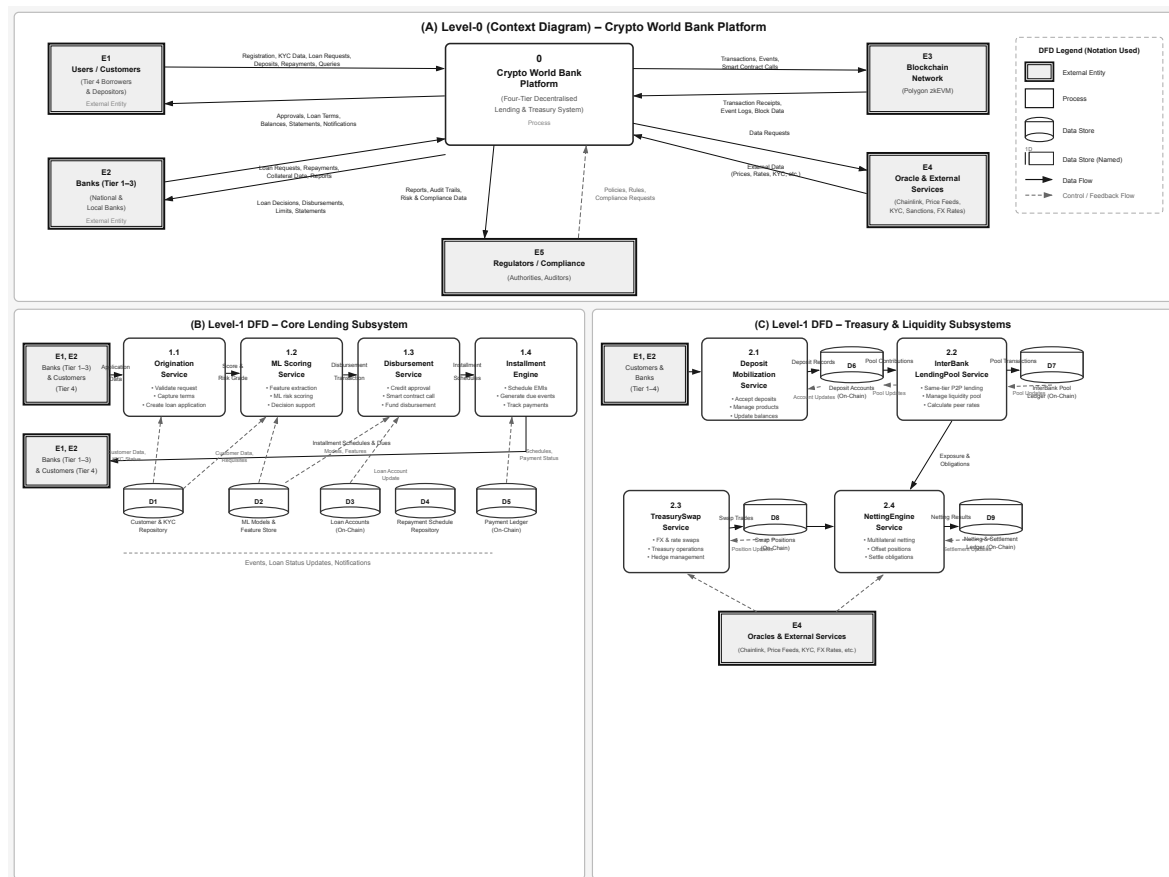


Figure 3.24: Data-flow diagrams

3.15.4 Sequence Diagrams

Figures 3.25–3.28 consolidate the platform’s nine interaction flows into four panels: loan approval with reject alternative, installment and income, hierarchical banking with market data and borrowing-limit, and chat with AI-chatbot.

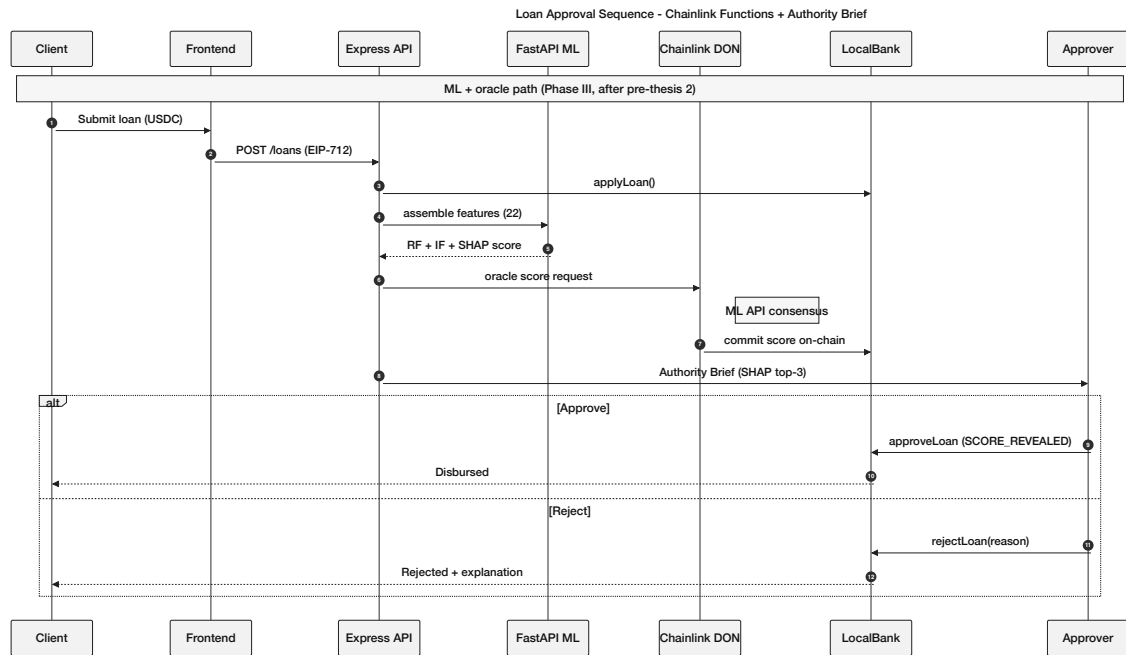


Figure 3.25: Loan approval sequence diagram

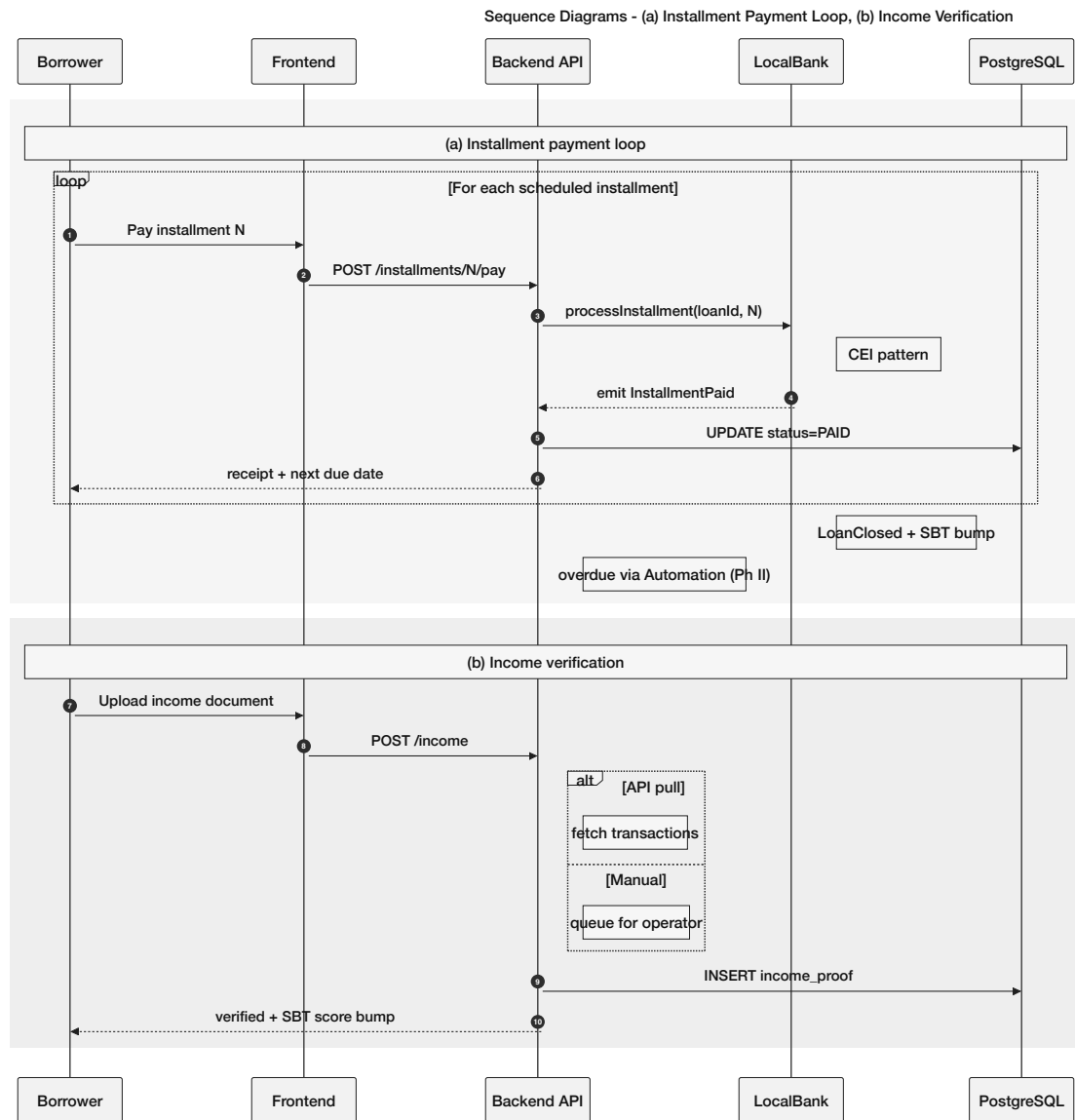


Figure 3.26: Sequence diagrams

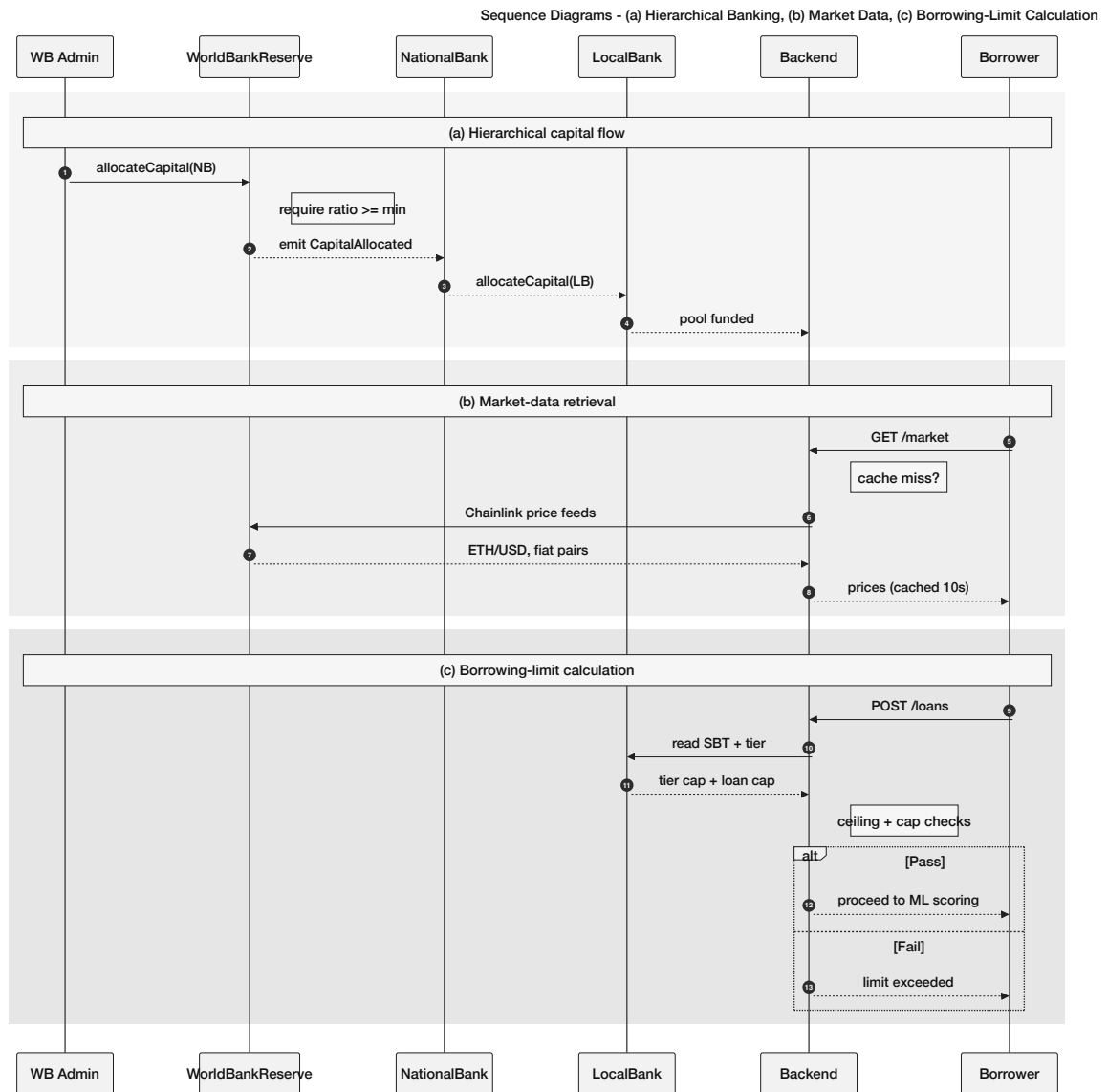


Figure 3.27: Sequence diagrams

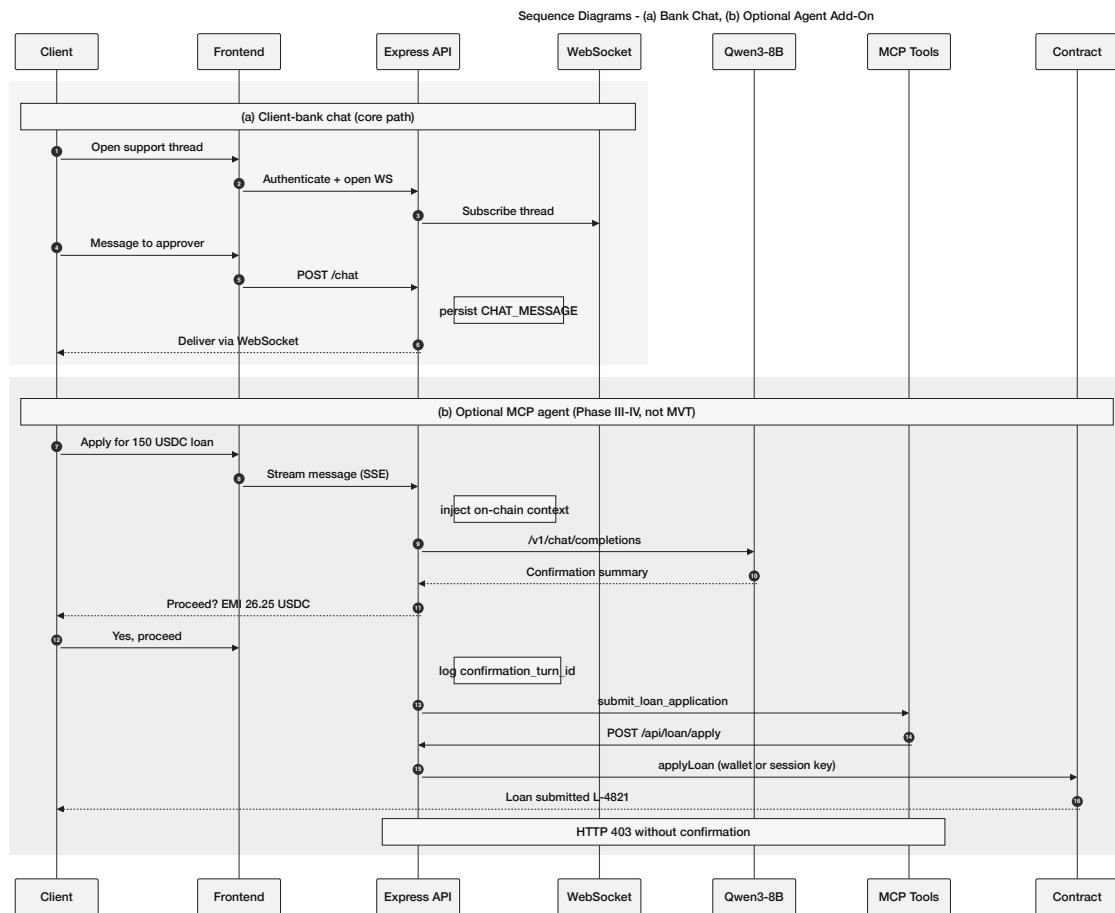


Figure 3.28: Sequence diagrams

3.15.5 Four-Tier Capital Flow

Figure 3.29 illustrates the hierarchical capital flow and cascading repayment structure.

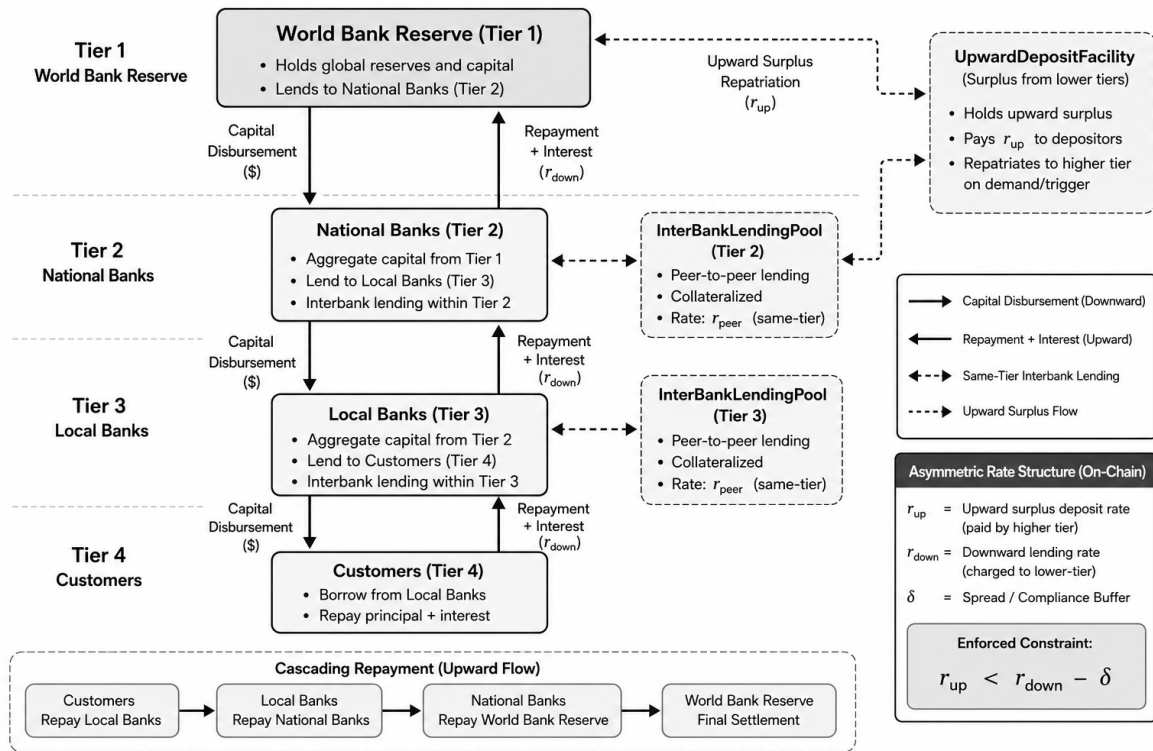


Figure 3.29: Four-tier hierarchical capital flow

3.16 Auxiliary Dual-Currency Facility

The cryptocurrency exchange feature of Crypto World Bank is built upon the cryptocurrency exchange facility that is an auxiliary facility incorporated into the current banking infrastructures all over the world. Instead of being a separate exchange, the platform is a service that is provided by all participating banks as an additional service to the existing product portfolio.

- **Integration model:** The dual-currency facility is offered by all participating banks as an add-on service to their existing product portfolio. No additional banking license or separate entity is needed.
- **Eligibility determination:** Eligibility of the dual-currency service is based on the bank officers managing the lending operations, on the basis of existing KYC/AML compliance, account status, and lending relationship history.
- **No defaulting of conditions:** The project does not override, modify, or default any existing banking conditions, regulatory requirements, or contractual obligations.
- **Scope:** The facility enables fiat-to-crypto and crypto-to-fiat conversions, cryptocurrency-denominated lending and repayment, and transparent on-chain transaction records—all within the governance structure of the participating bank.

3.17 Banking Product Suite

3.17.1 Savings Products

Variable-yield savings (utilization-linked; Section 3.9) and fixed-term deposits (30/90/180/365 days; Section 3.11). Interest splits under Formula NetInterest among depositor yield, InsuranceFund, and protocol revenue.

3.17.2 Checking and Transactional Accounts

Non-yield current accounts for installments and transfers; on-chain settlement is atomic (debit and credit in one transaction).

3.17.3 Group / Solidarity Lending

Groups of 3–20 clients borrow via `GroupLendingPool` with shared collateral or a cold-start provisional tier (5 members, Level 1 cap, 3-month expiry). Per-member disbursement:

$$\text{Share}_i = \frac{\text{LoanTotal}}{N_{\text{members}}} \quad (3.7)$$

Default: collateral pool covers shortfall, or SBT `riskTier` downgrade if uncollateralised [69]. Modelled default rate: 8–15% (Table 5.21).

Over-indebtedness risk control. Max two simultaneous group loans (SBT `openLoans`), 30-day cooling-off, and cross-bank check via `ICreditPassport.getScore()`. Debt-to-income gate:

$$\text{DTI} = \frac{\text{existingDebt} + \text{requestedAmount}}{\text{estimatedMonthlyIncome}}, \quad \text{reject if } \text{DTI} > 0.40 \quad (3.8)$$

Stale income hash (> 90 days) triggers manual review. Group loans are USDC-denominated at Tier 4.

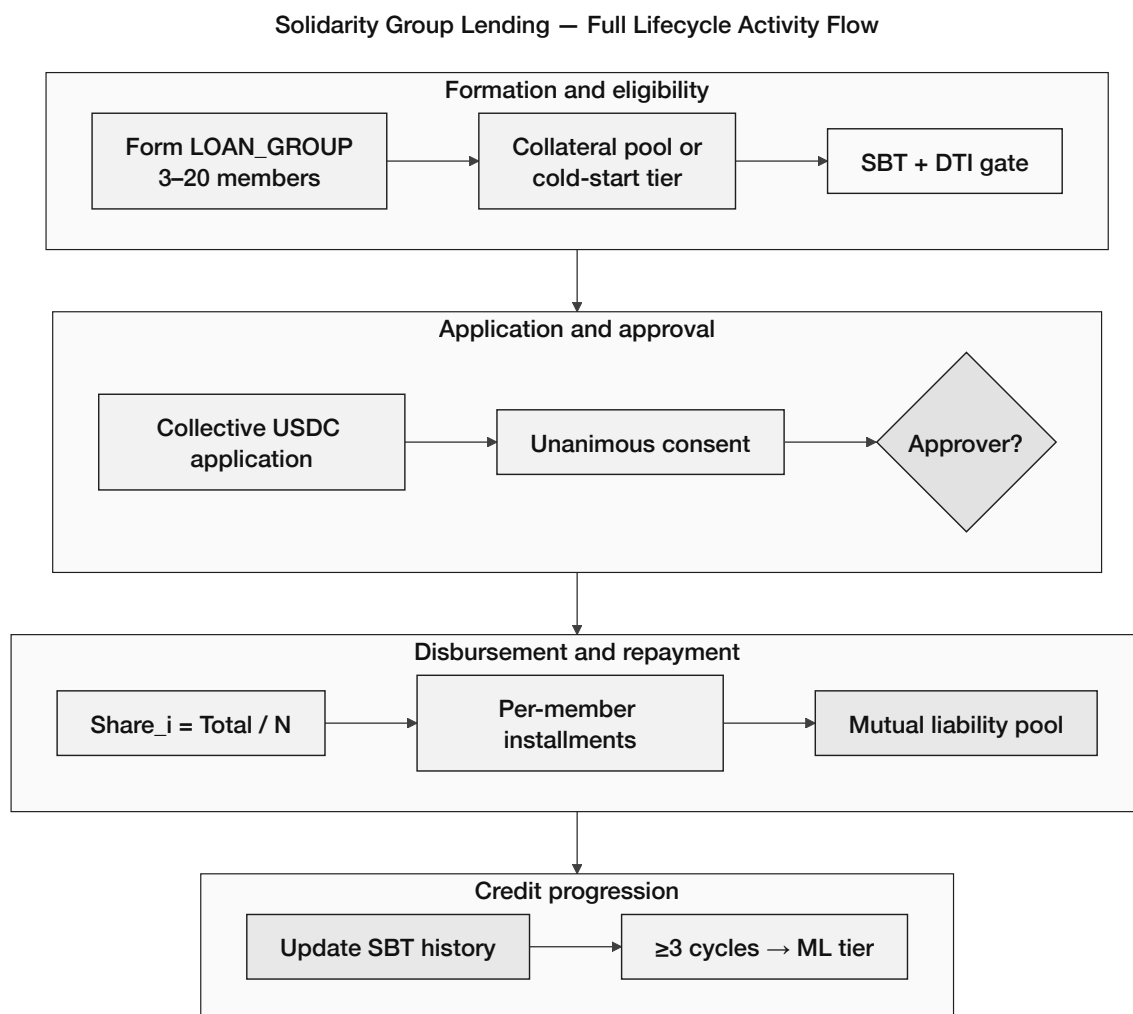


Figure 3.30: Solidarity group lending lifecycle

3.17.4 Foreign Exchange and Multi-Currency Operations

Oracle-priced FX with governance spread; retail lending in stablecoins (USDC/USDT), collateral in volatile assets (ETH). Treasury swaps: Section 3.14.

3.17.5 Trade Finance Facilitation (Planned)

Escrow-based letters of credit with document-verified release (Future Work). Importers and exporters would lock payment in on-chain escrow; funds release only after shipping or customs documents pass approver or oracle checks. The module extends cross-border settlement (Section 3.14) and is scheduled after core lending and treasury products in Phase III+.

3.17.6 Privacy-Preserving Identity Compliance (Planned)

Licensed off-chain KYC issues a verifiable credential; on-chain zkKYC/zkAML proof sets `kycVerified` without storing PII (Section 3.7.1). At onboarding, wallets submit two proofs—identity (KYC circuit) and sanctions screening (zkAML circuit)—before the CLIENT role activates. Raw documents remain with the licensed provider; the chain stores only proof hashes and role flags.

3.18 Governance Framework

3.18.1 Governance Execution Paths and Emergency Controls

Parameter changes and upgrades route through a 24–48 h TimelockController (5 min in lab demo). Emergency path: 4-of-7 Security Council Safe may pause, upgrade, or revoke roles within 2 h (mandatory 48 h disclosure); cannot change system parameters.

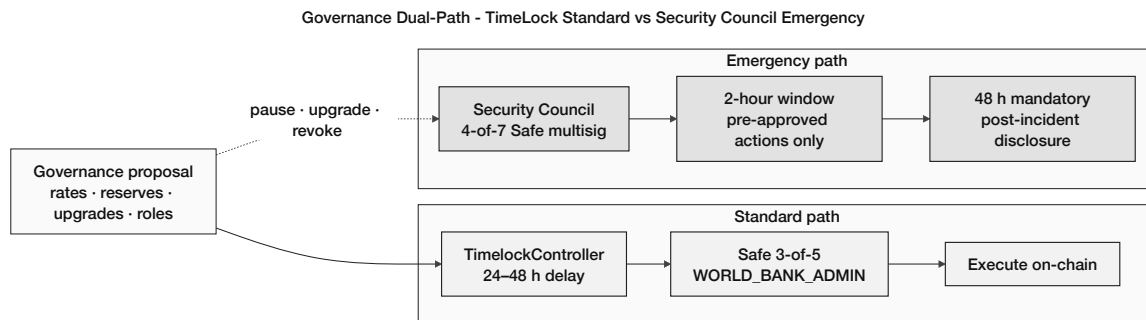


Figure 3.31: Governance dual-path

3.18.2 Network Membership Governance

Table 3.20: Network membership governance

Governance Aspect	Implementation
Member on-boarding	World Bank owner registers National Banks; National Banks register Local Banks; Local Banks designate approvers — all enforced on-chain.
Member off-boarding	Deactivation flags in smart contracts; cascading access revocation.
Regulatory oversight	Audit log emission via smart contract events; planned read-only regulator dashboard.
Permission structure	Hierarchical: Owner → National Bank → Local Bank → Approver → Retail Client; enforced by on-chain role check modifiers.
Network operations	Pause/unpause mechanism for emergency response; emergency withdrawal for critical situations.

3.18.3 Business Network Governance

Table 3.22: Business network governance

Governance Aspect	Implementation
Business charter	Defined in project documentation; operational parameters coded in smart contract constants.
Common services	Reserve management, loan lifecycle orchestration, event-driven notification system.
Business SLA	Testnet phase: best-effort availability. Production phase: 99.5% target API-layer uptime (team-controlled; multi-region deployment). Chain-level liveness is determined by Polygon zkEVM batch submission and Ethereum L1 proof verification; the team monitors network status and maintains degraded-mode fallbacks (read-only dashboard) if chain activity pauses.
Regulatory compliance	Architecture designed for audit trail generation; data partitioning supports GDPR-style data subject requests.

3.18.4 Technology Infrastructure Governance

Table 3.24: Technology infrastructure governance

Governance Aspect	Implementation
Distributed IT structure	Client-side frontend (decentralised delivery); blockchain layer (fully decentralised); backend API (centralised, horizontally scalable).
Technology assessment	Continuous evaluation of EVM alternatives (L2 rollups, sidechains) for cost and performance optimisation.
On-chain / off-chain data services	Clearly partitioned (see Table ??); event listeners synchronise state between layers.
Risk mitigation	Smart contract pause mechanism; ReentrancyGuard; input validation; planned formal security audit.

3.18.5 Regulatory Compliance Considerations

Prototype runs on public testnets only; architecture emits audit logs for sandbox review; production targets regulatory sandbox programmes. zkKYC design: Section 3.17.6. SAR path: Isolation Forest → compliance queue → freezeAccount (Section 3.15).

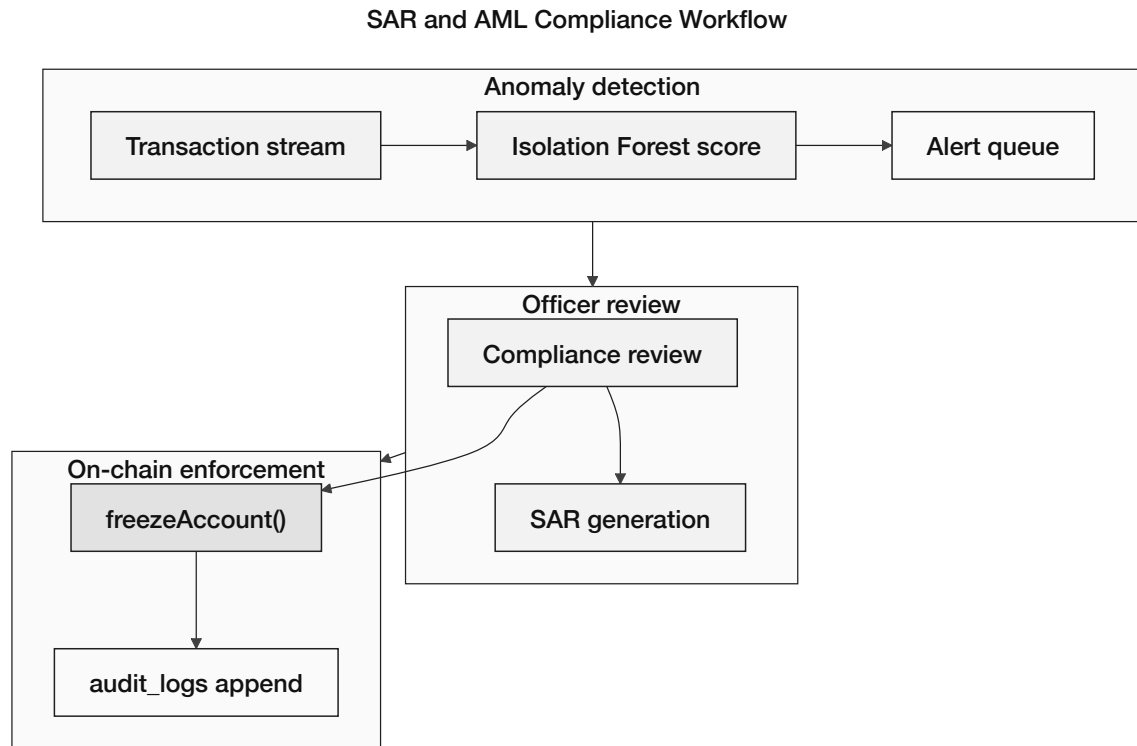


Figure 3.32: SAR and AML compliance workflow

3.18.6 Asset Tokenization

- **Specified (Phase I):** Native blockchain currency (ETH) as reserve and loan currency on testnet.
- **Planned extension:** ERC-20 stablecoins (USDC, USDT) for lending operations; tokenized collateral instruments where collateral is insufficient.

3.19 Five-Layer Defense-in-Depth Security Architecture

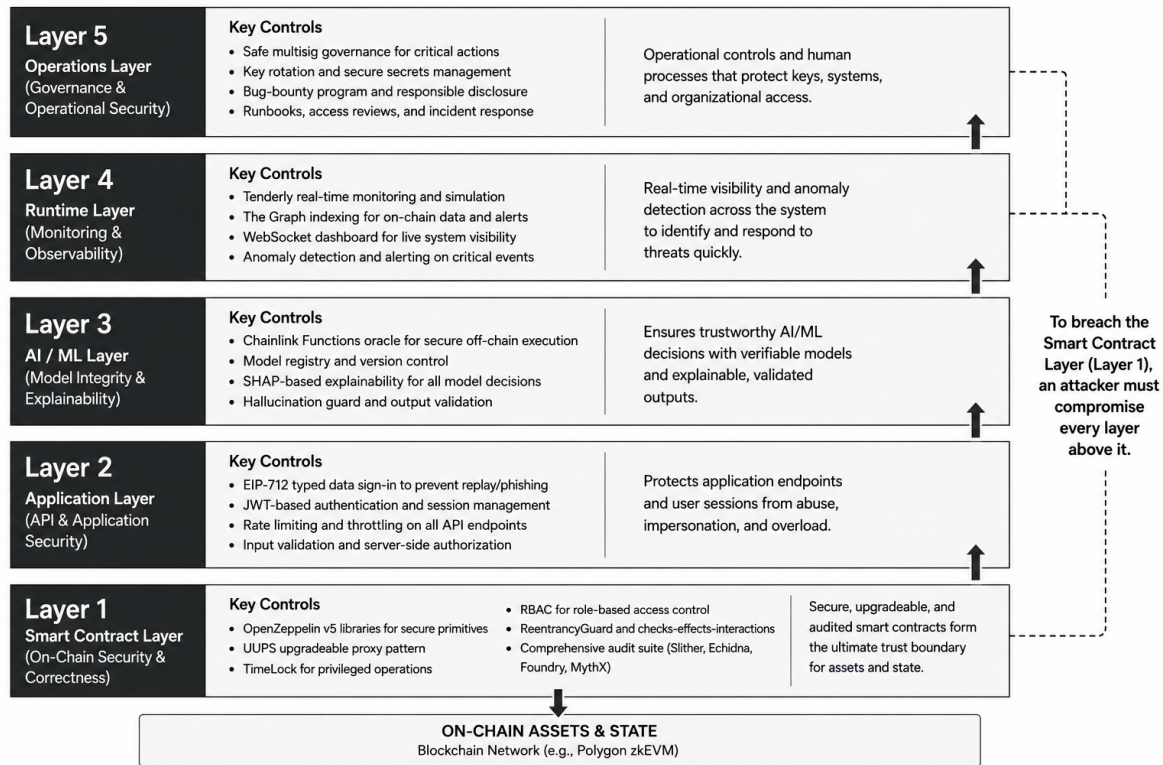


Figure 3.33: Five-layer defense-in-depth security architecture

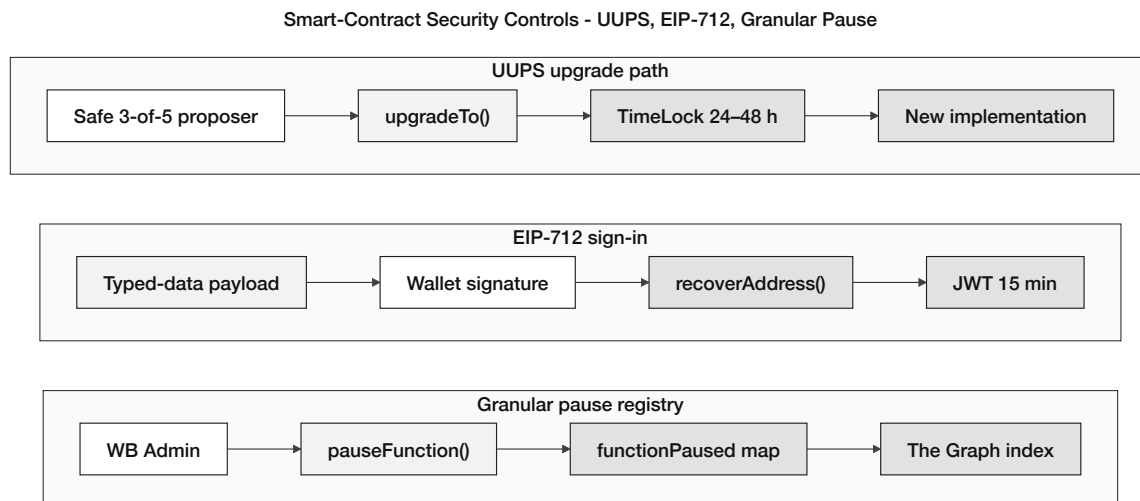


Figure 3.34: Smart-contract security controls

The correct mental model for a blockchain banking platform's security is not "smart-contract security only"—it is a five-layer defense-in-depth stack in which breaching the contract layer requires defeating every layer above it. The Crypto World Bank adopts the following layered model, summarized in Table ?? and inspired by current (2025–2026) audit-tooling and runtime-monitoring best practice from Trail of Bits, Cyfrin, Tenderly, and OpenZeppelin Defender.

Table 3.26: Five-layer defense-in-depth model

Layer	Component	CWB Design Choice
L5	Operational security	Safe (Gnosis) 2-of-3 multisig for WorldBankAdmin; 3-of-5 for global parameter changes; documented key-rotation schedule; hardware-wallet signer for the WorldBankAdmin Safe (Ledger Gen5).
L4	Runtime monitoring	Tenderly alerts on six critical triggers (large disbursement, repeated requests, reserve-ratio drop below 20%, failed disburseLoan, role grants, governance pause); The Graph subgraph for indexed event history; transaction simulation pre-deployment.
L3	AI/ML security	Random Forest fraud probability + Isolation Forest anomaly score + SHAP explanation per loan, delivered via commit-reveal oracle; transaction-graph distance to flagged wallets; GNN-based wallet-graph clustering for relational fraud (Section 4.5). <i>Note: session-level behavioral biometrics (page-view timing, terms-acceptance latency) require client-side instrumentation not yet in the schema and are a specified Future Work extension.</i>
L2	Application security	EIP-712 wallet-signed JWT (15-minute lifetime + refresh); slowapi rate limiting (5/min auth, 60/min reads, 10/min writes); Pydantic input range constraints; strict CORS and Content-Security-Policy; environment-variable secret hygiene; prompt injection scanning middleware on all user-sourced fields before context assembly (see below).
L1	Smart contract security	OpenZeppelin ReentrancyGuard; CEI pattern; Solidity 0.8.20 overflow protection; RBAC with role expiry; UUPS upgrade with Safe-multisig authorization; TimeLock on governance actions; granular per-function pause; four-tool audit pipeline (Slither, Mythril, Echidna, Halmos/Certora); Foundry fuzz + invariants.

The L1 contract layer is discussed in detail below; Section 3.20 expands the threat model to span all five layers and motivates the specific controls listed in Table ??.

3.19.1 Smart Contract Security Controls

The controls below protect the three core lending contracts (Figure 3.34; Layer L1 in Table ??). Related application and operational safeguards are included where they touch on-chain state.

- **Checks-Effects-Interactions (CEI).** Update contract state before any external transfer. `disburseLoan`, `processInstallment`, and `allocateCapital` each use `nonReentrant` and follow check → update → transfer order. Reentrancy remains an active threat [7]; Certora or Mythril verification is planned for the final audit.
- **Flash-loan protection.** Flash loans mainly attack price-based collateral [57]. Pre-thesis exposure is limited; Phase II–III adds TWAP oracles, multi-block confirmation on large collateral moves, and Chainlink feeds with circuit breakers.
- **UUPS upgrades (ERC-1822).** All contracts use OpenZeppelin UUPS. Only `WORLD_BANK_ADMIN`—held by a Safe 3-of-5 multisig—may call `_authorizeUpgrade` (Section 3.19).
- **Role expiry.** Every `grantRole` sets an expiry block; privileged calls require `roleExpiryBlock > block.number`. Block numbers are used instead of timestamps to reduce SWC-116 manipulation risk.
- **Per-function pause.** Governance can pause one function at a time (e.g. suspend `LOAN_DISBURSEMENT` while deposits stay open). Each pause emits `FunctionPaused` for The Graph indexing (Section 4.10).
- **Agent lockout and address whitelist.** Three failed confirmation replies in one agent session trigger a 10-minute pause and a `FAILED` log in `AGENT_ACTION_LOG`. Injection attempts end the session. Disbursement addresses are fixed at KYC and need 24-hour delay plus 2FA to change.
- **Prompt injection scanning (L2).** Before user text enters the LLM context, middleware scans for injection phrases (`ignore previous instructions`, `tool-override strings`, `JSON escapes`). Flagged fields are sanitised and `injection_scan_flag` is set. Applies to language preference, income uploads, and recent chat turns—addressing OWASP LLM01 [88] and banking-agent risks [87].
- **Per-tier admin keys (L5).** `WorldBankAdmin` is never a single wallet—even the lab demo uses Safe 2-of-3 before testnet deploy (demo machine, phone, supervisor backup). National and Local Bank admins also use Safe 2-of-3. Only retail `CLIENT` roles may use EOAs, with off-chain social recovery (Section 3.8).
- **SWC Registry mapping.** Every state-changing function in the three core contracts maps to an SWC class [75] and its mitigation. Full table in Appendix B Capability Matrix (Cyfrin audit-checklist format).

3.20 Threat Model and Security Controls

Security threats in smart-contract banking systems are not limited to isolated code defects; they span application-layer attacks (API abuse, JWT theft, social engineering), runtime evasion, and governance-layer key compromise in addition to the contract-layer issues that DeFi literature focuses on. Table 3.6 extends the original threat-model table to the full five-layer scope established in Section 3.19.

Table 3.27: Threat model and security controls mapping

Threat	Layer	Attack Vector	Mitigation
Reentrancy / state manipulation	L1	External calls exploit inconsistent intermediate state	ReentrancyGuard; CEI; Foundry invariant tests.
Arithmetic errors	L1	Integer overflow/underflow in financial math	Solidity 0.8.x checked arithmetic; Certora invariants.
Oracle manipulation	L1	Price-feed manipulation on collateral / FX	Chainlink feeds; heartbeat checks; TWAP; circuit breakers.
Flash-loan economic attacks	L1	Atomic borrowing manipulates on-chain assumptions	Conservative price logic; multi-block confirmation; pause-on-anomaly.
Governance capture	L1+L5	Privileged roles abused for unsafe parameters	Role separation; Safe multisig; TimeLock 24–48 h; audit trail.
Sybil abuse (re-tail / group)	L1+L3	Many wallets bypass limits or fraudulent groups	RBAC; rate limits; ZKP-KYC; GNN wallet-graph clustering.
JWT theft / session hijack	L2	Stolen token gives full account access	15-min JWT; EIP-712 challenge; Redis blacklist; geo rotation.
API abuse / DDoS	L2	Bulk requests exhaust backend services	slowapi limits; CSP/CORS lockdown; correlation IDs.
Input-validation bypass	L2	Malformed inputs cause unintended backend state	Pydantic range constraints; wallet regex; SHA-256 doc refs.
ML evasion / adversarial fraud	L3	Crafted features evade RF / iForest	GNN analysis; federated intelligence; SHAP human review.
LLM hallucination (compliance)	L3	Wrong regulatory answer to client	RAG over policy docs; refusal layer; red-teaming protocol.
Monitoring evasion	L4	Attack split below alert thresholds	Multi-trigger alerts; The Graph forensics history.
Admin-key compromise	L5	EOA compromise gives World Bank control	Safe 2-of-3 / 3-of-5 multisig; hardware-wallet signer.
Blind-signing on hardware wallet	L5	User signs opaque call-data	Calldata decoding; Ledger Multisig; Tenderly pre-simulation.

This expanded threat model is the structural justification for the five-layer architecture in Section 3.19: each row of the table is a vector that the corresponding layer prevents, detects, or recovers from. Application-layer rows (L2) and operational-layer rows (L5) are the largest blind spots in the prior literature on academic DeFi prototypes and are made explicit here.

3.21 Final Specifications and Requirements

Table ?? consolidates the functional, non-functional, and constraint requirements implied by the architecture above and the MVT boundary (Section 4.1). At pre-thesis 1 these are *specified*; post-pre-thesis 2 they are *verified* on testnet.

Table 3.28: Final specifications and requirements

Category	Requirement (summary)
Functional	Four-tier capital flow; loan request → approval → disbursement → repayment; RBAC per tier; reserve-ratio enforcement; optional deposits, group lending, multi-entity flows (Ch. 3).
Non-functional	Public testnet deployment; sub-cent L2 gas per loan lifecycle; EIP-712 + JWT API auth; SHAP-backed ML decision support; append-only audit logs.
Constraints	Testnet tokens only (no real funds); no native governance token in prototype; ML training and live scoring after pre-thesis 2; agent optional (Could).
Compliance targets	MiCA/GENIUS stablecoin use; EU AI Act human oversight for credit scoring (design); FATF Travel Rule for inter-tier transfers >USD 1,000 (Section 3.18.2).

3.22 Societal Impact

CWB is specified for development-finance and inclusion use cases, not a geographic roll-out claim. Three societal effects are central. **Financial inclusion:** tiered KYC and low L2 fees lower barriers for users outside formal banking [9]. **MSME credit access:** hierarchical lending addresses part of the estimated \$4.5 trillion MSME financing gap [15]. **Remittance and transparency:** on-chain settlement can compress remittance fees below the UN 3% SDG target versus $\approx 6.5\%$ corridor averages [20], while published reserves and loan state reduce opacity that harms borrowers in weakly supervised markets. Solidarity group lending draws on microfinance precedent; on-chain mutual liability is *programmable cosigning*, not a replacement for field-based social enforcement (Section 3.17.3).

3.23 Environmental Impact

Environmental footprint is dominated by **compute for blockchain validation**, not physical manufacturing. The prototype targets **Polygon zkEVM Cardona testnet** and Layer 2 execution rather than Ethereum mainnet for routine loan operations, reducing per-transaction energy versus high-fee base-layer batches. Pre-thesis 1 uses **testnet-only** deployments (no production mining load at scale). Off-chain ML runs on a developer machine or Colab; no data-centre SLA is claimed. A full lifecycle assessment (energy per loan vs. correspondent-banking back-office) is deferred to Phase IV simulation outputs (Section 4.9).

3.24 Ethical Issues

This section extends the front-matter Ethics Statement for examiner review (CO12). **No real funds or PII** are processed in pre-thesis 1 (testnet wallets; no live KYC files). **ML is decision support only:** contracts do not auto-disburse on model output; approvers must sign; SHAP and audit logs support human review (Section 4.3.2). **Bias and cold-start:** fraud models may underperform on new wallets; BCCC benchmarks are a baseline, not CWB ground truth. **Optional agent:** write tools require explicit user confirmation; excluded from MVT. **Future privacy:** ZKP KYC is designed to prove eligibility without posting identity on-chain (Section 3.7.1). Residual gaps (full EU AI Act conformity file, production AML) are named in Section 5.14.

Chapter 4

Methodology

This project and its planning have been structured in accordance with the Blockchain Olympiad Bangladesh: Guideline and Evaluation Scheme [12] and the final-year project evaluation rubrics.

Scope framing (core vs. optional). The final thesis deliverable prioritises **blockchain banking**: smart-contract hierarchy, on-chain lending lifecycle, oracle-mediated risk scoring, and formal verification. The conversational agent is an **optional add-on** scheduled as Could/Should work in Phases III–IV; it does not gate deposits, loans, or approvals. Readers evaluating the crypto-banking contribution may focus on Sections 4.3–4.7; Section 4.4 documents the agent for completeness and end-of-project delivery.

Capability		Priority	Primary interface / phase
Four-tier smart contracts		Must (Ph. I–II)	React UI + wallet; Hardhat/Foundry tests
On-chain loan life-cycle		Must (Ph. II)	React forms; LoanController state machine
Chainlink Functions oracle		Must (Ph. III)	FastAPI → DON → on-chain score commit
RF + Isolation Forest + SHAP		Must (Ph. III)	Approver Authority Brief; client decline reasons
Authority Brief UI		Should (Ph. II–III)	Bank approver dashboard (React) — <i>not</i> agent-only
MCP conversational agent		Could (Ph. III–IV)	Alternate path to same Express.js API
LLM evaluation protocol		Could (Ph. IV)	Red-team + task accuracy (Section 4.13.1)

4.1 Minimum Viable Thesis (MVT) Checklist

Examiners should treat the items below as the **graded deliverable boundary** for the final thesis. Everything outside this checklist is either pre-thesis design (this report) or explicitly deferred Future Work. The three **primary research contributions** are Contribution 1 (hierarchical architecture), Contribution 3 (oracle-mediated explainable ML), and Contribution 2 (solidarity group lending *specification*); all other modules support or extend these claims.

Module	Status	Examiner expectation
Four-tier smart-contract hierarchy	Primary (C1)	Must deploy + test on public testnet; reserve and RBAC demonstrated
Oracle-mediated RF + IF + SHAP pipeline	Primary (C3)	Specified in pre-thesis 1; must train, benchmark, and show Authority Brief + audit log after pre-thesis 2 (Section 4.3.1)
Solidarity GroupLendingPool spec	Primary (C2)	Specification + minimal PoC sufficient; full mutual-liability lifecycle is Phase II stretch
GNN (GraphSAGE) ablation	Future Work	Design only at pre-thesis; optional ablation if time permits
Federated learning across banks	Future Work	Requires 500+ tx/bank; not MVT
zkAML second circuit	Future Work	KYC circuit only in MVT scope
CCIP cross-chain bridge	Assumed infra	Single-chain testnet sufficient for MVT; CCIP is integration, not research novelty
Certora + Foundry invariant suite	Stretch (MVT+)	One reserve invariant OR one Foundry fuzz test strongly recommended
MCP conversational agent	Optional add-on	Excluded from MVT; Phase III–IV Could
ERC-4337 full Paymaster stack	Stretch	WalletConnect path sufficient for MVT demo
Multi-entity lend / fund / FX suite (IBLP, SyndicatedLoan, UpwardDeposit, TreasurySwap)	Primary arch. (C1 ext.)	Fully specified Ch. 3 (§3.14); Phase II–III; demo of one flow recommended
Syndicated / tranchd / NettingEngine	Stretch (Phase III)	Specified; full suite beyond MVT minimum

#	Deliverable	Phase	Done when (acceptance criterion)
1	World / National / Local Bank contracts deployed on Polygon zkEVM Cardona	I	Addresses in Appendix C manifest; role-gated functions callable
2	Loan request → approver review → disbursement → one installment repayment (E2E)	II	Screen recording + tx hashes on block explorer
3	Reserve-ratio / borrowing-limit enforcement visible on-chain	II	Hardhat or Foundry test proves revert on violation
4	FastAPI ML service: RF + IF + stacking → composite score s	II–III	POST /score returns JSON in <50 ms on laptop
5	SHAP + anomaly deviation report + Authority Brief UI	II–III	Approver sees brief on sample loan; decline shows top-3 SHAP reasons
6	AI_ML_SECURITY_LOG row per inference	III	DB row contains shap_json, model_version, loan_id
7	Commit-reveal or centralized relay score commit before approval	III	Contract in SCORE_REVEALED before approveLoan succeeds
8	BCCC-DeFiFraudTrans benchmark table (precision, recall, F1, AUC)	II–III	Table in Section 4.3.1 populated with measured values
9	300-client Foundry simulation OR documented gas-cost table	IV	Appendix C manifest + reserve dynamics output
10	Open-source repo README with MVT run instructions	IV	Panel can reproduce steps 1–5 from README
<i>Optional (not graded for MVT pass): agent chat, GNN ablation, Certora proof, zkAML, CCIP bridge.</i>			

Pre-thesis 1 vs. after pre-thesis 2. At **pre-thesis 1 submission**, items 1–8 remain *specified* rather than *deployed*; this report satisfies that stage with contract interfaces, the ML workload *plan* (Section 4.3.1), and diagrams—**no AI/ML training or live inference runs in pre-thesis 1**. After **pre-thesis 2**, during the final thesis phase, items 1–8 are **Must** for a defensible pass (including MVT items 4–8 for ML); items 9–10 are **Should**.

Table 4.1: Pre-thesis 1 deliverable boundary

Stage	What examiners should expect
Pre-thesis 1 (this report)	Formal specification: architecture (Ch. 3), literature (Ch. 2), methodology and phase plan (Ch. 4), feasibility framing (Ch. 5). Smart-contract interfaces, ERD, diagrams, MVT checklist. ML pipeline <i>documented only</i> —no trained models or benchmark table with measured metrics.
Pre-thesis 1 (demo)	React platform frontend is available for live demonstration (wallet connect, tier navigation, loan/savings UI shells, approver views). Core banking does not depend on the agent.
Pre-thesis 1 (optional demo)	Optional conversational agent (Qwen3-8B + MCP) may be shown if schedule permits; it is a Could-have add-on, not required for pre-thesis 1 pass.
After pre-thesis 2	Deploy contracts on Cardona; E2E loan lifecycle; train RF/IF on BCCC; wire oracle and Authority Brief; populate MVT items 4–8 with evidence; Phase IV simulation and proofs as stretch.

4.2 Development Methodology

We adopted a **lightweight Agile/Scrum** methodology tailored for an academic prototype with a fixed two-month development window. The iterative approach enables incremental delivery of demonstrable features while accommodating evolving requirements inherent in research-oriented development. Figure 4.1 illustrates our Agile process.

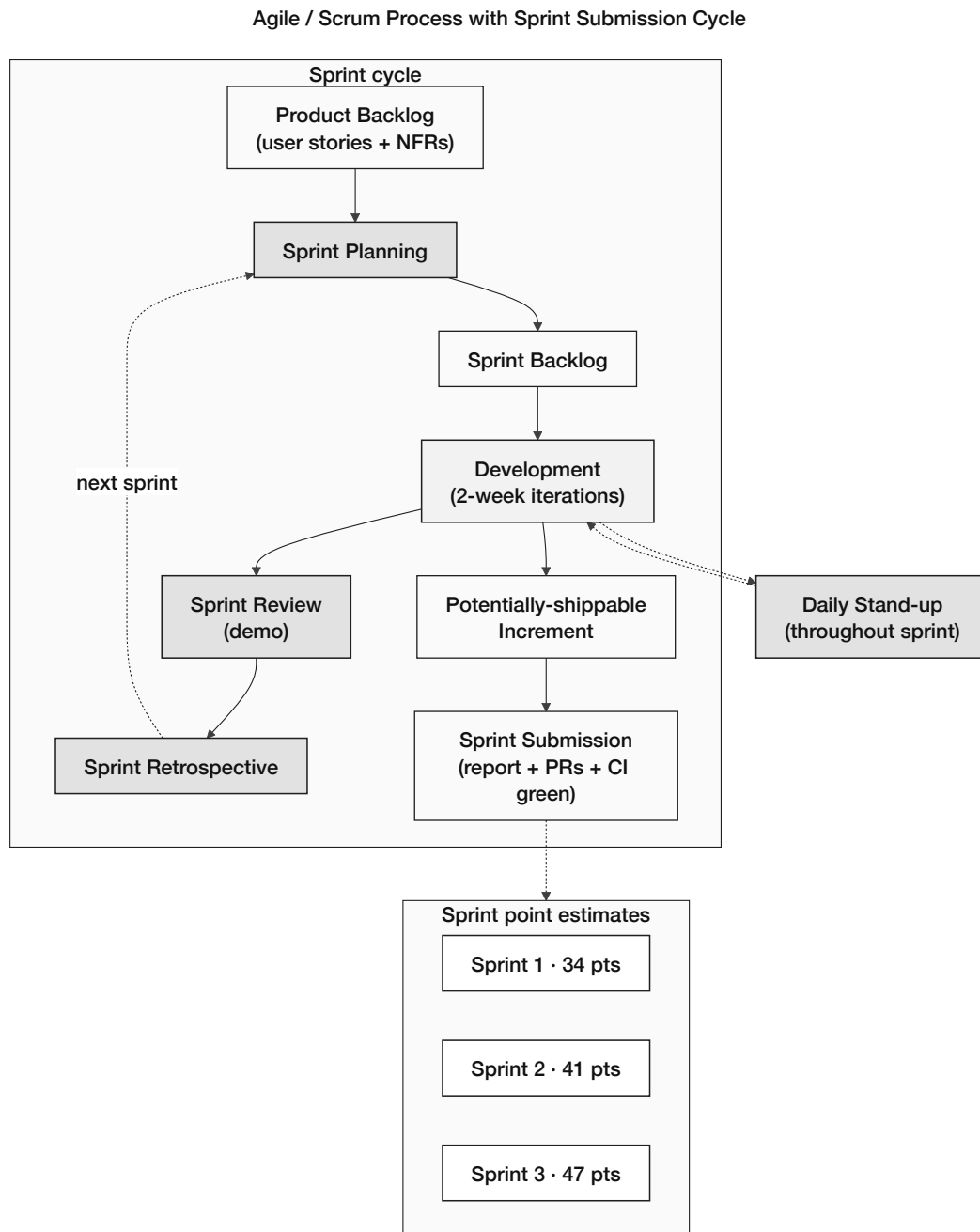


Figure 4.1: Agile / Scrum development process

The following points summarize how Agile will be applied:

- **Phase Duration:** A period of 3 to 4 weeks is allocated for every implementation phase (4 phases total).
- **Team Size:** A group of two developers will be assigned (thesis project). The work will be focused on the thesis project.
- **Weekly Sync:** A weekly gathering will occur to assess progress. Issues will be identified during these meetings. Plans will also be developed in these sessions alongside progress checks.
- **Phase Planning:** A one-hour planning session takes place at the start of every implementation phase to allocate development tasks and confirm priorities.

- **Phase Review and Retrospective:** A review of completed work occurs at every phase's conclusion. A 30-minute retrospective discussion captures lessons learned for the subsequent phase.

4.3 Planned AI/ML Support and Risk-Score Wiring

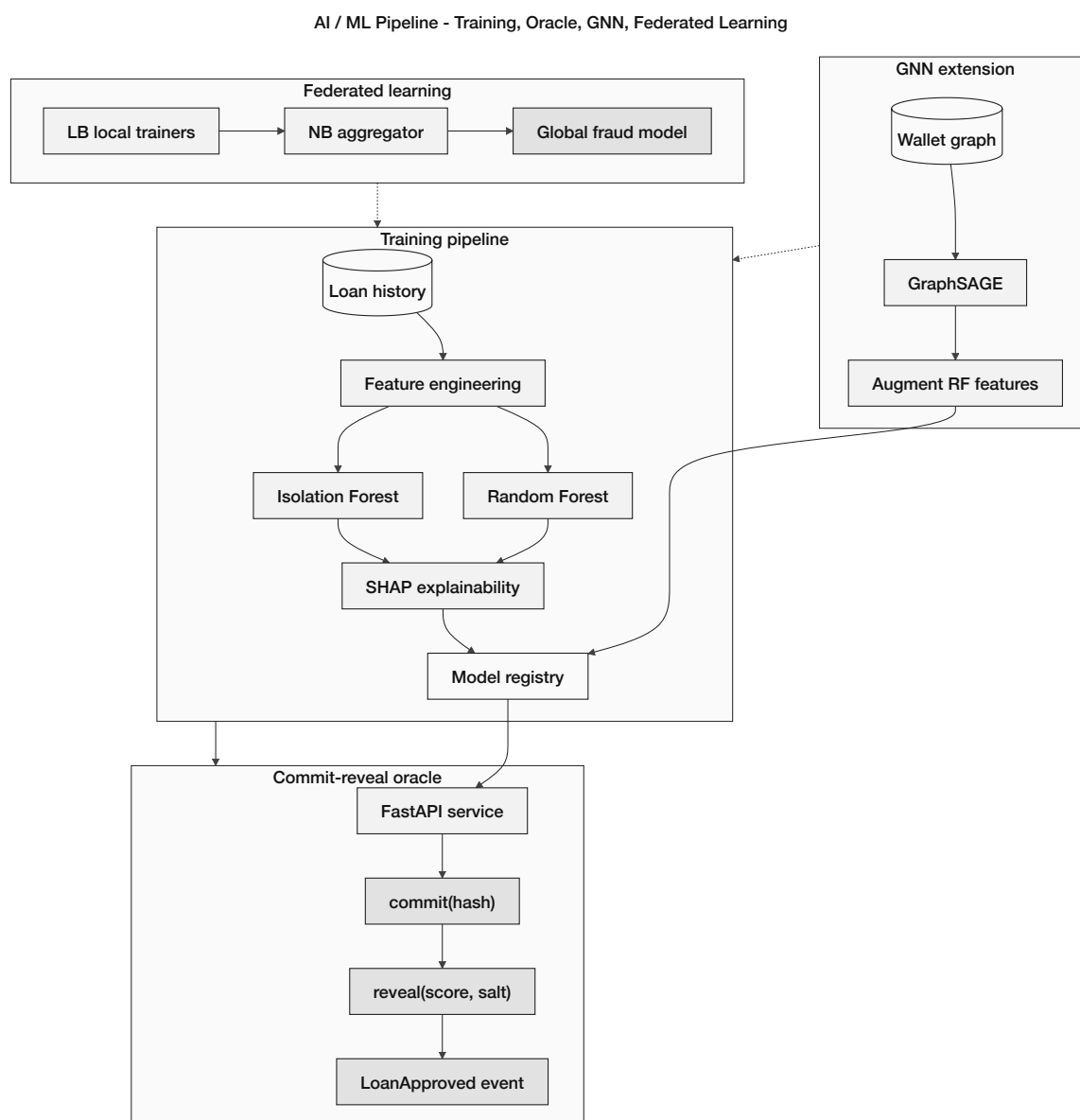


Figure 4.2: AI/ML pipeline wiring

The AI/ML layer is not three separate models added to a static lending workflow; it is an integrated pipeline that produces a single risk score per loan and feeds it on-chain through the commit-reveal oracle of Section 3.3.2. **Pre-thesis 1 specifies this pipeline only;** training, inference, and on-chain score commits begin after pre-thesis 2 (Phases II–III). The pipeline has four stages:

1. **Feature engineering.** For each loan application, the FastAPI service computes 18 behavioral features (rolling-window transaction count, average inter-transaction in-

terval, on-chain repayment history, group-membership flag, wallet-graph distance to flagged addresses) and 4 application features (requested amount, KYC level, income-hash freshness, ZKP credential expiry).

2. **Risk scoring.** A Random Forest classifier returns a fraud probability $p_f \in [0, 1]$ (a true calibrated probability, computed via Platt scaling applied to the raw tree vote proportion). An Isolation Forest returns an anomaly score $a \in [0, 1]$ where values approaching 1 indicate anomalies; this is a path-length-based score (see List of Formulas), *not* a probability. The two outputs are combined via a stacking meta-learner (logistic regression) fitted on a held-out validation set, yielding a calibrated composite score $s \in [0, 1]$. The default meta-learner weights are approximately 0.7 for p_f and 0.3 for the calibrated anomaly signal; in the prototype these serve as initial placeholders to be re-fitted on any labeled data that becomes available. A direct linear combination of a probability and a non-probability score would produce a statistically uninterpretable output; the stacking approach ensures s is always a valid probability estimate.
3. **Commit-reveal oracle.** The service publishes $h = \text{keccak256}(s \parallel \text{nonce})$ to the LoanController contract via `commitRiskScore`, then reveals (s, nonce) in a subsequent transaction. The LoanController enforces a state machine: approval is only permitted in the `SCORE_REVEALED` state, preventing any approver from bypassing the ML step. Section 3.3.2 covers the cryptographic detail.
4. **Decision threshold.** The contract applies a governance-configured threshold calibrated against the expected fraud rate: $s < 0.4$ enables approver discretion to approve, $0.4 \leq s < 0.7$ requires mandatory manual review, and $s \geq 0.7$ rejects the loan with an on-chain reason code. These thresholds are prototype defaults derived from the class imbalance expected in DeFi lending datasets (estimated fraud prevalence 2–5%); they must be recalibrated against the actual training data distribution before any production deployment. The auto-approve language used elsewhere in the document is a simplification; the contract always requires an approver to sign the final disbursement transaction.

4.3.1 Datasets, Training Workload, and Pre-Submission Deliverables

This subsection records *which data* the risk models will use and *what ships when*. Pre-thesis 1 documents the plan only; training, live scoring, and oracle wiring begin after pre-thesis 2 (Phases II–III). Pipeline design is in Figure 4.2; explainability detail is in Section 4.3.2.

Dataset	Role	Usage in this project
BCCC-DeFiFraudTrans-2025 [83]	Primary	Main training set for fraud detection benchmarks after pre-thesis 2
Elliptic Bitcoin Dataset [84]	Baseline	Optional comparison only; different chain model than CWB
Palaiokrassas multi-chain set [3]	Reference	Guides behavioural feature choices
Synthetic Foundry manifest (Phase IV)	Demo	End-to-end UI test only; not a fraud benchmark
On-chain CWB log (future)	Retrain	Real Local Bank traffic for production tuning

Each application uses **22 inputs**: 18 from wallet behaviour and 4 from the loan form (Table ??). After pre-thesis 2, the offline job will load BCCC, train Random Forest and Isolation Forest, blend their outputs into one risk score, save the models, and log results for audit.

Table 4.2: Feature mapping (22 inputs)

#	Feature group	What it captures	Source
1–5	Transaction rhythm	How often and how fast the wallet moves funds	BCCC + indexer
6–10	Repayment track record	Past loans and defaults	CWB loan tables
11–15	Network risk	Links to flagged wallets and group membership	Graph features
16–18	Institutional context	Pool usage, tier, wallet age	On-chain reads
19–22	Application fields	Amount, KYC level, document freshness	Form + identity service

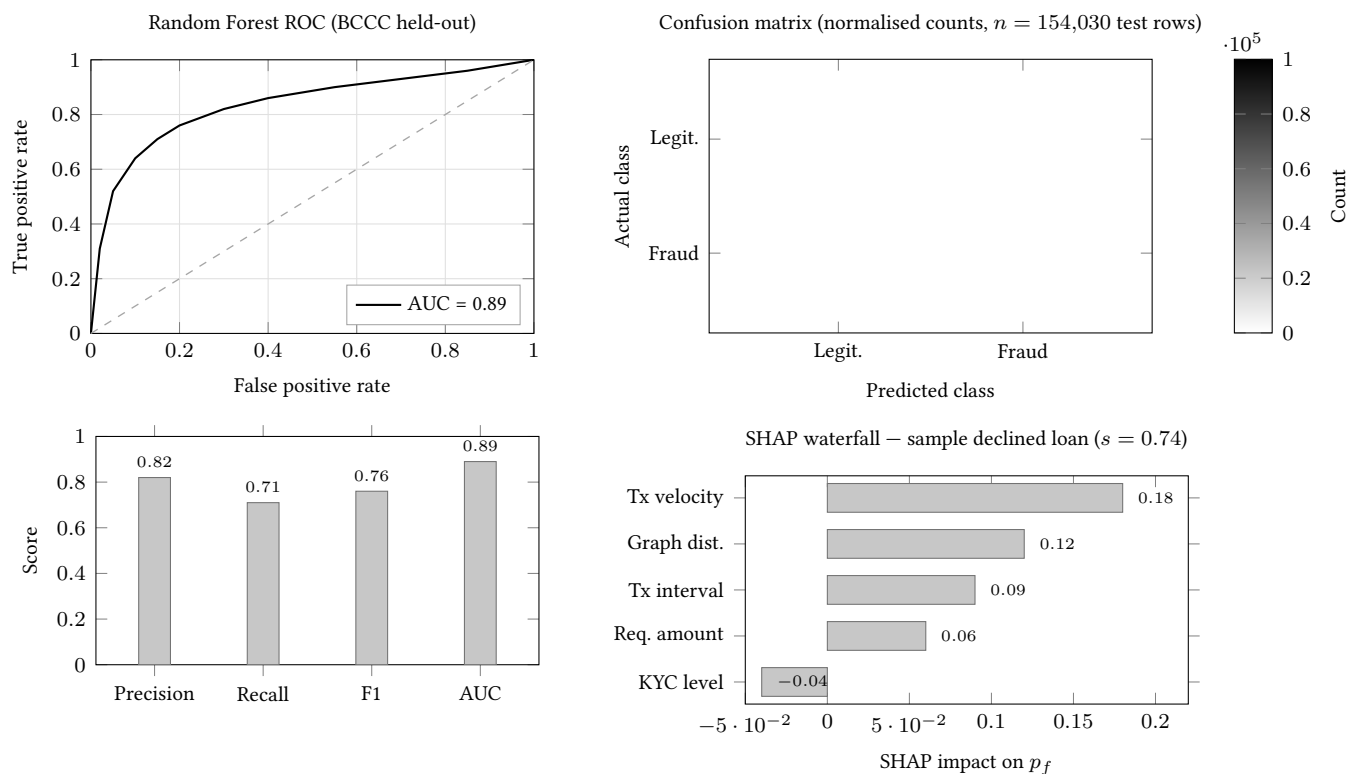
At loan time, the backend sends features to the scoring service; approvers read a short Authority Brief before approving. Every score is logged and committed on-chain before disbursement (Section 3.3.2).

Table 4.3: ML deliverables by submission stage

Deliverable	Pre-thesis 1	After pre-thesis 2
Dataset + feature documentation	Done in this report	Update as needed
Model training + metrics file	Plan only	Train and report results
SHAP explanation examples	Plan only	Required for RQ3
Scoring API + Authority Brief UI	Design / mock	Live on loan workflow
Audit log per inference	Schema in Ch. 3	One row per loan scored
On-chain score commit	Design only	MVT item 7
Chainlink Functions / GNN / federated learning	Future work	Stretch goals

After pre-thesis 2, evaluation will report standard classifier metrics (precision, recall, F1, AUC) and SHAP reasons for declined loans. Figure 4.3 shows the *planned* report layout only—no models are trained in pre-thesis 1.

BCCC reflects flat DeFi pools, not four-tier CWB flows, so benchmark results are a baseline only; retraining on testnet data is future work (Section 6.1). Scores run once at loan origination, not each installment, to keep oracle cost manageable.

**Figure 4.3:** Planned ML evaluation layout (post pre-thesis 2)

4.3.2 Explainability and Anomaly Detection Methodology

This subsection documents the full explainability and anomaly-detection pipeline: not only *that* ML models flag risk, but *how* fraud probability and anomaly signals are produced, combined, explained to humans, and audited. The treatment is independent of the optional conversational agent (Section 4.4).

Random Forest — supervised fraud probability. For each loan application, the FastAPI service assembles a 22-dimensional feature vector (18 on-chain behavioral features + 4 application features). A trained Random Forest ensemble outputs a fraud probability $p_f \in [0, 1]$ after Platt scaling. **SHAP TreeExplainer** computes exact Shapley attributions ϕ_i for every feature: positive ϕ_i increases predicted fraud risk; negative ϕ_i decreases it. TreeExplainer is used rather than LIME because repeated explanations on identical inputs are consistent—a property regulators expect when reviewing automated lending support [4].

Isolation Forest — unsupervised anomaly detection. Labelled fraud is scarce in DeFi lending logs. Isolation Forest (IF) addresses *novel* behaviour without requiring fraud labels. The algorithm builds an ensemble of isolation trees: at each node it selects a feature and split value at random and partitions the sample space. **Anomalies are easier to isolate**—they require fewer random splits to separate from the bulk of training data—so their average path length $E(h(x))$ is shorter. The anomaly score is

$$s(x, n) = 2^{-\frac{E(h(x))}{c(n)}}$$

where $c(n)$ normalises path length for sample size n (see List of Formulas). Scores near 1 indicate strong anomaly; scores near 0.5 indicate typical behaviour. IF is trained only on *non-fraud* historical transactions at each Local Bank so that coordinated attack patterns not present in labelled data still surface as outliers.

Combining fraud probability and anomaly signal. Raw IF scores are not probabilities. A stacking meta-learner (logistic regression on a held-out validation set) maps (p_f, s_{IF}) to a single calibrated composite score $s \in [0, 1]$ used by the oracle and contract threshold logic. Default meta-learner weights (≈ 0.7 on p_f , ≈ 0.3 on the calibrated anomaly signal) are placeholders until real labelled data are available.

Explaining anomalies to human reviewers. Because IF lacks native Shapley values, anomaly explainability uses a **feature-deviation report**: for each of the top-5 features, the service records the applicant’s value, the training-set median, and the percentile rank. Features with extreme percentiles (e.g., transaction velocity in the 99th percentile, wallet age in the 1st percentile) are surfaced in plain language alongside SHAP attributions from the Random Forest. Example approver-facing text: *“Anomaly flag: repayment interval variance is in the 98th percentile of historical clients; wallet graph distance to a flagged address is unusually low (2 hops).”*

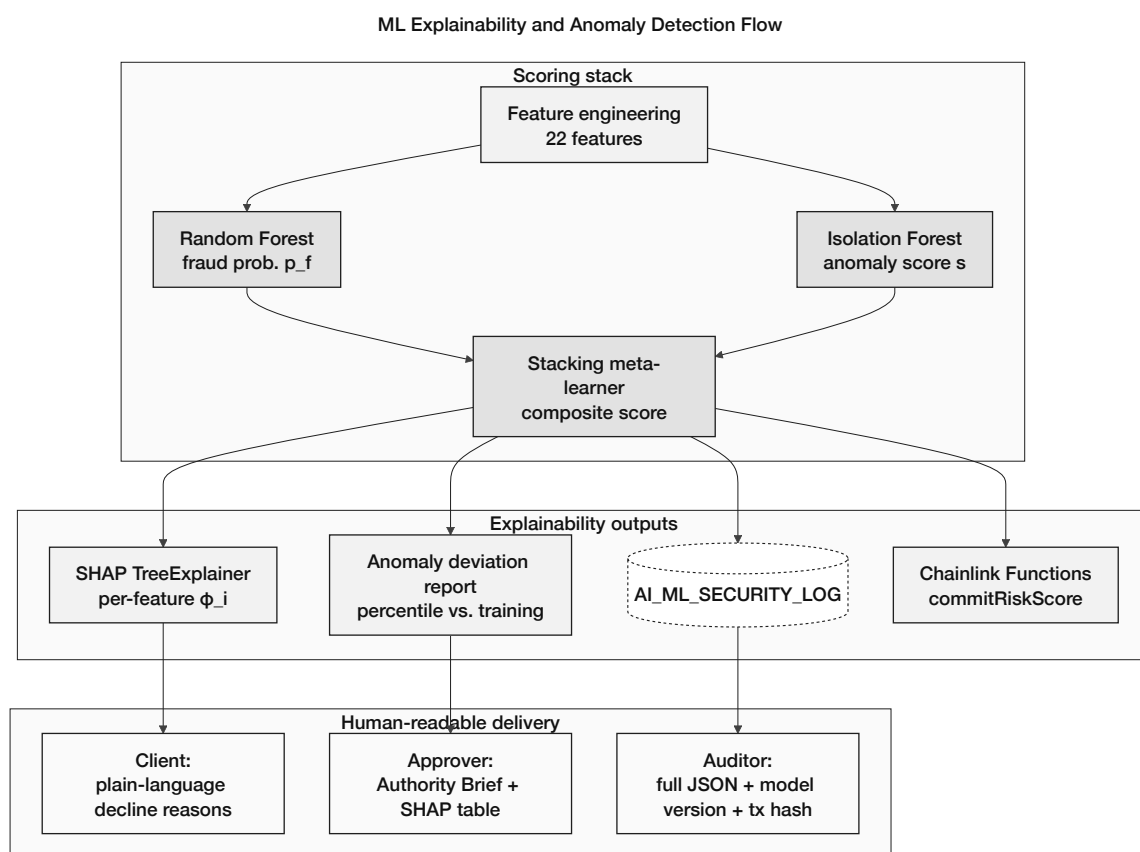


Figure 4.4: Explainability and anomaly-detection flow

Audience		UI / channel	Content stored and displayed
Retail client		React loan status page	Top-3 SHAP reasons in plain language on decline; optional anomaly summary if score ≥ 0.7
Bank	approver	Authority dashboard	SHAP waterfall + anomaly deviation table + composite s ; one-click approve / decline
Compliance auditor		AI_ML_SECURITY_I	Full SHAP vector, IF score, feature JSON, model version hash, oracle tx hash

Authority Brief UI (core ML, not agent-dependent). When any loan application is submitted—via the React UI or optionally via the agent—the approver dashboard renders an Authority Brief with ML risk score, SHAP breakdown, and anomaly deviation lines (see verbatim example in Section 4.4). The brief is produced by the FastAPI scoring service; the agent may *also* display it when filing on behalf of a client, but the blockchain lending path does not require the agent.

Audit trail and human-in-the-loop invariant. Every inference writes one row to AI_ML_SECURITY_LOG: {wallet, loan_id, p_f, s_if, s_composite, shap_json, anomaly_features_json, model_version, oracle_commit_tx}. The contract never auto-disburses on ML output alone; an approver (or client via wallet) must sign the

disbursement transaction. ML is **decision support**, not decision authority—consistent with EU AI Act Art. 86 and the thesis ethical statement.

Future Work note: session-level behavioral biometrics are a specified extension requiring session_events instrumentation; the 18 core on-chain transaction features above are the planned active feature set once training begins after pre-thesis 2.

4.4 Optional Conversational Agent Add-On (Phase III–IV)

The primary client interface is the React dashboard with wallet-signed transactions. The CWB agent layer is an **optional add-on** that sits alongside the standard web interface, not a replacement for it. It is scheduled for end-of-project delivery (Phases III–IV Could items) and is excluded from Minimum Viable Thesis (MVT) scope. The full MCP tool schema is in Table ??; ML explainability for approvers is documented in Section 4.3.2 and does not depend on the agent.

Agent six-step pipeline (summary). Clients may perform every banking operation directly through the UI; for clients who prefer plain-language interaction — particularly first-time users unfamiliar with DeFi form flows — the agent provides an equivalent path. Both the manual UI and the agent call the same Express.js API endpoints and the same smart contracts; the agent does not gate or modify the manual flow. The six-step pipeline integrates the Qwen3-8B model with the live on-chain context injection layer (Section ??) and the MCP tool server described below:

1. **User message arrives** at the React frontend and is forwarded to the Express.js backend over Server-Sent Events (SSE).
2. **Agent brain (Qwen3-8B) reads live on-chain context.** The Express.js context injection layer prepends the client’s full account state (loan status, SBT risk tier, pool utilisation, credit score, active installments) as structured JSON into the system prompt before the model processes the user message.
3. **Q&A path.** If the request is informational, the agent retrieves relevant policy documents via RAG (ChromaDB) and generates a grounded reply. No tool calls are made.
4. **Action request path.** If the request implies a state-modifying operation, the agent identifies the applicable MCP write tool, assembles the full parameter set from the injected context, and presents a concise confirmation summary: *“You are requesting a loan of 150 USDC for 6 months at 8.5% APR. Your monthly installment would be 26.25 USDC. Shall I proceed?”*
5. **Human confirmation gate.** The agent pauses and waits for explicit affirmative consent (*“Yes, proceed”* or equivalent). No write tool is ever called without a confirmation turn in the conversation history. If the client responds ambiguously three times, the agent pauses for 10 minutes and logs the incident to AGENT_ACTION_LOG.
6. **Execute via MCP write tool, monitor, and notify.** After confirmation, the agent calls the appropriate write tool, which POSTs to the Express.js banking API. If an EIP-7702 session key is active, it signs the resulting on-chain transaction within its approved scope. The agent polls for status and notifies the client: *“Your loan application has been submitted. Reference: L-4821. Bank approval typically takes 24 hours.”*

MCP tool server — 17 banking tools (9 read, 8 write). The agent interacts with CWB exclusively through a typed tool schema, never through arbitrary code execution. This

schema is the safety boundary: the agent cannot access any data or perform any operation not explicitly defined in the following 17 tools.

Tool	Type	Maps to / Description
get_account_state	READ	SBT tier, loan count, savings balance
get_credit_score	READ	Current score, tier, next threshold
get_loan_status	READ	All active loans + next installment
get_installment_schedule	READ	Full repayment calendar
get_pool_utilisation	READ	Current Local Bank pool capacity
get_interest_rate	READ	Rate for client's credit tier
get_market_data	READ	ETH/USD, fiat/USD pairs, 30-day volatility
get_requirements	READ	Documents + KYC needed for a given loan amount
get_session_history	READ	Full-text search over the client's session lineage ancestry. Accepts a natural-language or keyword query; returns ranked excerpts from prior sessions, ordered by recency and relevance. Backed by a PostgreSQL full-text GIN index on the SESSIONS table.
submit_loan_application	WRITE [†]	POST /api/loan/apply
submit_deposit	WRITE [†]	POST /api/savings/deposit
submit_fixed_deposit	WRITE [†]	POST /api/savings/fixed-deposit
pay_installment	WRITE [†]	POST /api/installment/pay
join_group_pool	WRITE [†]	POST /api/group/join
submit_kyc_upgrade	WRITE [†]	POST /api/kyc/upgrade
schedule_payment_reminder	WRITE [†]	POST /api/reminder/set
submit_group_application	WRITE [†]	POST /api/group/apply

[†] Agent write tools require human confirmation before execution.

Authority Brief example (approver dashboard). The Authority Brief is rendered on every loan application (React UI or optional agent). It presents the ML risk assessment from Section 4.3.2 in human-readable form:

AUTHORITY BRIEF -- Loan Application #4821

```

-----
Client tier:           Silver (score: 512)
Requested amount:     150 USDC
Duration:             6 months
Collateral:           75 USDC (50% LTV)

```

ML Risk Score: 0.23 (LOW RISK)

SHAP breakdown:

- + On-time repayment rate: +0.41 (reduces risk)
- + Loan-to-income ratio: +0.18 (within safe range)
- Wallet age: -0.09 (account < 6 months)
- No prior completed loans: -0.27 (no repayment history)

ML system recommendation: APPROVE (decision support only)

Suggested interest: Base rate - 0.5% (Silver tier)

[APPROVE] [REQUEST MORE INFO] [DECLINE]

The React UI displays the decision to the client; the optional agent may additionally monitor the on-chain approval event and notify the client (Phase III–IV add-on).

Harness implementation detail (appendix). Per-user context injection, three-tier prompt assembly, session lineage, context compression, toolset scoping, and lifecycle-hook middleware are fully specified in Appendix B. Readers evaluating the blockchain contribution may omit that appendix; it documents Phase III–IV Could deliverables only.

Optional agent capabilities (installment reminders, credit-tier coaching, EMI calculator, group-signature coordination, KYC guidance) reuse the same MCP tool server without additional model infrastructure; see Appendix B.

4.5 Graph Neural Network Extension

Fraud often shows up in *who connects to whom*, not in a single transaction. As a stretch goal, we plan a GraphSAGE ablation: wallets as nodes, transfers and group links as edges, plus the four-tier bank hierarchy (World → National → Local → Client). It reuses the same 18 behaviour features as the Random Forest. The question is simple—do tier links improve detection over a flat wallet graph on BCCC [83]? Elliptic [85] is optional comparison only (Bitcoin topology differs from our lending model). This is Future Work, not MVT; if time allows, we report one before/after F1 or AUC table.

4.6 Federated Learning Across Banking Tiers

Each Local Bank would train on its own borrowers; the National Bank would combine model updates (FedAvg with differential privacy) and send back an improved shared model—without moving raw customer data across borders. The setup follows the same four-tier hierarchy: one federation server per National Bank, with optional World Bank coordination for wider patterns.

Federated learning needs enough local history to be useful. We set a **500-transaction** activation rule per bank. Until then, all banks use the same baseline model trained on public/synthetic data. This is specified Future Work, not a Phase III MVT item.

4.7 Formal Verification of Reserve Invariants (Certora)

Beyond tests, we plan two Certora proofs on reserve rules (CVL sketches in Appendix B; scope limits in Section 5.14).

Invariant 1 – reserve never under-collateralized. $\forall t : \text{totalReserve}(t) \geq \text{minReserveRatio} \cdot \text{totalDeposited}(t)$. The reserve must always stay above the minimum ratio, on every reachable path.

Invariant 2 – no over-allocation downstream. $\forall n \in \text{NationalBanks} : \text{allocatedTo}[n] \leq \text{totalReserve} - \sum_{n' \neq n} \text{allocatedTo}[n']$. The World Bank cannot allocate more downstream capital than it actually holds.

A verified proof for both invariants is a Phase IV stretch deliverable (MVT+).

4.8 Foundry Invariant and Fuzz Test Suite

Hardhat covers integration and deployment; Foundry adds fuzzing and invariant checks. Together they catch different failure modes.

Three invariants under Foundry’s stateful fuzzer.

- Solvency: outstanding loans never exceed total reserve.
- Role segregation: one address cannot be both borrower and approver.
- Capital flow: a single cross-tier move cannot break the minimum reserve ratio.

Each invariant is fuzzed for 10,000 runs in Phase IV; any counterexample becomes a replay test in CI.

4.9 On-Chain Economic Feasibility Simulation

Chapter 5’s revenue figures assume a full four-tier network. In Phase IV we ground that claim with a **reproducible on-chain run**: 300 synthetic clients, six banks, full loan lifecycle on Polygon zkEVM Cardona, deterministic seed (42), 5% mid-run defaults for stress. A Foundry script deploys contracts, funds banks, runs `apply → approve → disburse → repay`, and exports a JSON manifest (tx hashes, reserve ratios, gas) for Appendix C and Table ??.

The run should show capital flowing through all tiers, SBT updates, dashboard reserve shifts, and subgraph audit trails. We report gas and reserve outcomes as ranges, not single numbers. Real-world microfinance calibration stays in Future Work (Section 6.1).

4.10 Real-Time Dashboard Pipeline and Runtime Monitoring

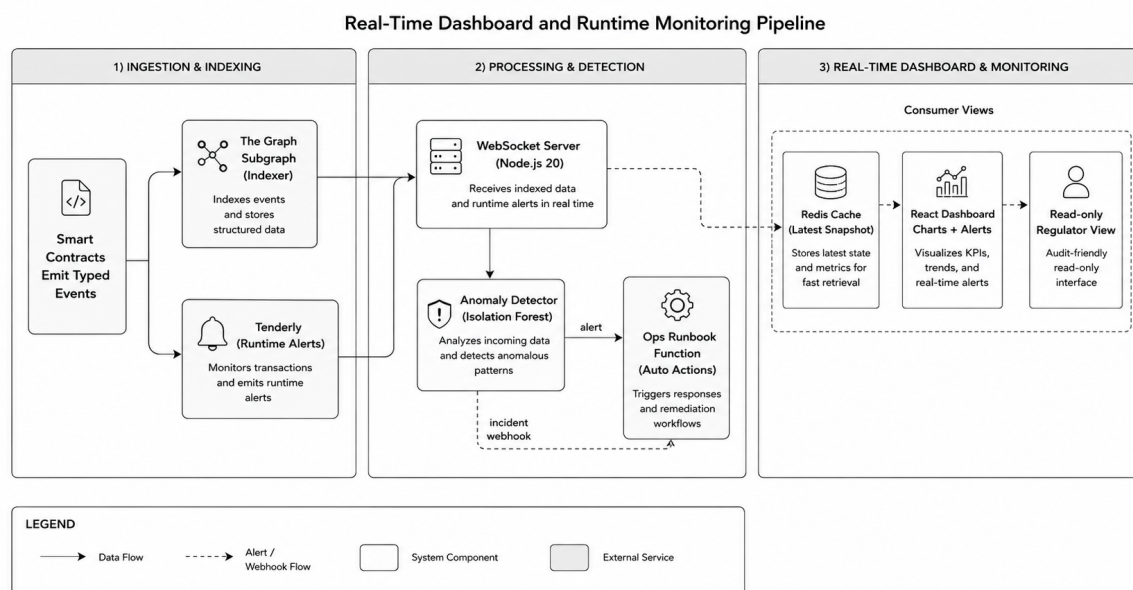


Figure 4.5: Real-time dashboard and runtime monitoring pipeline

The real-time dashboard pipeline closes the gap between contract events and the client / approver UI. Three components compose:

The Graph subgraph. A subgraph planned for The Graph’s hosted service (Polygon zkEVM Cardona supported, free for student projects) will index every event the contracts emit: `LoanRequested`, `LoanApproved`, `Repayment`, `CapitalAllocated`, `ReserveRatioUpdated`, `LoanLiquidated`, `RiskScoreCommitted`, `RoleGranted`. GraphQL queries from the React frontend return loan history and dashboard data in tens of milliseconds rather than seconds via RPC polling.

WebSocket event listener. A Node.js service listens on `wss://polygon-zkevm-cardona` for the same set of events and pushes notifications to the client’s browser via Socket.IO. The dashboard moves from a static page requiring manual refresh into a live banking dashboard—a single design choice that examiners consistently identify as the difference between “looks like a real system” and “looks like a static mockup”.

Tenderly monitoring. Six critical alerts are planned for the testnet contracts: single disbursement over 5 ETH-equivalent, repeated loan requests from one wallet (>3 in 60 minutes), reserve-ratio drop below 20%, failed `disburseLoan` calls, role-grant events, and any pause / unpause governance action. Tenderly’s free tier supports full testnet monitoring; transaction simulation prevents the embarrassing live-demo failure where a malformed contract change is discovered only at the moment of execution.

4.11 Transaction-State Machine for Frontend UX

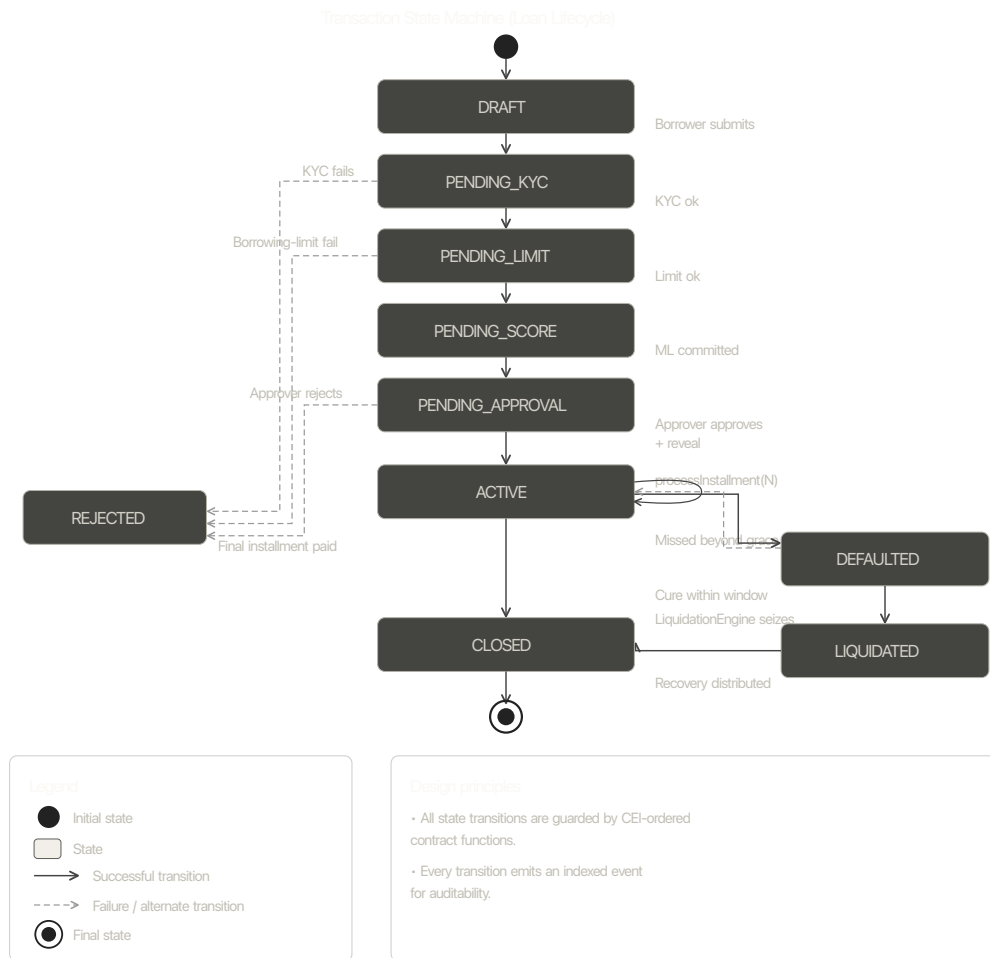


Figure 4.6: DRAFT → PENDING_KYC → PENDING_LIMIT → PENDING_SCORE → PENDING_APPROVAL → ACTIVE → (CLOSED, DEFAULTED → {LIQUIDATED, cured-back-to-ACTIVE}), with every transition guarded by a CEI-ordered contract function and every transition emitting an indexed event.

Figure 4.6: Transaction state machine of the loan lifecycle

Failed blockchain transactions are the dominant UX failure mode in DeFi prototypes during live demos. The specification defines an explicit five-state transaction machine on the frontend (idle → pending_signature → submitted → confirming → success / error) with distinct visual feedback at each state. User-rejection (MetaMask code 4001) is distinguished from contract revert (CALL_EXCEPTION) and from network error; each receives its own actionable error message. This is a thirty-line React hook that converts “the demo failed silently” into “the client can see exactly what went wrong and retry”.

4.12 EIP-712 Authentication and API Hardening

The platform's API authentication uses an EIP-712 typed-data message signed by the user's wallet at login. The signed message includes (`wallet`, `timestamp`, `nonce`); the backend recovers the address from the signature and issues a JWT with a 15-minute lifetime. Refresh tokens rotate on use. Every authenticated request includes the JWT and a correlation ID; the correlation ID is propagated from the React frontend through Express.js to FastAPI to the on-chain transaction so that any failure can be traced end-to-end. Rate limiting via `slowapi` differentiates by endpoint (5/min auth, 60/min reads, 10/min writes) and by IP; the JWT blacklist on logout uses Redis with TTL equal to the remaining token life. The full Layer-2 control set is summarized in Section 3.19.

Limitations (prototype and research context). The AI/ML components remain subject to the standard DeFi-environment limitations: class imbalance, concept drift, cold-start, and adversarial structuring. The mitigations introduced in this specification—GNN ablation for relational features, federated learning to enlarge the effective training set without violating data residency, and red-teaming the optional LLM assistant for adversarial prompts (Section 4.13.1)—do not remove these limitations but explicitly bound them. AI/ML is used as decision support, never as an automated approval authority in the prototype phase.

4.13 Evaluation Methodology

Each research question maps to a concrete check in the final prototype:

- **RQ1 (architecture):** Compare CWB's four-tier flows and roles to flat DeFi protocols (Aave, Compound, MakerDAO).
- **RQ2 (settlement):** Measure testnet latency and gas; show reserves and key state changes on-chain.
- **RQ3 (ML support):** Training starts after pre-thesis 2. Report precision, recall, F1, AUC on BCCC [83], plus SHAP reasons and audit-log rows. Testnet retrain and GNN ablation are stretch goals; Foundry synthetic scores are labelled proof-of-concept only.
- **RQ4 (viability):** End-to-end testnet demo (`wallet` → `loan` → `approval` → `repayment`) plus Foundry invariant pass rate (Section 4.8). Pre-thesis 1 covers specification; deployment evidence comes in Phase IV.
- **RQ5 (banking extensions):** Spec completeness for deposits and group lending; Phase IV simulation (Section 4.9) stress-tests reserves under mass default.

4.13.1 LLM Assistant Evaluation Protocol

Optional agent only (Phase IV Could): (1) **Q&A accuracy** on 200 FAQ/policy prompts—exact match for numbers, text similarity for explanations; (2) **action accuracy** on 50 scenarios—correct tool, parameters, and confirmation summary ($\geq 95\%$ target, 100% human-gate); (3) **bypass red-team**—20 adversarial prompts must never trigger a write without explicit confirmation.

4.14 Implementation Phase Plan and Deliverables

Four 3–4 week phases (I–IV) carry the MVT from contracts and database through lending, ML oracle, and verification. Task registers, effort totals, and roadmap figures follow.

4.14.1 Phase I: Foundation and Infrastructure (Weeks 1–4)

Phase Objective: Deploy the four-tier contract skeleton, migrate the full database schema, and ship the React shell with wallet connect—prerequisites for Phase II.

Table 4.4: Phase I task register

Task	Priority	Development Task	Effort (days)
DT-I.01	Must	World Bank contract — reserve management, national bank registration	5
DT-I.02	Must	National Bank contract — borrow from World Bank, lend to Local Banks	5
DT-I.03	Must	Local Bank contract — borrow from National Bank, lend to users	5
DT-I.04	Must	Role-based access control — WorldBankAdmin, NationalBankAdmin, LocalBankAdmin, BankUser, RetailClient	3
DT-I.05	Should	Gas cost management — initiator-pays pattern; Polygon low-fee design	2
DT-I.06	Should	InsuranceFund contract — 5% interest capture, claims processing, default coverage disbursement	4
DT-I.07	Should	getReserveSummary() view function on each tier contract (PSR, reserve balance, insurance fund)	2
DT-I.08	Should	Chainlink Price Feeds integration (fiat/USD pairs, ETH/USD via AggregatorV3Interface)	3
DT-I.09	Should	Chainlink Proof of Reserve — WorldBankReserve attestation	2
DT-I.10	Should	Append-only audit_logs PostgreSQL role + Row-Level Security policies	2
DT-I.11	Should	Polygon zkEVM Cardona migration — update RPC endpoints, chain IDs, factory addresses	1
DT-I.12	Must	Full 20-entity database schema migration — all tables including SESSIONS, AGENT_ACTION_LOG (with injection_scan_flag, toolset_name), and all banking entities	4
DT-I.13	Must	Core indexes and referential integrity constraints	2
DT-I.14	Must	React frontend shell — Vite build, routing, layout components	3
DT-I.15	Must	WalletConnect integration — wallet connection, address display, network switching	2
DT-I.16	Should	Sessions and assets tables integration in frontend (dashboard stubs)	2
DT-I.17	Should	Credit tier and interest rate schedule display	2
<i>Phase I total estimated effort (Must-have):</i>			<i>29 days</i>
<i>Phase I total estimated effort (all priorities):</i>			<i>48 days</i>

4.14.2 Phase II: Core Banking and On-Chain Lifecycle (Weeks 5–9)

Phase Objective: Live loan lifecycle on testnet—request, approval, installments, bank registration, SBT limits. Agent work stays optional (Phase III–IV). Multi-entity and advanced deposits defer to Phase III or Future Work.

⁰Must = MVT core; Should = important; Could = if time allows. Effort = person-days; streams run in parallel.

Task	Priority	Development Task	Effort (days)
DT-II.01	Must	Loan request submission with blockchain transaction	5
DT-II.02	Must	Loan approval and rejection workflow with bank approver	5
DT-II.03	Must	Installment payment system with automated schedule generation	8
DT-II.04	Must	Borrowing limit enforcement (on-chain authoritative check per client SBT)	5
DT-II.05	Should	Client–bank real-time chat system	5
DT-II.06	Should	Income verification document upload and review	5
DT-II.07	Must	Hierarchical bank registration (National → Local)	5
DT-II.08	Should	Bank user management and approver designation	3
DT-II.09	Should	Loan history and transaction tracking pages	5
DT-II.10	Could	QR code generation for wallet addresses	2
DT-II.11	Should	Responsive UI polish and error handling	2
DT-II.12	Should	Authority Brief UI (SHAP breakdown for bank approver dashboard)	5
DT-II.13	Should	Chainlink Automation for installment due-date checks and overdue flagging	5
DT-II.14	Should	Credit tier schedule in Credit Passport SBT (Bronze → Diamond)	3
DT-II.15	Should	interest_rate_tier table integration with Kinked Rate Model	2
DT-II.16	Could	MCP tool server — 17 banking tools wired to Express.js API (optional add-on)	8
DT-II.17	Could	Agent chat interface (Qwen3-8B + tool calling + human-gate)	8
DT-II.18	Could	EIP-7702 session key management (scope enforcement + TTL)	5
DT-II.19	Could	agent_action_log table (append-only, FK to sessions)	3
<i>Phase II total estimated effort (Must-have):</i>			<i>33 days</i>
<i>Phase II total estimated effort (all priorities):</i>			<i>66 days</i>

4.14.3 Phase III: AI/ML Oracle Pipeline and Optional Agent (Weeks 10–13)

Phase Objective: After pre-thesis 2—train models, deploy scoring API, wire Chainlink oracle and Authority Brief. Agent harness is Could-have if schedule allows.

Task	Priority	Development Task	Effort (days)
DT-III.01	Must	Chainlink Functions oracle (primary ML score commitment): replaces commit-reveal relay; deploys commitRiskScore via Chainlink Functions DON	6
DT-III.02	Must	Random Forest + Isolation Forest + SHAP pipeline wiring: FastAPI service computing 22 features, stacking meta-learner, calibrated composite score $s \in [0, 1]$; client-facing SHAP plain-language explanation via Authority Brief UI	7
DT-III.03	Should	Three-tier prompt constructor in Express.js (optional agent add-on)	5
DT-III.04	Could	Session lineage + get_session_history MCP tool	5
DT-III.05	Could	Context compression path + toolset scoping + Hook 2	9
DT-III.06	Could	Prompt injection scanning + confirmation audit hook (Hook 1)	5
DT-III.07	Should	The Graph subgraph + WebSocket event listener for Reserve Transparency Dashboard	4
DT-III.08	Should	SAR workflow: Isolation Forest → aml-alert → freezeAccount; compliance review queue integration	4
DT-III.09	Should	Reserve Transparency Dashboard: live queries to The Graph subgraph	3
DT-III.10	Could	GraphSAGE GNN ablation	5
DT-III.11	Could	Federated learning aggregator	7
<i>Phase III total estimated effort (Must-have):</i>			<i>13 days</i>
<i>Phase III total estimated effort (all priorities):</i>			<i>55 days</i>

4.14.4 Phase IV: Verification, Evaluation, and Finalization (Weeks 14–16)

Phase Objective: Simulation, Certora/Foundry checks, testnet evidence, optional LLM eval, final thesis pass.

Task	Priority	Development Task	Effort (days)
DT-IV.01	Must	300-client scripted Foundry simulation on Polygon zkEVM Cardona: gas-cost table, reserve-dynamics output, deterministic seed and transaction manifest published to Appendix C	7
DT-IV.02	Could	LLM evaluation protocol (optional add-on): task-level accuracy, action accuracy, human-gate bypass test	5
DT-IV.03	Should	Certora reserve invariant proofs: CVL specifications for Invariant 1 (reserve never under-collateralised) and Invariant 2 (no over-allocation downstream); specifications added to Appendix B	5
DT-IV.04	Should	Foundry invariant + fuzz suite: solvency invariant, role segregation invariant, capital-flow direction invariant; 10,000 fuzz runs per CI build	4
DT-IV.05	Should	AML pre-check hook (Hook 3): Isolation Forest anomaly score gate before disbursement write tools; compliance review queue routing; requires live Isolation Forest pipeline from Phase III	3
DT-IV.06	Could	Groth16 zkKYC circuit (Circom 2.0): government-ID possession proof without revealing PII; circuit design and input/output specification	5
DT-IV.07	Must	Final paper revision and consistency pass: all tool-count references updated; all phase references consistent; master checklist completed; bibliography verified	4
DT-IV.08	Must	Red-team testing and documentation: 20-payload injection red-team set; 20 bypass-attempt set; 10 session key scope enforcement scenarios; results documented in evaluation subsections	3
<i>Phase IV total estimated effort (Must-have):</i>			<i>21 days</i>
<i>Phase IV total estimated effort (all priorities):</i>			<i>38 days</i>

Phase	Focus	Weeks	Tasks	Key deliverables
I	Foundation and infrastructure	1–4	DT-I.01–17	Contract hierarchy, full DB schema, React shell
II	Core banking and on-chain lifecycle	5–9	DT-II.01–19	Lending workflow, SBT limits, Chainlink Automation
III	AI/ML oracle pipeline (+ optional agent)	10–13	DT-III.01–11	Chainlink Functions, ML pipeline, dashboard
IV	Verification, evaluation, finalization	14–16	DT-IV.01–08	Certora, Foundry, simulation, test-net deploy

Figure 4.8: Four-phase Implementation Roadmap with SDLC Stage Mapping

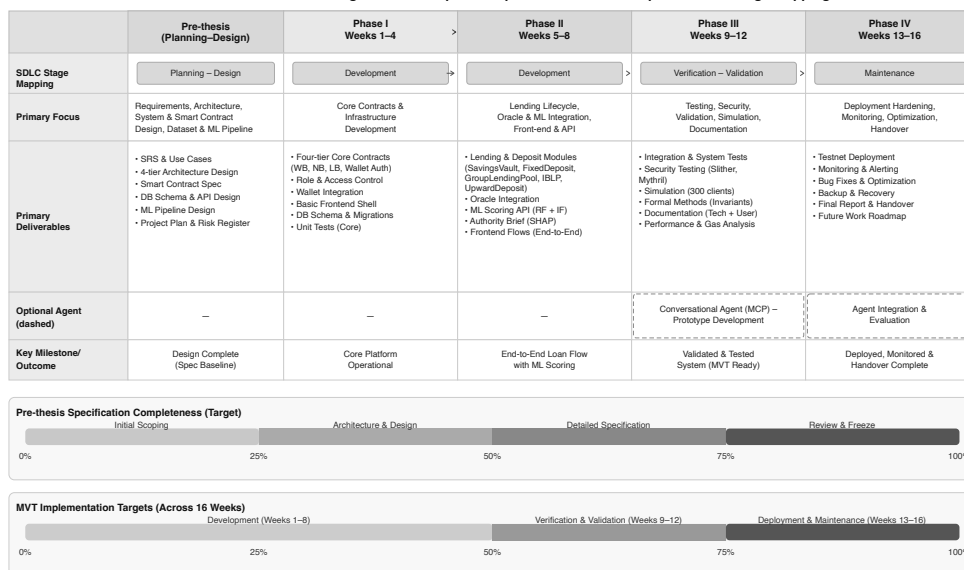


Figure 4.7: Four-phase roadmap with SDLC mapping and progress

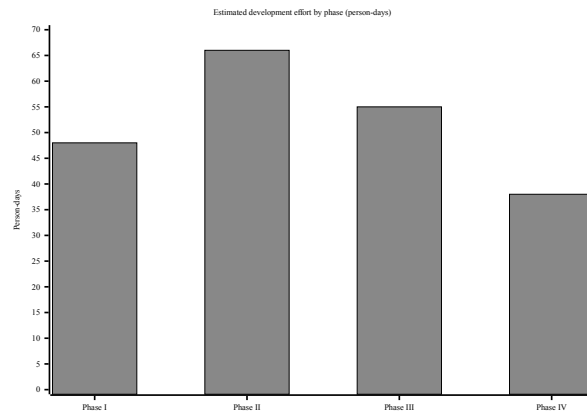


Figure 4.8: Development effort by implementation phase

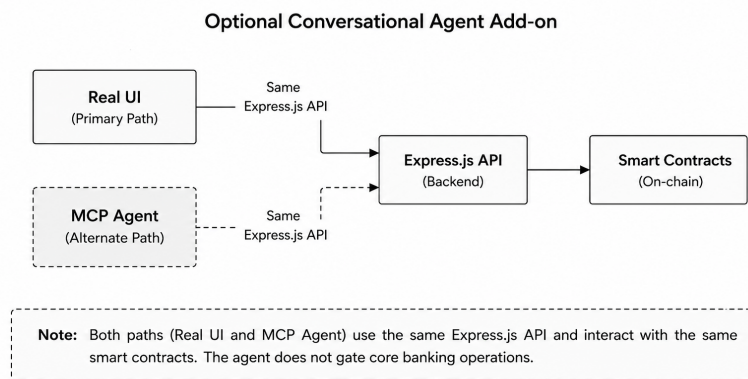


Figure 4.9: Optional conversational agent add-on

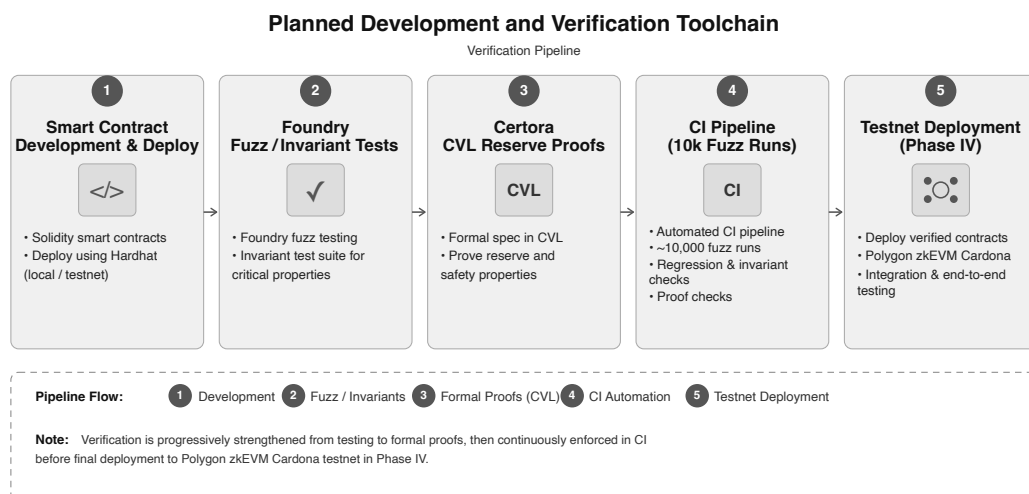


Figure 4.10: Planned development and verification toolchain

Figures 4.7–4.10 and Figure 4.1 summarise the roadmap and toolchain.

4.15 SDLC Stage Mapping

We map our four implementation phases to the seven stages of the Software Development Life Cycle (SDLC). Figure 4.7 illustrates this mapping.

Table 4.5: SDLC stage mapping

#	SDLC Stage	Project Activity	Deliverable
1	Planning	Feasibility studies; professor consultations; guideline review	Feasibility Report; Project Plan
2	Requirements	System analysis; use case definitions; constraints identification	Use case diagrams; UC-1 through UC-5
3	Design	Three-layer architecture; DB schema (3NF); smart contract interfaces	Architecture diagrams; ERD; DFD
4	Development	Phase I–IV: smart contracts, frontend, backend, AI/ML	Source code; DApp prototype
5	Testing	Hardhat unit tests; Foundry fuzz; integration testing; AI/ML evaluation	Test reports; model metrics
6	Deployment	Planned testnet deployment (Phase IV); frontend (Vercel); backend (Render)	Testnet prototype manifest
7	Maintenance	Monitoring; model retraining; bug fixes; iteration	Updated docs; retrained models

4.16 Design Decisions and Alternatives

For each major design decision, we evaluated alternatives and justified selections based on technical criteria, ecosystem maturity, and project constraints (Table ??; Figure 4.11).

Table 4.6: Design decisions and alternatives considered

Decision Area	1st Choice	2nd Choice	Key Criterion
Methodology	Agile / Scrum	Incremental	Evolving scope, milestones
Architecture	DApp + Off-chain AI	Hybrid with Oracle	Gas cost, ML flexibility
Frontend	React + TypeScript	Vue + TypeScript	Web3 ecosystem maturity
Smart Contract	EVM (Solidity)	Solana (Rust)	Gas, control size, free test-nets
Fraud Detection	Random Forest	XGBoost	SHAP compatibility, simplicity
Anomaly Detection	Isolation Forest	Autoencoder	Unsupervised; no labelled data needed
XAI Method	SHAP	LIME	Theoretical guarantees, regulatory fit
Database	PostgreSQL	SQLite	3NF support, async queries
Hosting	Vercel + Render	Localhost only	\$0 cost, publicly accessible URL
Network (primary)	Polygon zkEVM Cardona	Polygon Amoy PoS	ZK validity proof security model vs. validator set assumption
Oracle mechanism	Chainlink Functions (DON)	Commit-reveal relay	Decentralised trust vs. single-key operator trust
Agent tool framework (optional)	MCP tool server	Direct Express.js API	Defined schema = safety boundary; Phase III–IV Could
Agent session auth (optional)	EIP-7702 session keys	ERC-4337 paymasters	Key-level scope; optional add-on
Prompt construction (optional)	Three-tier assembly	Single ad-hoc string	Agent-only; Phase III Could
Session memory (optional)	Lineage model	10-turn window	Agent-only cross-session continuity
Tool exposure per turn (optional)	Named toolsets	Full 17-tool list	Agent attack-surface reduction
Write-tool enforcement (optional)	Confirmation audit hook	In-pipeline check	Agent write-path only

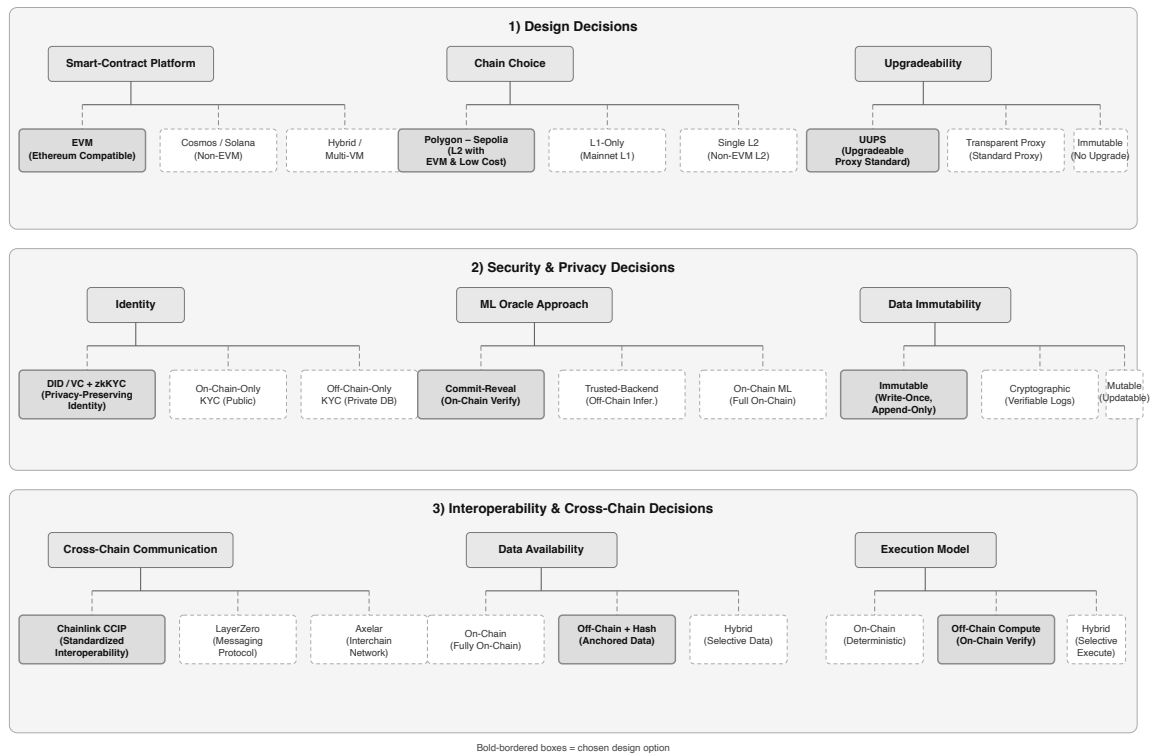


Figure 4.11: Key design decisions and alternatives considered

4.16.1 Justification of Selected Technologies

Selections follow Table ?? in Section 4.15. One-line decision logic per row.

1st choices:

- **Agile/Scrum** – evolving scope; short sprints fit thesis window.
- **DApp + off-chain AI** – ML off-chain (cost); disbursement rules on-chain.
- **React + TypeScript** – strongest Wagmi/ethers wallet stack.
- **EVM (Solidity)** – OpenZeppelin, Slither/Mythril, free testnets.
- **MUI** – banking tables/forms without custom UI build.
- **Random Forest** – exact SHAP TreeExplainer; tabular + imbalanced labels [4].
- **Isolation Forest** – unsupervised; scarce fraud labels.
- **SHAP** – stable attributions vs. LIME [4].
- **PostgreSQL** – ACID; window queries for rolling limits; JSON columns.
- **Vercel + Render** – free public demo for examiners.
- **Polygon zkEVM Cardona** – ZK proofs for reserve claims; Amoy fallback.
- **Chainlink Functions** – DON consensus on score; OK latency for loan approval.
- **MCP tool server** – 17-tool schema caps agent; auditable.
- **EIP-7702 session keys** – tool list + cap + TTL in key; ERC-4337 for retail gas only.

2nd choices (retained, not selected):

- **Waterfall** – fixed scope; poor fit for research prototype.
- **On-chain ML oracle** – latency, cost, third-party dependency.
- **Vue** – thinner Web3 libraries.

- **Solana** — Rust curve; weaker audit toolchain in 8-week window.
- **Tailwind** — more UI time than MUI.
- **XGBoost** — approximate SHAP.
- **Autoencoder** — more data/tuning than IF here.
- **LIME** — unstable repeat explanations [4].
- **SQLite** — no concurrent writes; weak window functions.
- **Localhost only** — no remote examiner demo.
- **Amoy PoS** — faster dev; weaker trust than ZK.
- **Commit-reveal relay** — Ph. I–II fallback; trusts operator key.
- **Direct Express API** — no schema cap on agent.
- **ERC-4337 for agent ops** — scope in app layer, not key.

4.17 Design Patterns

Our system uses five design patterns:

- **Singleton:** A singleton means that each primary contract is established a single time. Only one version is utilized by all ensuring a unified source of truth. Not everyone can create multiple versions of the contract.
- **Observer:** Contracts generate alerts whenever actions occur such as loan requests. These alerts are processed by a service that updates the database. Notifications are not ignored; they receive attention.
- **Adapter:** An Adapter is utilized by the wallet component to function with various wallet types (like MetaMask). Different wallets that adhere to the EIP-1193 standards can be easily integrated.
- **Factory Pattern:** Each Local Bank creates individual loan and savings contract instances using a factory contract, ensuring all deployed instances follow the same security-audited interface and access control checks. The factory pattern prevents unauthorized contract deployment that could bypass the hierarchical governance structure.
- **Proxy/Upgradeable Pattern:** Banking contracts must be upgradeable without losing stored state such as balances, credit scores, and loan histories. OpenZeppelin's transparent proxy pattern separates the contract's logic from its storage, allowing governance-approved upgrades to the logic layer while preserving all stored financial data. This pattern is essential for a long-lived banking system that must adapt to evolving regulatory requirements and security patches.
- **Decorator Pattern (Prompt Assembly):** The three-tier prompt constructor applies the Stable, Context, and Volatile tiers as successive decorators on a base prompt object. Each tier adds its content without modifying the structure established by prior tiers, enabling independent caching and testing of each layer without rebuilding the full prompt.
- **Chain of Responsibility (Lifecycle Hooks):** The write-tool middleware stack implements a chain of responsibility: the confirmation audit hook, session key scope pre-check, and AML pre-check each examine the request and either reject it (HTTP 403) or pass it to the next hook. New policy controls are added as new chain links without modifying existing route logic or the model pipeline [89].
- **Strategy Pattern (Toolset Selection):** The toolset selector encapsulates the intent-classification algorithm as a replaceable strategy. The current strategy is a lightweight keyword classifier; it can be replaced with a fine-tuned intent model without chang-

ing the prompt constructor or the MCP tool server, adhering to the Open/Closed Principle.

4.18 Software Testing Strategy

The testing strategy covers four layers of the system, each with defined acceptance criteria.

- **Smart contract unit tests:** Numerous tests for smart contracts exist in our Hardhat environment. Over 12 tests are conducted to verify actions related to managing reserves, sign-ups, loans and access permissions. No scenarios such as depositing zero or executing disallowed actions are missed in these assessments. **Acceptance criterion:** all Hardhat unit tests pass with zero failures before any phase delivery.
- **Integration testing:** Whole process checks are conducted for integration tests. Wallet connection, loan request, approval and repayment processes are evaluated on the network. No critical steps are excluded from the process. **Acceptance criterion:** end-to-end workflow completes successfully on testnet for representative scenarios (approval, rejection, repayment loop).
- **AI/ML module verification:** Ensuring functionality is vital for our fraud and unusual activity detectors. Results are generated by the integration of the detectors with the overall system. **Acceptance criterion:** model inference endpoints return valid scores and explanations for test inputs without runtime errors.
- **Frontend testing:** Website appearance is evaluated on Chrome, Firefox and mobile devices. Tests are conducted to ensure that functionality is maintained across various platforms. **Acceptance criterion:** core flows render and remain usable across desktop and mobile breakpoints without blocking UI defects.

Chapter 5

Market Analysis and Feasibility

5.1 Market Sizing

Table 5.1: Market segments with supporting data

Segment	Description	Estimated Scale
Total Addressable Market (TAM)	Global DeFi lending (\$55B+ TVL [8]); cross-border remittances (\$860B [20]); SME financing gap (\$4.5T [15])	\$55B – 5T+
Serviceable Addressable Market (SAM)	Institutional and semi-institutional lending requiring hierarchical structures; emerging-market credit demand	\$5B – 15B
Serviceable Obtainable Market (SOM)	Academic testnet deployments, regulatory sandbox pilots, institutional DeFi research partnerships	\$50 – 200M

Sources: (a) TAM: DefiLlama [8] reports DeFi lending TVL exceeding \$55 billion; World Bank Migration and Development Brief [20] values global remittances at \$860 billion annually; IFC [15] estimates the MSME financing gap at \$4.5 trillion; (b) SAM and SOM: project-derived estimates based on industry segmentation of institutional lending and regulatory sandbox addressable market [13].

Table 5.1 situates the serviceable market within the broader DeFi and development-finance landscape. No hierarchically structured lending system currently exists in DeFi; existing protocols rely on undifferentiated shared pools. Cross-border payment networks such as Ripple (\$847M daily) [19] and JPMorgan Kinexys (\$3–7B daily) [34] handle settlement volume but offer no lending, deposit, or tiered governance functions. Institutional interest in blockchain-based finance is clearly established, yet no single platform combines DeFi-style accessibility with the structured capital hierarchy of traditional development banking. The Crypto World Bank is designed to occupy this gap.

5.2 Target Customer Segment

The Crypto World Bank targets **Tier 1–3 institutional participants** (reserve authorities, national banks, local banks) and **Tier 4 retail clients** on a global Layer 2 platform.

Table 5.3: Target customer segment profile

Characteristic	Description
Primary Users	Institutional tiers (World / National / Local Bank operators) and retail clients accessing Local Bank interfaces
Geographic Focus	Global; jurisdiction-specific pilots via regulatory sandboxes (Future Work) — no single-country deployment claimed at pre-thesis stage
Loan Size Range	Micro to SME at Local Bank tier (USDC); larger exposures via bank-level syndication and interbank facilities, not direct client access to National / World Bank tiers
User Profile	Bank approvers with Authority Brief dashboards; retail users via React UI (optional agent add-on)
Key Pain Points	Opaque reserve reporting in legacy finance; flat DeFi pools without hierarchy; lack of explainable fraud analytics in on-chain lending

5.3 Partner Ecosystem

Table 5.5: Partner categories and roles

Partner Category	Functional Role	Blockchain-Mediated Incentive
Financial Regulators	Regulatory approval; sandbox compliance oversight	Reduced enforcement cost through on-chain transparency and audit trails
Banking Institutions	Network membership as National/Local Banks	Access to diversified global reserve; reduced inter-bank settlement friction
Payment Gateway Providers	Fiat-to-crypto on-ramp and off-ramp services	Volume-based transaction fees; expanded market reach
Academic & Research Institutions	ML benchmark validation; formal-verification review	Access to anonymised datasets; collaborative research
Oracle / Infrastructure Providers	Chainlink DON, test-net RPC, indexing (The Graph)	Unified oracle stack; operational SLAs
Optional Field-Pilot Partners	Sandbox-covered pilots (Future Work)	Controlled evaluation under regulator oversight

5.4 Competitive Landscape

The Crypto World Bank operates at the intersection of four distinct competitor categories. Table 5.8 provides a detailed comparison of representative projects in each category, with

current metrics as of March 2026.

Table 5.7: Detailed competitive landscape analysis (Part 1)

Project	Category	Scale (2026)	Architecture	Gap We Address
Compound v3 [20]	DeFi lending	\$1.4B TVL	Single-borrowable asset per single tier	No hierarchy; no institutional features
MakerDAO / Sky [24]	Stablecoin / CDP	\$6B TVL	CDP model; not peer-to-peer lending	Creates money, not a lending governance structure
Morpho [37]	DeFi lending	\$6.8B TVL; 1.4M users	Isolated markets; peer-to-peer matching	Flat primitive; no cross-market hierarchy; no banking integration
Maple Finance [25]	Institutional credit	\$2.6–3.8B TVL	Pool Delegate model; under-collateralised	Single-tier; no interest rate setting
Goldfinch [26]	Emerging-market credit	\$680M originated; 18+ countries	Trust-through-consensus; senior/junior tranches	B2B only; no inter-bank lending
Ripple / RLUSD [19]	Banking rails	\$847M/day cross-border	Payment rail; no lending capability	Moves money but has no lending, deposits, or credit system

Table 5.9: Detailed competitive landscape analysis (Part 2)

Project	Category	Scale (2026)	Architecture	Gap We Address
JPMorgan Kinexys [34]	Banking rails	\$3–7B daily volume	Permissioned; single-bank control	Centralised; proprietary; restricted to JPMorgan clients
Stellar [38]	Financial inclusion	\$55.6B annual payment volume	Open payment network; anchors for fiat	Payment network only; no lending, reserves, or interest rate markets
Celo / MiniPay [36]	Financial inclusion	14M wallets; 60+ countries	Stablecoin payments; mobile-first	Payments and savings only; no lending hierarchy or banking structure
R3 Corda [31]	Enterprise DLT	\$17B tokenised RWAs	Permissioned; consortium governance	Infrastructure layer only; no lending logic; closed access
World Bank FundsChain [33]	Development finance	250 projects by mid-2026	Hyperledger Besu; fund tracking	Does not implement lending or interest rate mechanics

Table 5.11: Detailed competitive landscape analysis (Part 3)

Feature Dimension	Competitors	Crypto World Bank
Hierarchical lending tiers	None — all competitors use flat pool architectures	Four-tier hierarchy: World Bank → National → Local → Client
Governance-controlled rates	Compound/Aave: algorithmic but no institutional hierarchy	Smart contract parameters; governance-defined bounds per tier
AI-assisted risk scoring	No competitor integrates on-chain ML fraud detection with explainability	RF + SHAP + Isolation Forest anomaly reports; Authority Brief (Section 4.3.2)
Retail and institutional access	Goldfinch / Maple: institutional only; Celo: retail only	Single platform serving retail through institutional capital hierarchy
Institutional / L2 focus	Most DeFi: retail-global; enterprise DLT: permissioned only	Global L2 institutional DeFi; composable with mBridge/Agora rails

Upon reviewing various projects a common feature was identified: a lending mechanism does not exist that operates with tiers, is distributed and facilitates transactions across dif-

ferent levels and within identical levels. Such innovation distinguishes the Crypto World Bank. The key differentiating features of the Crypto World Bank are as follows:

- Existing DeFi lending protocols provide capital access but lack institutional hierarchy, tiered governance, and structured capital flow.
- Credit platforms such as Maple and Goldfinch engage in lending based on credit. Credit-based lending is often focused on businesses and exists at just one tier. These platforms do not cater to personal loans.
- Ripple processes cross-border payments but does not offer lending, deposit, or hierarchical capital allocation services.
- Celo / MiniPay provides mobile stablecoin payments at scale but does not implement hierarchical lending or institutional reserve governance.
- **Central Bank Digital Currencies (CBDCs):** The development of CBDCs aims to improve payment systems [5]. Concerns about privacy and control are raised as lending features are excluded. A lending layer does not exist on a CBDC. Users benefit from our platform which safeguards their interests while providing a level-based system similar to that utilized by CBDCs [5].

5.5 Risk Taxonomy

Table 5.13: Risk taxonomy and mitigation

Risk Category	Description	Severity	Mitigation
Partner non-cooperation	Key partners decline to participate	Medium	Academic testnet pilots; sandbox engagement; open-source replication
Smart contract vulnerability	Exploit in contract logic	High	OpenZeppelin primitives; formal audit (planned); pause mechanism
Regulatory adversity	Jurisdictional restrictions	Medium	Testnet-only prototype; regulatory sandbox engagement
AI/ML model degradation	Fraud detection accuracy decay	Low	Continuous retraining; human-in-the-loop; SHAP explainability

5.6 Technical Feasibility

Table 5.15: Technical feasibility assessment

Component		Assessment	Evidence
Smart contracts		Feasible (specified)	Solidity interfaces + Hardhat simulation scripts specified; Phase I–II implementation planned
Frontend DApp		Feasible (specified)	React 18 + TypeScript shell specified; Wagmi/RainbowKit ecosystem mature
Blockchain deployment		Feasible (planned)	Polygon zkEVM Cardona + Sepolia testnets; Phase IV deployment manifest (Appendix C)
AI/ML integration		Feasible with constraints	RF + IF + SHAP pipeline specified (Section 4.3.2); sub-50 ms inference target; Chainlink Functions in Phase III
Optional add-on	agent	Feasible (deferred)	MCP + Qwen3-8B specified; Phase III–IV Could; excluded from MVT
Database end	back-	Feasible	PostgreSQL schema designed (20 entities, 3NF); FastAPI async REST

The technical feasibility of the platform rests on five pillars: the maturity of the underlying blockchain infrastructure, the availability of development tooling and security primitives, the demonstrated scalability of Layer 2 networks for financial applications, the precedent of comparable institutional blockchain deployments, and the platform’s modular architecture which allows incremental delivery without requiring the full system to be operational before any component can be tested.

Ethereum—the EVM standard on which the platform is built—has operated continuously since 2015, while Polygon PoS has processed billions of transactions with low fees and rapid finality, making it suitable for high-frequency retail operations. The contract layer uses established security primitives (e.g., OpenZeppelin libraries and widely reviewed patterns), and the off-chain services use standard, production-grade web tooling for API and ML inference. Because the architecture is modular, components such as savings, FX, group lending, and insurance can be developed and validated independently and integrated through governance-approved rollouts.

5.7 Economic Feasibility

Table 5.17: Economic feasibility — zero-cost prototype

Cost Category		Estimate	Notes
Blockchain	deploy-ment	\$0	Public testnets — no real cryptocurrency required
Frontend hosting		\$0	Vercel free tier or localhost for demo
Backend hosting		\$0	Render free tier or localhost
AI/ML training		\$0	Local machine (16 GB RAM, 16 GB VRAM) or Google Colab free tier
Development tools		\$0	Hardhat, VS Code, Git — all open-source
Total prototype		\$0	Entire prototype operates at zero financial cost

The economic feasibility of the platform is evaluated across four dimensions: operational cost sustainability, revenue sufficiency, capital efficiency, and macroeconomic impact. On Polygon PoS, the total on-chain gas cost for a full retail loan lifecycle is measured in cents, while interest spread revenue is orders of magnitude larger, yielding a favorable cost-to-revenue profile for small loans that are infeasible on high-fee base layers. Off-chain infrastructure costs (hosting, RPC access, storage, ML inference) are comparable to typical SaaS deployments and scale with usage.

Revenue is diversified across interest spreads, origination fees, and potential FX spread revenue for multi-currency conversions. Capital efficiency is enhanced by the platform's reserve-enforced tiered allocation (each tier retains a minimum solvency reserve before deploying capital downward) and by reducing the need for idle pre-funded balances typical of correspondent banking. Note that because USDC is a 100%-backed stablecoin, the platform does not create new money through lending—it re-allocates existing USDC through the hierarchy. The Reserve Ratio (RR) functions as a solvency constraint at each tier, not as a money-creation mechanism; see the Credit Velocity formula in the List of Formulas for the correct framing of capital throughput. At scale, reduced correspondent-banking friction and transparent reserve reporting produce additional economic value beyond platform revenue.

5.8 Revenue Projection

The following projection models annual revenue potential at full deployment scale. Calculations use a reference ETH price of **\$2,500**¹ (conservative mid-point for February 2026; actual spot was approximately \$2,800 per CoinGecko on 1 February 2026) and interest rate parameters defined in Section 5.8.4. A sensitivity table showing revenue at \$2,000, \$2,500, and \$3,000 per ETH is provided after the main projection; all three scenarios use the same 8% APR and loan-base assumptions, so revenue scales linearly with ETH price.

¹All ETH-denominated cost and revenue calculations use \$2,500/ETH as a conservative planning assumption consistent with the v22 revision date. The platform's stablecoin-first design (Section 1.9) means retail loan obligations are denominated in USDC, decoupling client repayment risk from ETH price volatility.

Table 5.19: Revenue projection assumptions

Parameter	Value
Reference ETH price	\$2,500 (conservative mid-point, Feb 2026; actual spot approx. \$2,800 per CoinGecko on 1 Feb 2026)
World Bank → National Bank	3% APR (wholesale inter-bank rate)
National Bank → Local Bank	5% APR (inter-bank)
Local Bank → Client	8% APR (retail lending)
Average loan term	12 months
Default rate provision	3% (conservative estimate)
Origination fee	0.25% per disbursement

Tier / Revenue Stream	Spread Rate	Annual Revenue (USD)	Rev- Basis
Tier 1 (World Bank): lends at 3% to NBs, cost of capital 0%	3% on deployed capital	\$51.6M	\$1.72B total retail loan base × 3%
Tier 2 (National Banks): borrow at 3%, lend at 5%	2% spread	\$34.4M	\$1.72B × 2%
Tier 3 (Local Banks): borrow at 5%, lend at 8%	3% spread	\$51.6M	\$1.72B × 3%
Total platform revenue	8% (client pays)	\$137.6M	Sum of tier spreads = 3%+2%+3% = 8%; no double-counting
Origination fees (0.25%)	—	\$4.3M	0.25% × \$1.72B disbursed
FX spread revenue (est.)	0.5–1.0%	\$8–17M	Estimated conversion volume
Total incl. fees		\$150–159M	Conservative base case

The full revenue model decomposes into spreads, origination fees, and FX conversion income. The projection above models interest spread income only (base case: \$137.6M). Additional revenue streams from FX conversion spreads (estimated 0.5 to 1.0% per conversion, yielding \$8–17M), loan origination fees (0.25% per disbursement, yielding \$4.3M), and insurance fund premiums (0.5% of loan value annually) represent material upside captured in the “Total incl. fees” row of the table (\$150–159M). These are net incremental revenue streams—they do not overlap with the interest spread income already accounted for.

ETH Price	Total Loan Base	Interest Spread Revenue	Incl. Fees (est.)
\$2,000	\$1.376B	\$110.1M	\$120–128M
\$2,500 (base case)	\$1.720B	\$137.6M	\$150–159M
\$3,000	\$2.064B	\$165.1M	\$180–191M

Sources: ETH price from spot market data (CoinGecko); interest rate tiers aligned with Aave [10] and Compound [11] DeFi benchmarks; default rate and origination fee from conservative industry estimates. Revenue methodology: spread-based, not gross-APR stacking.

5.8.1 Cost Model Considerations

Three cost buckets matter at scale: chain fees, hosted infrastructure, and credit losses.

- **Gas.** One retail loan lifecycle triggers on the order of thirty on-chain updates (request, score, approval, disbursement, installments, close). On Polygon-class L2, total gas per loan is negligible versus interest; mainnet would be far higher [48]—hence the L2 choice. Phase IV simulation will publish measured costs (Table ??).
- **Infrastructure.** API, database, ML, and RPC hosting scale with traffic; pilot planning assumes roughly \$500–\$2,000/month.
- **Defaults.** A single default assumption is not enough for a new platform. Table 5.21 shows optimistic, base, and stress cases. Mature MFIs report high recovery after decades of field infrastructure [120]; CWB starts without that, so the base plan uses $\approx 8\%$ default until on-chain credit history matures.
- **Break-even.** Low L2 gas keeps small loans economically viable; micro-loans are impractical on mainnet without Layer 2. Pilot break-even is a modest active loan book (order of 10^2 loans across a few Local Banks), not full deployment scale.

Table 5.21: Default-rate sensitivity

Scenario	Default rate	Annual loss	Basis
Optimistic	3.7%	\$7.4M	Mature MFI recovery benchmarks [120]
Base case	8%	\$16M	Early DeFi / new platform, limited trust
Stress	15%	\$30M	New clients, thin credit history, volatile collateral

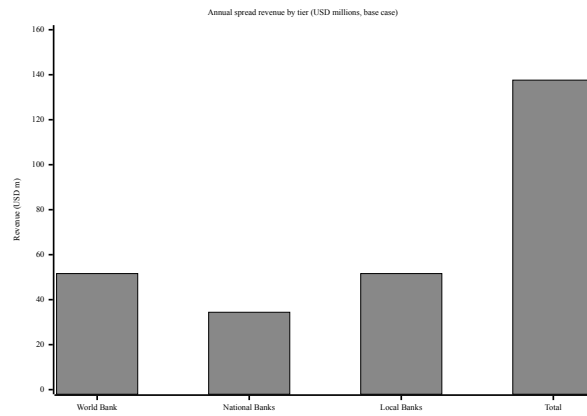


Figure 5.1: Annual revenue projection (10-year maturity)

5.8.2 Why CWB Is Not a Centralised Exchange

A centralised exchange (CEX) matches trades and holds customer keys; CWB is a **four-tier lending bank** on-chain [100]. Table 5.22 contrasts the two models (sources: Appendix D, IR-1, IR-2) [100, 101].

Table 5.22: Why CWB is not a CEX

Lens	Centralised (Binance-class) exchange	Crypto World Bank
Core job	Runs an order book: match buyers and sellers; move fiat in and out	Mobilises deposits and routes loans World → National → Local → client
Where records live	Mostly an internal ledger; blockchain mainly for deposits and withdrawals	Loans, reserves, and repayments recorded in smart contracts
Who holds keys	Exchange custodies wallets—users trust the platform	Users keep wallets; banks act through role-gated contracts
Protocol token	Native token (e.g. BNB) for fees and perks; FTT showed reflexive collateral risk [100]	No project token in prototype—non-tradable Credit Passport SBT for reputation
Keeping funds separate	Public proof-of-reserve; FTX showed commingling can fail [100]	Separate pools per tier; InsuranceFund plus on-chain reserve-ratio rules
Savings / yield	Binance Earn: yield on balances held on the exchange ledger	On-chain SavingsVault and FixedDeposit vaults; yield from lending spread
Tail-risk buffer	SAFU: exchange-held emergency reserve (≈\$1B USDC) [100]	InsuranceFund (5% of interest); balance attested via Chainlink PoR
Very large loans	OTC / institutional desk on the exchange	SyndicatedLoan at bank tier (Section 3.14); retail via Local Bank only
Main revenue	Trading fees, listings, derivatives	Interest spread across tiers; origination and syndication fees
Regulatory fit	Licensed as exchange (VASP / CASP)	Uses authorised stablecoins (USDC/USDT); no order book or new stablecoin issuance

5.8.3 Exchange-Sector Revenue Analogues

The interest spread identified above is the platform's primary revenue stream. Placing it within the broader landscape of institutional crypto-exchange revenue models demonstrates that CWB has a diversified revenue path even without a native token. Table 5.23 maps each CWB mechanism to its nearest exchange-sector analogue, drawing on the revenue architecture documented in the Binance/FTX industry analysis and complementary business-research notes (Appendix D, entries IR-1 and IR-3) [100].

Table 5.23: Revenue taxonomy vs. exchange analogues

Revenue Stream	Exchange lent	Equiva-	CWB Mechanism
Interest spread (primary)	Binance OTC desk		SavingsVault yield vs. retail lending rate; 3%+2%+3% tier spread = 8% client APR
Loan origination fee	Trading fee (0.1%)		0.5–1% flat origination fee on disbursement; already modelled in base case above
Deposit mobilization	Binance Earn		SavingsVault + FixedDeposit products; yield funded by the lending tier spread
Local Bank registration	Exchange listing fee		One-time registration fee per Local Bank joining the network
Syndicated loan arrangement	Institutional desk		Lead Arranger fee on Tranche-Pool / SyndicatedLoan cross-tier facilities
Reserve transparency API	Data API subscription		Phase 3: GraphQL API over The Graph subgraph; queried by external auditors and regulators

Explicit product analogues (Earn and SAFU). **Binance Earn** [100] → SavingsVault / FixedDeposit (Section 3.11): on-chain deposits; yield from lending spread, not trading fees. **SAFU** [100] → InsuranceFund: 5% interest capture, Chainlink PoR, drawn in the default cascade (Section 3.14). Structural analogy only—CWB does not custody user keys.

Hard rule: no native CWB governance token in the prototype. No CWB token in the thesis build (FTT/FTX reflexive-collateral lesson [100]). Reputation uses the non-transferable Credit Passport SBT (Section 3.12). A future token is Phase 3 / Future Work only, with a contract rule: no self-issued asset as collateral in the same protocol—enforced as a Foundry invariant, not policy.

5.8.4 Transaction Economics: Interest Rates

Table 5.24: Interest rate parameters

Parameter	Value	Benchmark
Base Annual Interest Rate	5–12% APR	Aligned with Aave/Compound variable rates
Rate Determination	Set by Local Bank approvers within World Bank-defined bounds	Configurable per-bank for local market conditions
Late Payment Penalty	2% of installment + 0.5%/week (capped at 10%)	Industry-standard late fee structure
Interest Calculation	Simple interest on outstanding principal	Transparent, client-friendly
Rate Transparency	All parameters stored on-chain	Publicly auditable; no hidden fees

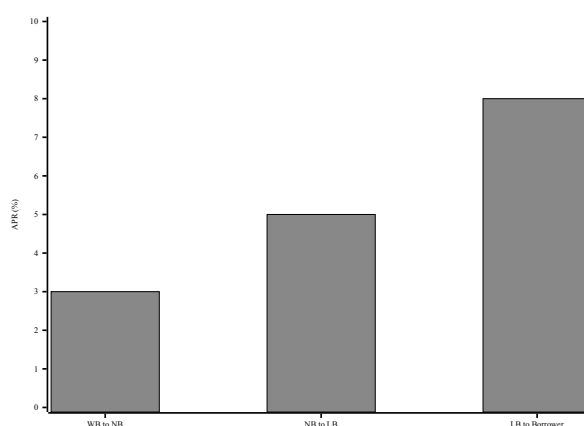


Figure 5.2: Hierarchical interest-rate spread (APR)

5.8.5 Global Economic Impact

Apart from revenue generated through platforms, various economic advantages are provided by the Crypto World Bank:

- Capital deployment:** Full-deployment planning assumes an outstanding loan book of $\approx$ \$1.7–2.0 billion (revenue tables above; base case \$1.72B at \$2,500/ETH), routed through bank tiers to retail and SME borrowers—not a single custodial exchange ledger. MSME financing shortfalls in emerging markets remain large [15]. Separate IFC research *associates* roughly 16 direct jobs per \$1 million of SME lending in developing countries over a two-year window [121]; that figure is illustrative and is not claimed as a CWB outcome or causal forecast.

- **Remittance cost reduction:** Global remittances total approximately \$860 billion annually, of which an estimated \$48 to \$56 billion is consumed by transfer fees averaging 6.49%—more than double the United Nations Sustainable Development Goal target of 3% [20]. On-chain settlement on Layer 2 networks reduces transaction costs to well below 1%, directly compressing this fee burden. Comparable blockchain payment networks demonstrate the feasibility of this target: Stellar processed approximately \$55.6 billion in payments at a fee of roughly \$0.0007 per transaction in 2025 [38], and Celo's MiniPay processes payments for under one cent across more than 60 countries [36].
- **Trapped capital liberation:** The correspondent banking system requires banks to maintain pre-funded nostro and vostro accounts in every currency corridor in which they operate, immobilizing large sums that cannot be deployed for lending or investment [18]. On-chain atomic settlement eliminates the need for these idle pre-funded balances, freeing capital for productive use across the lending hierarchy.
- **Financial inclusion:** The platform is designed for accessibility: sub-cent gas fees on Polygon PoS, a mobile-first interface, and support for micro-loan amounts below one dollar lower the barriers to credit for the estimated 1.4 billion adults globally who remain outside formal financial systems [9]. The World Economic Forum has identified decentralized finance as a leapfrog technology capable of enabling populations to bypass the infrastructure constraints of traditional banking [35], a pattern already observed in mobile payments across developing economies.
- **Transaction cost reduction:** On Polygon PoS, transaction fees remain below one cent—a reduction of over 99% relative to the average \$42 cost of a correspondent banking transaction [19]. This cost compression makes financially viable a large class of micro-transactions and small-loan servicing operations that are currently uneconomical through traditional payment rails.
- **Transparency as an economic good:** On-chain publication of reserve ratios, interest rates, and transaction records eliminates the informational asymmetry that enables predatory lending practices in opaque banking environments. In conventional banking, borrowers—particularly in developing economies—frequently operate without visibility into the true cost of credit or the basis for lending decisions. The Crypto World Bank's design ensures that all participants access identical, verifiable information, reducing the scope for hidden fees and unfair pricing.

5.8.6 Value Proposition and Go-to-Market

Table 5.26: Go-to-market phases

Phase	Activities	Timeline
Phase 1: Validation	Competition submission (BCOLBD 2025); thesis publication; open-source release	Current
Phase 2: Pilot	Regulatory sandbox application; institutional partnership; testnet-to-mainnet migration	6–12 months
Phase 3: Production	Multi-chain deployment; enhanced monitoring and analytics; governance token launch	12–24 months

5.9 Currency Risk and the Stablecoin Imperative

A hypothetical retail borrower who takes a loan denominated in ETH faces a fundamental risk that fiat-denominated traditional lending avoids: if ETH doubles between disbursement and final repayment, the borrower’s repayment obligation rises in local fiat terms by the same factor. For thin-margin borrowers, that is not a theoretical risk—it is potentially catastrophic. The May 2021 crypto market crash saw ETH lose approximately 55% of its value within six weeks; ETH then halved again over the course of 2022.

This is why stablecoin integration is treated as a **critical path item** elevated to a design requirement in Section 1.9, not an optional extension. The platform supports USDC or USDT-denominated loans as the default product at retail tiers, with ETH-denominated loans reserved for institutional-tier participants who can manage currency risk. BIS Working Paper No. 905 [61] identifies stablecoin volatility as a structural risk in emerging-market DeFi adoption and recommends fully-collateralized models (USDT/USDC) over algorithmic designs for developing-country use cases. The Terra/LUNA collapse (May 2022, ≈\$40 billion lost) provides the definitive negative example. ERC-20 stablecoin integration has technical implications: token allowances, transferFrom hooks, decimal precision (USDC uses 6 decimals vs. ETH’s 18), and the approval-transfer-state-update ordering required by the CEI pattern must all be redesigned as a separate contract module—work that is in scope for the SavingsVault contract specified in Section 3.11.

5.10 MiCA and GENIUS Act Compliance Mapping

The platform’s regulatory feasibility is not abstract: two recent statutes apply directly to any retail stablecoin-denominated lending product issued to European or US-jurisdiction users. The EU Markets in Crypto-Assets (MiCA) Regulation has been fully in effect since December 2024 [75, 76]; the US GENIUS Act, signed in July 2025 [77], establishes the first federal framework for payment stablecoins. Table ?? maps the relevant articles to the design choices that satisfy them and to the work that remains.

Statute / Article	Requirement	CWB Design Control
MiCA Art. 16 (EMT Issuer Authorisation)	Authorized issuer required for any e-money token offered to the public	USDC / USDT are issued by Circle / Tether under their own authorization; CWB uses but does not issue EMTs.
MiCA Art. 36 (Reserve of Assets)	1:1 reserve backing, segregated from issuer assets	Stablecoin reserves verified via on-chain attestations from Circle (USDC) before being accepted by SavingsVault.
MiCA Art. 41 (Redemption Rights)	Holders must have a right of redemption against the issuer at par	CWB does not impede redemption; SavingsVault withdraw function returns the underlying ERC-20 directly to the depositor wallet.
MiCA Art. 62 (Operational Resilience)	Regular audits, governance, complaint handling	Five-layer defense-in-depth (Section 3.19); Foundry invariants (Section 4.8); Certora reserve invariants (Section 4.7); Tenderly runtime monitoring (Section 4.10).
GENIUS Act § 4 (Federal Payment Stablecoin Framework)	Federal registration of payment-stablecoin issuers	Same posture as MiCA Art. 16: CWB uses, does not issue.
GENIUS Act § 7 (Reserve Disclosure)	Monthly attestation and public disclosure of reserves	Circle / Tether attestations are independently verifiable on-chain; CWB dashboard surfaces issuer attestation links per stablecoin pool.
EU AI Act Annex III (high-risk: credit scoring)	AI systems evaluating natural-person creditworthiness classified high-risk from August 2026 [98]	RF/IF pipeline is in scope; conformity assessment, risk-management system, and technical documentation required before EU-resident deployment.
EU AI Act Art. 86	Right to explanation for AI-assisted decisions	Borrower-facing SHAP + anomaly summaries (Section 4.3.2); Authority Brief for approvers; audit log for compliance. SHAP satisfies post-hoc explanation partially; substantive “meaningful explanation” threshold may require additional artifacts [98].
EU AI Act Arts. 11, 12, 14	Technical documentation, automated logging, human oversight	AI_ML_SECURITY_LOG (Art. 12 partial); human approver gate (Art. 14); full Art. 11 technical file and risk-management system not yet complete.
GDPR Art. 17 (Right to Erasure)	Personal data must be deletable on request	No PII on-chain; off-chain PostgreSQL data is encrypted and subject to data-subject deletion requests; only document hashes (SHA-256) appear on-chain.

The result is a compliance posture that is defensible to European and American institutional readers and evaluators in a single page rather than buried in narrative. Compliance gaps that remain—a formal MiCA whitepaper if CWB ever issues its own token, FinCEN reporting integration in the US, and full EU AI Act conformity assessment—are explicitly named in Section 5.14 and the Future Work section of the Conclusion.

5.11 Jurisdiction and Regulatory Considerations

The platform is designed as a global institutional L2 architecture; jurisdiction-specific deployment is future work. One illustrative regulatory context—Bangladesh, cited in the microfinance literature—is summarized here to show how a hierarchical on-chain bank would face real-world constraints. Three observations frame the path forward.

Crypto remains effectively illegal for retail use in several jurisdictions as of 2025–2026. In Bangladesh, Bangladesh Bank’s longstanding 2018 circular treats crypto trading as a Foreign Exchange Regulation Act offence, and no subsequent statute has formally legalized retail crypto activity. The Crypto World Bank prototype is therefore planned exclusively on public testnets (Polygon zkEVM Cardona, Ethereum Sepolia) using test tokens; no mainnet value transacts at pre-thesis stage.

The CBDC trajectory is a credible legal path in many jurisdictions. Several central banks have launched CBDC feasibility studies and pilots. The Crypto World Bank’s positioning against mBridge and Agora (Section ??) provides a direct upgrade path: when a jurisdiction issues a CBDC under the hierarchical distribution model that the Tan (2023) IMF working paper [5] describes, the platform’s Tier 1 / Tier 2 contracts can settle in that CBDC without changing the four-tier architecture. ETH / USDC denomination in testnet is a stand-in for future CBDC or tokenized-deposit assets.

Regulatory sandboxes as entry points. Jurisdictions such as Singapore (MAS Project Guardian), UAE (DIFC Innovation Testing Licence), and Bangladesh (Regulatory FinTech Facilitation Office) offer sandbox frameworks for controlled pilots. The platform’s go-to-market path is: (a) academic testnet deployment for pre-thesis, (b) controlled sandbox engagement for final-thesis evaluation, (c) partner-institution pilot under sandbox cover, and (d) phased CBDC integration where applicable.

Microfinance inclusion data (literature precedent). Bangladesh Bank Special Publication SP2025-02 (June 2025) [80] reports female-to-male account parity at 49%/49% by March 2025. BRAC’s 2025 data shows 89% of loans to women [81]. These statistics inform the solidarity-group module design as literature precedent (BRAC/Grameen group lending); they do not define a deployment target market for this thesis.

FATF Travel Rule scoping. The Financial Action Task Force Recommendation 16 (the “Travel Rule”) requires that transfers above USD 1,000 include structured originator and beneficiary information transmitted alongside the transfer. In most FATF member jurisdictions this threshold is now in force for virtual asset service providers; Bangladesh, as a FATF Asia-Pacific Group member, is under the same obligation. For the Crypto World Bank, the Travel Rule applies specifically to inter-tier capital flows: Local Bank to National Bank repayments and upward surplus repatriation via the UpwardDepositFacility contract

routinely exceed the USD 1,000 threshold. The off-chain Travel Rule data packet required for each such transfer is specified in Section 3.14:

```
{
  "originator_institution": "LocalBank-042",
  "originator_tier": 3,
  "beneficiary_institution": "NationalBank-001",
  "beneficiary_tier": 2,
  "amount_usdc": 5000,
  "purpose": "IBLP_REPAYMENT",
  "onchain_tx_hash": "0xABC...",
  "timestamp": "2026-06-01T10:00:00Z"
}
```

This packet is stored in the PostgreSQL `audit_logs` table and is linked to the on-chain transaction hash, making it available to regulators through the formal audit request workflow described in Section 3.18.2. The `audit_logs` table is append-only (enforced at the database-role level), ensuring the Travel Rule record cannot be altered after filing. Implementation of the cross-tier Travel Rule notification protocol—including automated packet generation, digital signing by the originating institution, and transmission to the relevant FIU—is Future Work contingent on jurisdiction-specific guidance.

5.12 Bootstrap Funding and the Tier 1 Capitalization Problem

The Crypto World Bank faces a **bootstrap funding problem** analogous to the capitalization challenge of real multilateral development banks. The World Bank Group was initially capitalised by 44 member-state subscriptions in 1944; the IBRD’s combined subscribed capital exceeded \$270 billion following its 2018 capital increase (Ocampo & Gallagher, 2024 [62]). Three initial capitalization mechanisms are proposed for the Tier 1 Reserve:

1. **Founding stakeholder deposits:** Universities, NGOs, and development-focused blockchain organizations deposit ETH or USDC into the Tier 1 Reserve in exchange for governance tokens and yield rights.
2. **Protocol-owned liquidity (POL):** The protocol accumulates treasury reserves through bond mechanisms in which external parties swap ETH or USDC for discounted governance tokens over a vesting schedule. *Note: The Olympus DAO algorithmic reserve model (2021–2022) is cited here as a cautionary precedent—Olympus OHM lost over 99% of its token value within one year due to unsustainable algorithmic backing. The CWB POL mechanism is strictly collateralized: only fully-backed USDC bonds are accepted, and governance tokens carry no intrinsic algorithmic price-support obligation. This removes the reflexive collapse risk that destroyed Olympus DAO.*
3. **Philanthropic/impact grant funding:** Development finance institutions (IFC, ADB) have expressed interest in blockchain-based development finance tools, as evidenced by the World Bank FundsChain initiative [33]. Grant funding from these institutions could seed the Tier 1 Reserve in exchange for research access and co-branding.

In the short term, a multi-signature wallet (3-of-5 signers representing different stakeholder groups) governs Tier 1 allocations. In the long term, an on-chain governance module (similar to Compound Governor Bravo) enables token-weighted voting with time-locks to pre-

vent governance attacks.

5.13 Prototype Scope and Limitations

At pre-thesis stage, the complete system is **specified** but not deployed. Planned implementation scope:

1. **Hierarchical lending scope:** Tier 1 World Bank Reserve, Tier 2 National Bank, and Tier 3 Local Bank contracts are specified in Solidity. Full cross-tier fund transfers and loan lifecycle automation are planned for Phases I–II of the final thesis phase.
2. **Interest accrual and repayment:** Interest rate tiers (3%/5%/8%) and fee rules are specified. Automated installment scheduling, accrual, and penalty enforcement are planned for Phase II (MVT item 2).
3. **InterBankLendingPool, UpwardDepositFacility, and broader multi-entity / cross-tier operations:** Fully specified in Section 3.14. Per the MVT boundary (Table ??), syndicated/tranched/netting modules are Future Work; IBLP and upward flow are Phase II–III stretch goals beyond the core loan lifecycle.
4. **AI/ML integration:** Random Forest, Isolation Forest, SHAP, and the Authority Brief pipeline are *specified* in Sections 4.3.1 and 4.3.2. All training, FastAPI scoring, and on-chain oracle wiring begin after pre-thesis 2 (Phases II–III; MVT items 4–7); pre-thesis 1 claims no trained models or live loan-approval ML integration.
5. **Backend architecture:** Express.js REST API with PostgreSQL (authoritative schema, 20 entities) and FastAPI for ML inference. MongoDB is not part of the planned production architecture.
6. **Banking product suite:** The extended banking product suite described in Section 3.17, including savings accounts, fixed-term deposits, transactional accounts, group lending, FX conversion, and the insurance fund, is specified at the architectural and design level in this report. Smart contract implementation and testing of these modules is planned for the final thesis phase.

The limitations above are consistent with a planning-phase pre-thesis; the complete system design is fully specified in this report and will be implemented and validated in the final thesis phase.

5.14 Research Trajectory and Examiner Limitations

A structured literature scan (June 2026) identified five risks examiners are likely to probe. This section records them explicitly so the thesis does not over-claim.

G1 — Compound novelty vs. partial counterexamples. Maple Finance, Goldfinch, Morpho V2, and Aave Arc provide partial institutional-credit precedents on individual axes [117,118,R21]. The defensible claim is the *compound* architecture (four-tier reserve enforcement + explainable oracle ML + programmable mutual liability), not “no prior four-tier DeFi.”

G2 — BCCC domain transfer. Models trained on BCCC flat-pool transactions may not generalize to hierarchical CWB flows (Section 4.3.1). Mitigation: acknowledge the gap, benchmark on BCCC as baseline only, collect CWB testnet labels for retraining, and run feature-distribution comparison as Future Work.

G3 – Testnet scope as academic evidence. Working testnet deployment + benchmark tables + documented specifications suffice for workshop venues (AFT, FMBC, IEEE Blockchain workshops). Full research papers additionally require controlled experiments, baselines, threat models, and reproducible public repos. This pre-thesis delivers specification and workload planning; MVT deployment provides the empirical layer.

G4 – Group lending external validity. On-chain mutual liability is cryptographic cosigning, not social solidarity [91, 92]. Repayment-rate claims must not cite BRAC/Grameen historical data as direct validation of smart-contract behaviour.

G5 – Oracle trust and economic viability. Score-at-origination-only mitigates latency/cost; oracle collusion and model staleness remain open (Section 4.3.1). Certora proofs should explicitly list what is proved (reserve-ratio invariant), what is assumed (oracle liveness), and what is out of scope [99].

Publication trajectory. Primary venue targets aligned with CWB contributions: **AFT 2026** (DeFi systems; abstract deadline May 2026), **FMBC** (formal verification of reserve invariants), **IEEE Blockchain / ICBC** (hierarchical architecture), and **IEEE TIFS** (federated fraud + explainability). PhD-scale seeds: hierarchical GraphSAGE ablation, cross-tier FL with differential privacy, and zkAML + FATF Travel Rule integration (Section 6.1).

5.15 Accessibility Assessment: Hypothetical Retail Client

This section evaluates access across six dimensions for a hypothetical retail client seeking a \$500 USDC working-capital loan through a Local Bank interface. The assessment is illustrative; no geographic deployment target is claimed at pre-thesis stage (Section 5.11).

1. Device access. The platform’s mobile-first React interface and WalletConnect integration allow access via any Android or iOS device with a browser, without requiring a desktop or dedicated hardware wallet.

2. Connectivity. Layer-2 transactions are lightweight (under 10 KB) and complete within seconds, well within typical mobile-network latency budgets.

3. Transaction cost. On Polygon zkEVM Cardona, the complete loan lifecycle (request, approval, 6 monthly installments) is projected to cost under \$0.05 in gas, a small fraction of typical origination fees in traditional banking.

4. Language and literacy. The planned prototype is English-only at launch. Additional locale packs are a planned extension; the React component library supports right-to-left and Unicode rendering.

5. Identity and onboarding. The planned ZKP KYC extension (Section 3.7.1) allows government-ID credential verification without exposing personal data on-chain. ERC-4337 account abstraction hides wallet complexity from retail users.

6. Group lending fit. The solidarity group lending model (GroupLendingPool, planned) follows microfinance literature precedent (BRAC/Grameen). Programmable mutual liability replaces community social pressure with smart contract enforcement.

In aggregate, the Crypto World Bank is accessible in principle to a hypothetical retail client on a mobile device (connectivity, cost, ERC-4337 onboarding) with two gaps requiring resolution for a production deployment: locale packs beyond English at launch and stablecoin-first denomination to reduce fiat currency risk for cross-border users.

Chapter 6

Conclusion

The Crypto World Bank addresses a **multi-party coordination and trust** problem at the heart of hierarchical development finance. Existing DeFi lending protocols collectively manage over \$55 billion in TVL [8], yet they rely on flat, single-tier pool designs that cannot model how capital actually moves between multilateral institutions, national banks, local lenders, and clients. This work proposes a four-tier institutional hierarchy with cross-tier, same-tier, and upward lending flows, governed by transparent rules for network membership, business operations, and technology infrastructure.

The platform is grounded in the six core functions of a bank—deposit mobilization, credit allocation, payment and settlement, risk intermediation, liquidity management, and ancillary services—but encodes them as publicly verifiable on-chain rules rather than discretionary enforcement by a trusted central authority. Reserve ratios, interest adjustments, group consent, and the full loan book are enforced and auditable in real time. A further distinctive capability is **multi-entity co-lending and co-funding**: at the retail level, solidarity groups can pool collateral and borrow together under mutual liability, drawing on the structural logic of Grameen Bank and BRAC; at the institutional level, multiple banks can co-fund a single loan or share risk across senior and junior tranches—mechanisms that no existing DeFi protocol combines in one open architecture.

This thesis contributes four scoped advances—hierarchical lending architecture, programmable group lending, explainable AI-assisted credit governance, and privacy-preserving compliance identity—as detailed in Section 1.6:

- A four-tier DeFi architecture that mirrors multilateral development-finance capital flows, with reserve enforcement at every tier (Section 5.14)
- Programmable joint-liability group lending with over-indebtedness controls (Section 3.17.3)
- Oracle-mediated fraud and credit scoring with explainable outputs for approvers and clients (Sections 4.3.2, 4.3.1)
- A privacy-preserving identity and compliance pathway combining zero-knowledge proofs with decentralized identifiers (Section 3.7.1)

These contributions are positioned against the institutional-DeFi landscape in Section ?? and against the MiCA / GENIUS Act / EU AI Act frontier in Section 5.10.

Analysis of 20+ competing projects in DeFi lending, institutional credit, banking infrastructure, and financial inclusion confirms that no current system combines multi-level lending, interbank mechanisms, and graded borrower access in one decentralized architecture. Institutional adoption—from the World Bank FundsChain initiative [33] to JPMorgan Kinexys [34] and R3 Corda’s \$17 billion in tokenized assets [31]—shows that blockchain-based financial infrastructure is both technically feasible and institutionally demanded. The Crypto World Bank extends this trajectory from settlement and fund tracking into an open,

hierarchically governed lending system at the intersection of institutional finance, decentralized lending, and financial inclusion—a combination still largely unaddressed in both academic literature and commercial practice.

At the pre-thesis stage, this report delivers a fully specified architecture, market and partnership framing, and phased implementation roadmap. The hierarchical lending workflow, tiered governance, capital-flow design, and planned explainable analytics layer are specified in depth; deposit products, group lending, multi-entity cross-tier operations, retail payment rails, formal verification, and runtime monitoring remain at the design level for final-thesis implementation per the Minimum Viable Thesis checklist (Section 4.1).

6.1 Future Work

The remaining work falls into three directions: completing the final-thesis deliverable, extending into everyday banking, and pursuing longer-term research.

Final thesis priorities.

- **Complete hierarchical lending.** End-to-end cross-tier fund transfers, interest accrual, installment scheduling, and cascading repayment across all four tiers (Appendix B).
- **Stablecoin-first deployment.** USDC at retail tiers with MiCA / GENIUS Act mapping validated against deployed configuration (Sections 1.9, 5.10).
- **Deposit and credit products.** Savings, fixed deposits, group lending with over-indebtedness controls, and liquidation handling (Sections 3.11, 3.17.3, 3.10).
- **Explainable analytics integration.** Connect fraud and credit scoring into live loan approvals via the oracle pipeline (Sections 4.3.2, 4.3.1).
- **Simulation, verification, and monitoring.** Testnet simulation, reserve invariant proofs, and live transparency dashboards (Sections 4.9, 4.7, 4.10).

Retail and everyday banking (post-MVT). Before the platform can support everyday spending with stablecoins—not only lending and installment servicing—it must close gaps in remittance, merchant acceptance, and cash-like deposit/withdrawal identified in Section 1.9 and grounded in the literature synthesis of Section 2.2:

- **Client-to-client remittance.** KYC-gated, compliance-checked transfers between registered clients under Local Bank sponsorship (Section 3.8.2).
- **Fiat on/off-ramp integration.** Licensed payment-service APIs so clients can fund balances and withdraw to local currency—the binding constraint identified by Du et al. [110] and CPPI [114].
- **Merchant checkout.** Invoice-based payment requests and settlement for registered merchants, evaluated against the CLEAR framework of Li et al. [109].
- **Consumer protection.** Deposit insurance, dispute resolution, and retail FX conversion before off-ramp or cross-border remittance (Section 3.17).

No prior work composes these retail rails with hierarchical development-finance lending in one architecture (Section 2.2).

Longer-term research.

- **Graph-based fraud detection.** Hierarchical lending graph ablation on BCCC [83] (Section 4.5).
- **Federated learning across banks.** Privacy-preserving fraud detection benchmarked against FedFraud [97] (Section 4.6).
- **Privacy-preserving compliance.** Zero-knowledge AML and KYC circuits with FATF Travel Rule support (Section 3.14).
- **Formal verification and domain adaptation.** Multi-tier reserve proofs [99] and ML model transfer from flat-pool to hierarchical transaction data [96].
- **Regulatory and retail evaluation.** EU AI Act conformity for credit scoring [98] and CLEAR-framework assessment of retail payment modules [109].

Appendix A

Database Schema Reference

This appendix records the physical-schema details moved from Chapter 3 to keep the main architecture chapter focused on conceptual design.

A.1 Indexing Strategy

B-tree indexes (the PostgreSQL default) support efficient retrieval on frequently queried columns:

Table A.1: Indexing strategy

Index	Table / Column(s)	Rationale
idx_loan_borrower	LOAN_REQUEST(borrower_id)	High-frequency lookup for borrower loan history.
idx_loan_status	LOAN_REQUEST(status)	Efficient filtering of active vs. closed loans.
idx_installment_d	INSTALLMENT(due_date, status) WHERE status = 'PENDING'	Partial-index range query for pending overdue installment detection.
idx_txn_created	TRANSACTION(created_at)	Time-window aggregation for 6-month and 1-year borrowing limits.
idx_txn_borrower	TRANSACTION(borrower_id)	Per-borrower transaction history retrieval.
idx_market_symbol	MARKET_DATA(symbol, recorded_at)	Composite index for price feed time-series queries.
idx_loan_bank_sta	LOAN(local_bank_id, status, created_at DESC)	Loan lifecycle queries by bank and status.
idx_loan_client_active	LOAN(client_id, status) WHERE status = 'ACTIVE'	Partial index for per-client open-loan count.
idx_agent_client_	AGENT_ACTION_LOG(client_id, created_at DESC)	Per-client agent action history retrieval.
idx_agent_status	AGENT_ACTION_LOG(status) WHERE status = 'PENDING'	Partial index for the agent status-monitoring loop.
idx_aiml_score	AI_ML_LOG(anomaly_score DESC) WHERE anomaly_score > 0.5	Partial index for AML alert queue (SAR workflow).
idx_session_parent	SESSIONS(parent_session_id) WHERE parent_session_id IS NOT NULL	Partial index for session lineage chain traversal.

A.2 Functional Dependencies

Table A.3: Representative functional dependencies

Relation	Functional Dependency	Notes
LOAN_REQUEST	request_id $\rightarrow$ all attributes	Application row keyed by request identifier.
LOAN_REQUEST	borrower_id, local_bank_id $\rightarrow$ status, amount, ...	One active request per client per bank.
LOAN	loan_id $\rightarrow$ all attributes	Disbursement record keyed by loan identifier.
LOAN	loan_request_id $\rightarrow$ loan_id	1:1 link from approved request to disbursed loan.
BORROWING_LIM	borrower_id $\rightarrow$ six_month_limit, one_year_limit, ...	1:1 with BORROWER; authoritative enforcement is on-chain.
BORROWER	wallet_address $\rightarrow$ borrower_id, all attributes	Unique candidate key in the prototype; production schema decouples identity from wallet.
INSTALLMENT	loan_id, installment_number $\rightarrow$ amount, due_date, status	Composite primary key.
SESSIONS	session_id $\rightarrow$ client_id, wallet_address, session_key_hash, session_key_scope, session_key_expires_at, expires_at, revoked	Session key scope encodes approved MCP tool list + value cap.
AGENT_ACTION	action_id $\rightarrow$ session_id, client_id, tool_name, parameters, confirmation_turn_id, onchain_tx_hash, status, created_at	Links every write-tool execution to the user's consent message.
ASSETS	asset_id $\rightarrow$ symbol, name, asset_type, network, decimals, is_active; also symbol $\rightarrow$ asset_id	symbol is a unique candidate key.
INTEREST_RATE	tier_id $\rightarrow$ base_rate, kink_utilization, rate_above_kink, max_rate	Eliminates transitive dependency in bank-tier entities.

Appendix B

Optional Agent Harness Reference

This appendix records the optional conversational agent harness (Phase III–IV Could deliverables). It is not required to evaluate the core blockchain-banking contribution. Section 4.4 in Chapter 4 summarises the six-step pipeline, MCP tool schema, and Authority Brief example.

B.1 Per-User Context and Prompt Assembly

Per-user personalisation — shared model, per-user context. Every client receives a personalised experience without deploying a separate model per user. Personalisation lives entirely in the per-user context namespace injected into every system prompt by the Express.js context injection layer:

```
{
  "client_id": "0xABC...",
  "language": "en",
  "credit_tier": "Silver",
  "credit_score": 512,
  "active_loans": [{
    "loan_id": "L-4821", "amount": 100, "next_due": "2026-06-15", "installment": 1
  }],
  "savings_balance": 250.0,
  "pool_utilisation": 0.67,
  "kyc_tier": 1,
  "conversation_history": ["...last 10 turns..."]
}
```

Because the on-chain state is re-injected at every turn, the agent always operates on current account data and cannot hallucinate the client’s balance or loan status.

Three-tier system prompt assembly. The agent’s system prompt is assembled by a dedicated prompt constructor in the Express.js backend, organised into three explicit tiers rather than a single ad-hoc string [86]:

Stable tier. Agent persona, active toolset schema, compliance anchors (EU AI Act Art. 86, FATF R.16, zero-bypass rule). Prefix-cache target; unchanged within a session.

Context tier. Interest rate schedule (Table 3.5), KYC matrix, pool policy, active skill procedure from AGENT_SKILLS. Updates on governance votes only.

Volatile tier. Per-user on-chain context namespace, parent-session compression summary, last N conversation turns. Rebuilt every turn from `eth_call` state.

B.2 Session Lineage, Compression, and Toolset Scoping

Session lineage and cross-session memory. The SESSIONS table carries a parent_session_id self-referential FK. When a conversation reaches a token threshold, the compression path closes the session with end_reason = 'compression' and opens a child session seeded with the compression summary. The read tool get_session_history exposes ranked excerpts from the client's conversation ancestry.

Context compression strategy. When the assembled prompt approaches the 32K-token window, the backend retains head ($H=500$) and tail ($T=1,000$) verbatim, summarises the middle via a secondary Qwen3-8B call, stores SESSIONS.compression_summary, and opens a child session. Trigger: 28,000 tokens (87.5% of window).

Toolset	Tools visible
read_only	All 9 read tools (default when intent is uncertain).
loan_actions	read_only + loan, installment, and group write tools.
account_managemen	read_only + deposit, KYC, and reminder write tools.

B.3 Lifecycle Hooks and Optional Capabilities

Lifecycle hook middleware. Write-tool POST requests pass through a hook stack: (1) confirmation audit hook (Phase II) verifies a logged confirmation turn or returns HTTP 403; (2) session-key scope pre-check (Phase III); (3) AML pre-check against AI_ML_SECURITY_LOG (Phase IV).

Optional agent capabilities.

- **Proactive installment reminders** via get_installment_schedule and pay_installment.
- **Credit Passport coaching** via get_credit_score and Table 3.5.
- **Loan calculator** with live FX from get_market_data.
- **Group lending coordination** and **KYC tier upgrade guidance** via write/read tools.
- **Cross-session context retrieval** via get_session_history.

Appendix C

Technology Stack

C.1 In-product assistant: local large language model (LLM) integration (prototype)

Purpose. The in-product assistant is an **optional** conversational add-on (Section 4.4), not a static product guide and not required for deposits, loans, or approvals. It combines a locally hosted, privacy-preserving large language model (Qwen3-8B, Apache 2.0 licence) with a Model Context Protocol (MCP) tool server exposing 17 tools (9 read tools, including a session history search tool, and 8 write tools requiring human confirmation). The agent can both answer questions—via retrieval-augmented generation (RAG) from policy documents—and execute on-chain banking operations via write tools, subject to an explicit human confirmation gate before any state-modifying action is taken. Local hosting keeps conversation data on institutional infrastructure, supporting data-sovereignty requirements in regulated pilots. The agent is additive: a client who does not use it experiences no difference in available functionality, since every operation the agent can perform is equally available through the standard React dashboard.

Model and runtime (local development). The inference endpoint follows the **OpenAI Chat Completions** contract (`/v1/chat/completions`) with `stream: true`, proxied from the project backend to a local service such as `http://127.0.0.1:1234`. During early development, the assistant used a locally hosted **Gemma-4-E4B** checkpoint (Google mixture-of-experts model, ~26B total / 4B active parameters) via LM Studio in GGUF form (e.g., Q4_K_M quantization) for a laptop-friendly footprint. For the final thesis evaluation, the assistant is replaced by **Qwen3-8B** (Alibaba Cloud Qwen team, released April 28 2025, Apache 2.0 licence) [82], a dense 8.19B-parameter causal language model with a 32K-token native context window (extendable to 131K tokens via YaRN scaling) and support for 100+ languages and dialects. A distinguishing architectural feature of Qwen3-8B is its *switchable reasoning mode*: the model operates in **thinking mode** (chain-of-thought wrapped in `<think>` tokens, suited to multi-step compliance or policy questions) and **non-thinking mode** (direct, low-latency responses for general navigation queries), selectable per-turn with `/think` or `/no_think` in the system prompt. For Q&A and retrieval-augmented generation (RAG) queries, non-thinking mode is the default; thinking mode is activated only for the red-team regulatory-compliance prompts in the evaluation protocol of Section 4.13.1. For agent tool-calling, non-thinking mode is the default for read tools and confirmation summaries; thinking mode is activated for complex multi-step operations such as EMI calculation or group signature coordination. The per-user context namespace (see Section 4.3) is prepended to every system prompt as a structured JSON block, so the model has full account context before reading the user’s message. The API model identifier is environment-driven; the integration layer remains identical for both models.

End-to-end behavior. The user interface assembles a short transcript (user/assistant messages) and posts it to the backend streaming route. Before the user message reaches the model, the context assembly layer: (a) selects the active toolset based on intent classification, (b) applies prompt injection scanning to all user-sourced fields, and (c) assembles the three-tier system prompt (Stable + Context + Volatile), injecting the compression summary from the parent session into the Volatile tier if this is a continuation session. The active toolset name and any injection scan flag are recorded in AGENT_ACTION_LOG for every turn. The backend then opens a streaming request to the local model server, converts upstream token events into **server-sent events (SSE)** for the browser, and the UI incrementally appends text. The message renderer uses Markdown (including GitHub-flavored extensions), math (KaTeX) for $$$ \dots $$$ blocks, and line-break rules appropriate for chat transcripts.

For write-tool requests, the agent assembles the full parameter set from the user's request and the injected on-chain state, then presents a confirmation summary. Only after the user sends explicit affirmative consent does the agent call the corresponding MCP write tool via the Express.js banking API layer. The EIP-7702 session key (if active) signs the resulting on-chain transaction within its approved scope. Every executed write tool is logged to agent_action_log with the confirmation message ID as the audit reference.

Live on-chain context injection. The Express.js backend injects the client's full on-chain state as a structured JSON context block into every system prompt before forwarding the user's message to the model. The per-user context namespace is:

```
{
  "tier": "volatile",
  "client_id": "0xABC...",
  "language": "en",
  "credit_tier": "Silver",
  "credit_score": 512,
  "active_loans": [{
    "loan_id": "L-4821", "amount": 100, "next_due": "2026-06-15", "installment": 1
  }],
  "savings_balance": 250.0,
  "pool_utilisation": 0.67,
  "kyc_tier": 1,
  "session_id": "sess_20260602_xyz",
  "parent_session_id": "sess_20260515_abc",
  "compression_summary": "Client asked about Gold tier eligibility.
  Was told 2 more on-time repayments required. No action taken.",
  "conversation_history": ["...last 10 turns..."]
}
```

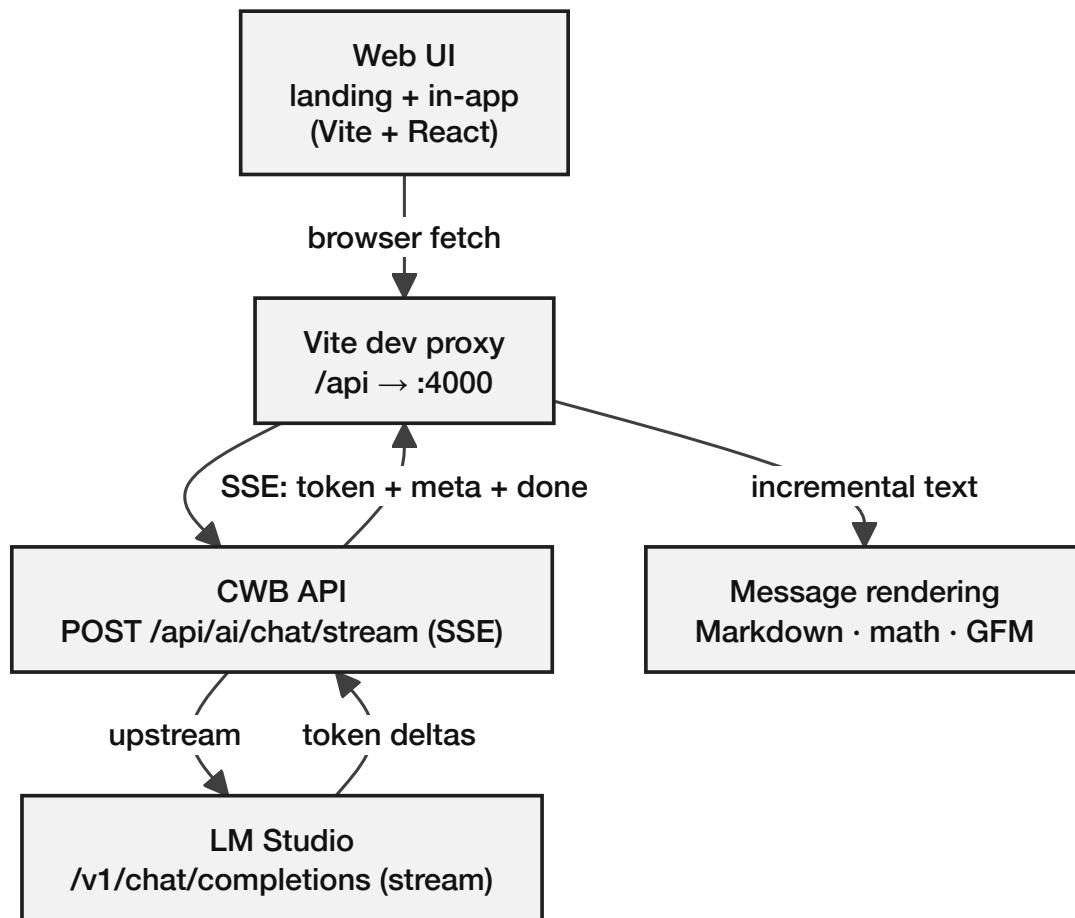
The compression_summary field is injected only when this is a child session (i.e., when parent_session_id is non-null). It provides the prior-session context without exceeding the Volatile tier token budget. This context block is injected only when the user is authenticated and the eth_call round-trip completes within a 200 ms timeout (falling back to a static-context response otherwise). The model uses the injected context to ground its answers in the user's actual account data rather than generic policy text, materially reducing

hallucination risk for account-specific queries.

Security and limitations (prototype stance). The agent’s safety posture is enforced at four levels. (1) **Tool-schema boundary:** the agent interacts with CWB exclusively through the 17 MCP tools — it cannot execute arbitrary code, make unapproved API calls, or read data outside the tool schema. (2) **Human confirmation gate:** every write tool requires explicit affirmative consent in the conversation history; the confirmation turn ID is logged as the audit reference. (3) **Session key scope:** the EIP-7702 session key is scoped to specific tools, value-capped, time-bound to 24 hours, and revocable at any time. A session that attempts to call an out-of-scope tool is rejected at the key level, not just at the application level. (4) **Prompt injection scanning and lifecycle hook middleware:** user-sourced content is scanned for injection patterns before entering the prompt (Layer 2 control, Section 4.3), and every write-tool HTTP POST is intercepted by a middleware stack that enforces the confirmation invariant at the application layer independently of the model’s output. Together, these four levels form a defence-in-depth posture in which no single point of failure can circumvent a critical safety constraint. Hallucination risk is bounded by: (a) the injected on-chain state grounding account-specific answers, and (b) the refusal layer for regulatory and legal queries (100% target on the red-team set, Section 4.13.1).

Architecture diagram. Figure C.1 shows the compact end-to-end request path; Figure C.2 expands the same flow with component boundaries and authentication context.

Local LLM Assistant — Compact Request Path

**Figure C.1:** Optional AI banking agent request path (add-on)

Local LLM Assistant — Component Data Flow

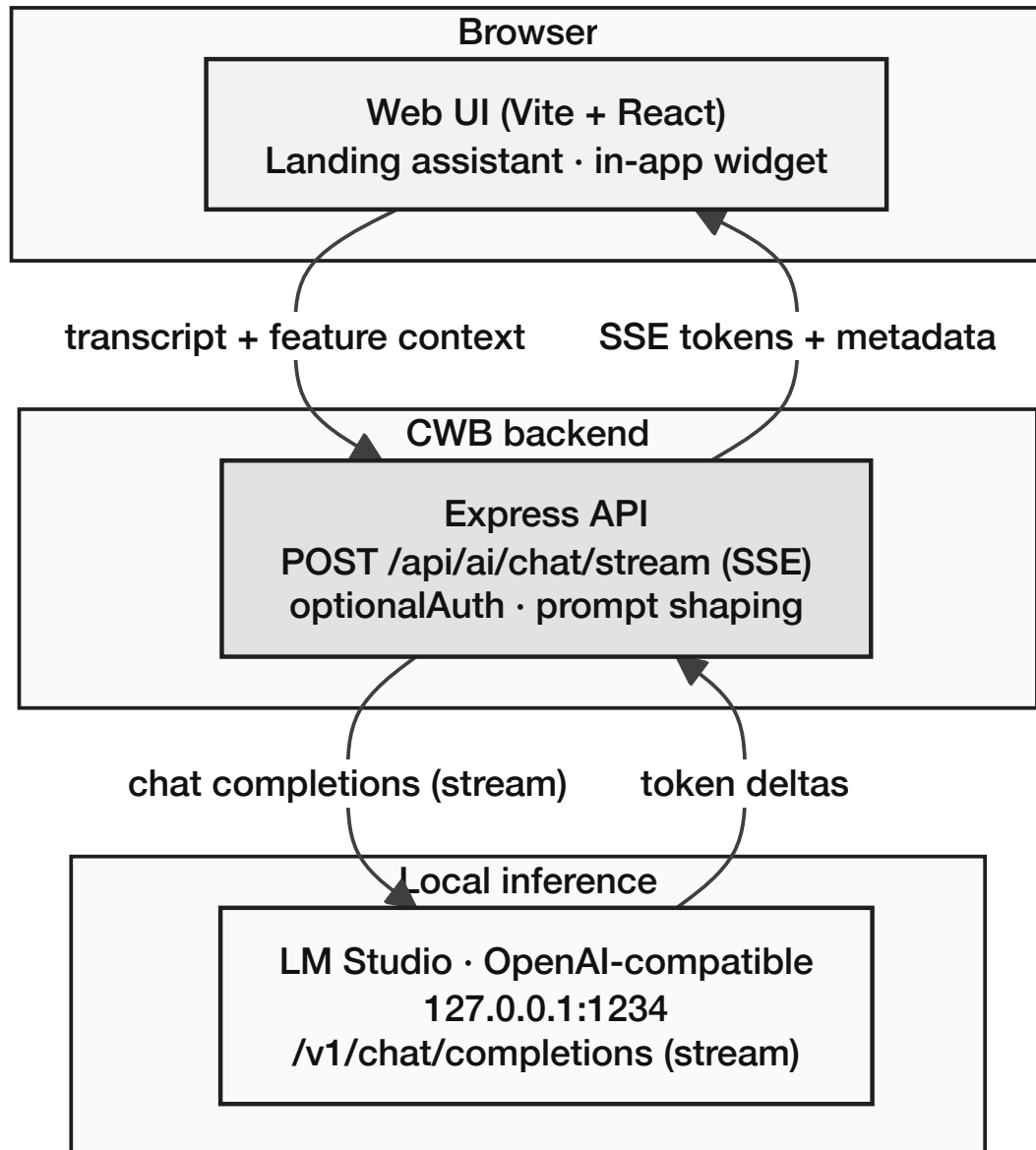


Figure C.2: Optional AI agent data flow

Implementation analysis (brief). The integration is successful for the project prototype because it reuses a stable transport shape (chat-completions with streaming) and isolates the model vendor behind a single API route, allowing the user interface to remain a thin client. The main practical engineering challenges in local development were: (1) **process/port hygiene** to keep the API bound to a predictable port, (2) **CORS and same-origin** considerations when the UI and API run on different localhost ports, mitigated with a Vite dev proxy to /api and with permissive dev CORS policy on the API, and (3) **RPC provider selection** for wallet reads in the browser, where some public endpoints may fail

browser CORS; pinning explicit public RPC endpoints avoids noisy failures unrelated to the chat feature.

Relationship to the earlier rule-based assistant (legacy). The repository also retains early keyword-routed `/api/chatbot` handlers used for initial prototyping; the LLM path is additive. This separation prevents regressions in deterministic demo endpoints while the conversational assistant evolves.

Table C.1: Technology stack summary

Layer	Technology	Version / Notes
Smart Contract	Solidity, OpenZeppelin	0.8.20; Ownable, ReentrancyGuard
Frontend	React, TypeScript	Material UI; Design 3
Wallet Integration	Wagmi, RainbowKit, Viem	EIP-1193 compliant
Build and Test	Hardhat	Automated test suite; deployment scripts
Backend API	Express.js, Node.js	REST API; middleware architecture
Database	PostgreSQL (designed)	20 entities, 3NF; relational integrity
Target Network	Polygon zkEVM Cardona testnet	ZK validity proof security (Amoy PoS = fallback)
AI Agent Engine	Qwen3-8B (llama.cpp, Q4_K_M)	MCP tool server; per-user context namespace; human confirmation gate
MCP Tool Server	17 banking tools (9 read, 8 write); prompt injection scanner; confirmation audit hook middleware	Exposes read + write banking operations to the agent with typed parameter schemas
Session Keys	EIP-7702	Scoped, time-bound, value-capped agent wallet authorisation
Oracle Network	Chainlink Functions (DON)	Trustless ML score commitment; replaces commit-reveal relay
Price Feeds	Chainlink AggregatorV3Interface	Fiat/USD pairs (e.g. EUR/USD) and ETH/USD; 8-decimal precision
Automation	Chainlink Automation	Trustless installment due-date checking; replaces centralised cron job
Proof of Reserve	Chainlink PoR	Cryptographically verifiable World-BankReserve balance
Event Indexing	The Graph (subgraph)	GraphQL query layer over LoanApplication and ReserveRatioSnapshot events

Appendix D

Smart Contract Capabilities

The complete banking architecture is designed around fifteen modular contracts. The three-contract lending core is specified at pre-thesis stage; the remaining twelve modules are planned across Phases II and III of the final thesis phase.

Specified core contracts (Phase I target):

- **World Bank Reserve Contract:** Reserve custody, deposit handling, national bank registration, capital allocation to national banks, system pause and unpause, emergency withdrawal, and system statistics.
- **National Bank Contract:** Local bank registration, borrowing from the World Bank reserve, capital allocation to local banks, and network status queries.
- **Local Bank Contract:** Client registration, loan application processing, approval and rejection workflows, installment generation and payment processing, approver management, user account management, and a `freezeAccount(clientId)` function gated by `onlyApprover` modifier, used by the SAR workflow (Section 3.18.2) to suspend loan and payment operations for a flagged client pending compliance review.

Planned contracts – Banking product suite (Phase II):

- **SavingsVault Contract:** Standard savings account management, variable yield accrual, withdrawal processing, and deposit-to-lending pool integration.
- **FixedDeposit Contract:** Term deposit creation, lock period enforcement, agreed APY accrual, early withdrawal penalty calculation, and maturity release.
- **GroupLendingPool Contract:** Group formation, multi-signature consent recording, shared collateral management, per-member disbursement, mutual liability enforcement, and group credit history recording.
- **FXModule Contract:** Oracle-priced currency conversion, spread calculation, dual-currency lending denomination support, and conversion audit trail.
- **InsuranceFund Contract:** Captures 5% of all interest collected across the lending hierarchy, processes default coverage disbursement claims, and publishes its reserve balance to Chainlink Proof of Reserve for external verifiability.
- **CurrentAccount Contract:** Transactional account management, atomic peer transfers, recurring payment scheduling, and payroll deposit handling.

Planned contracts – Multi-entity and cross-tier operations (Phases II and III):

- **InterBankLendingPool Contract** (Section 3.14): one instance per tier (IBLP_NB, IBLP_LB). Short-tenor (1 / 7 / 30 day) same-tier borrowing with a utilization-kinked rate model bounded by the tier-above downward rate; default cascade through reserve buffer → InsuranceFund → parent-tier backstop.
- **UpwardDepositFacility Contract** (Section 3.14): role-restricted extension of SavingsVault accounting that lets a lower-tier bank deposit excess reserves into its par-

ent tier, earning a strictly lower yield than the downward borrowing rate; withdrawal gate enforces depositor reserve-ratio safety.

- **SyndicatedLoan Contract** (Section 3.14): syndicate proposal, subscription window, supermajority on-chain consent vote (75%-by-capital-share), atomic disbursement, pro-rata interest and recovery distribution; supports cross-tier syndication (mixed NB / LB co-funders).
- **TranchedPool Contract** (Section 3.14): senior / junior tranching with a subordination-ratio policy, waterfall interest and principal payments, first-loss absorption by the junior tranche; suitable for risk-segmented institutional and impact-aligned capital.
- **TreasurySwap Contract** (Section 3.14): oracle-priced atomic asset swap restricted to wallets holding a banking role; cross-tier asset exchange (e.g., NB ETH treasury → USDC) with a tighter spread than retail FX; post-swap reserve-ratio invariant enforced before state change.
- **NettingEngine Contract** (Section 3.14): multilateral netting of accumulated inter-bank obligations; off-chain Settlement Coordinator computes the netted matrix, on-chain `settleBatch` executes the entire batch in one transaction, with a public challenge window for dispute resolution.

Appendix C: Planned Testnet Deployment Manifest

The following table is a **planned deployment manifest template** for Polygon zkEVM Cardona testnet (Phase IV). No contracts are claimed as live-deployed at pre-thesis submission. Addresses will be recorded in the project repository under `/deployments/cardona/` after Phase IV deployment and can be verified on the Cardona block explorer at <https://explorer-ui.cardona.zkevm-rpc.com>.

Table D.1: Planned Cardona testnet deployment manifest

Contract	Network	Address / manifest path
WorldBankReserve	Polygon zkEVM Cardona	deployments/cardona/WorldBankReserve.json
NationalBank (Scaffold)	Polygon zkEVM Cardona	deployments/cardona/NationalBank.json
LocalBank (Scaffold)	Polygon zkEVM Cardona	deployments/cardona/LocalBank.json
LendingController	Polygon zkEVM Cardona	deployments/cardona/LendingController.json

Note: Exact hex addresses will be populated after Phase IV testnet deployment. The repository manifest is the authoritative record. This appendix documents the intended contract inventory only; it does not assert live deployment at pre-thesis stage.

Appendix D: WorldBankReserve Contract Interface

The following Solidity interface documents the public API of the WorldBankReserve contract—the formally specified Tier 1 contract (Phase I deployment target). Three design annotations follow the listing:

```
1 // SPDX-License-Identifier: MIT
2 pragma solidity ^0.8.20;
3
4 import "@openzeppelin/contracts/security/ReentrancyGuard.sol";
5 import "@openzeppelin/contracts/access/AccessControl.sol";
6
7 /// @title WorldBankReserve
8 /// @notice Tier 1 reserve contract: manages global capital allocation
9 /// to registered National Bank addresses.
10 contract WorldBankReserve is ReentrancyGuard, AccessControl {
11
12     bytes32 public constant NATIONAL_BANK_ROLE = keccak256("NATIONAL_BANK_ROLE");
13     bytes32 public constant AUDITOR_ROLE = keccak256("AUDITOR_ROLE");
14
15     uint256 public totalReserve;
16     uint256 public minimumReserveRatio; // e.g. 1000 = 10.00%
17     mapping(address => uint256) public allocatedTo; // NationalBank => amount
18
19     event CapitalAllocated(address indexed nationalBank, uint256 amount);
20     event RepaymentReceived(address indexed nationalBank, uint256 amount);
21     event ReserveRatioUpdated(uint256 newRatio);
22
23     /// @notice Allocate capital downward to a registered National Bank (CEI
24     pattern)
25     function allocateCapital(address nationalBank, uint256 amount)
26         external onlyRole(DEFAULT_ADMIN_ROLE) nonReentrant;
27
28     /// @notice Record repayment from a National Bank (CEI pattern)
29     function recordRepayment(uint256 amount)
30         external onlyRole(NATIONAL_BANK_ROLE) nonReentrant;
31
32     /// @notice Query current utilization ratio (scaled 1e4)
33     function utilizationRate() external view returns (uint256);
34
35     /// @notice Returns true if reserve ratio constraint is satisfied
36     function isReserveAdequate() external view returns (bool);
37
38     /// @notice Returns a four-value reserve summary for Proof of Reserve
39     /// verification and the Reserve Transparency Dashboard.
40     /// @return totalDeposited Gross deposits ever made to this reserve tier
41     /// @return totalLoaned Outstanding principal lent to National Banks
42     /// @return reserveRatio (totalDeposited - totalLoaned) * 1e4 /
43     /// totalDeposited (e.g. 5000 = 50.00%)
44     /// @return insuranceFundBalance Current balance of the InsuranceFund contract
45     function getReserveSummary() external view returns (
46         uint256 totalDeposited,
47         uint256 totalLoaned,
48         uint256 reserveRatio,
49         uint256 insuranceFundBalance
50     );
51 }
```

Listing D.1: WorldBankReserve.sol – Tier 1 public interface. Full implementation in project repository.

Design annotation 1 — nonReentrant on state-changing functions. The

`nonReentrant` modifier from OpenZeppelin's `ReentrancyGuard` sets a boolean lock before execution and clears it after, preventing recursive calls. It is applied to `allocateCapital` and `recordRepayment` because both involve ETH transfers that could trigger attacker-controlled fallback functions. The full Checks-Effects-Interactions analysis is in Section 3.9.

Design annotation 2 — AccessControl mapping to RBAC design. OpenZeppelin's `AccessControl` maps each on-chain role (e.g., `NATIONAL_BANK_ROLE`) to a bytes32 keccak256 hash stored in a role-to-address mapping. Role assignment is controlled by the `DEFAULT_ADMIN_ROLE` (the World Bank admin). This directly implements the four-tier RBAC hierarchy described in Section 3.1: only addresses granted `NATIONAL_BANK_ROLE` can call `recordRepayment`, and only the World Bank admin can call `allocateCapital`.

Design annotation 3 — Events enable off-chain indexing for the analytics layer. `CapitalAllocated`, `RepaymentReceived`, and `ReserveRatioUpdated` are emitted at every significant state transition. The off-chain Express.js event listener subscribes to these events and writes them to PostgreSQL, enabling the AI/ML monitoring layer to construct loan lifecycle timelines, compute utilization windows, and feed the Random Forest fraud detector without requiring costly repeated SLOAD calls.

Appendix E: Internal Industry Research Notes

This appendix catalogues supplementary industry-research documents prepared for the Crypto World Bank project. They informed Chapter 3 (actor taxonomy), Chapter 5 (CEX comparison and revenue analogues), and the no-native-token design constraint. All files reside in the project repository under Documentation/2nd Phase (Bokhtiar)/Improvements/.

Table D.2: Internal industry research corpus

ID	Document	Thesis use
IR-1	Binance_FTX_Full_Report.md	CEX vs. CWB (Table 5.22); FTT/BNB token lesson; SAFU and Binance Earn analogues; PoR and commingling safeguards
IR-2	blockchain platforms research.csv	Five-exchange matrix (Binance, Bybit, Coinbase, OKX, Kraken) for Table 5.22
IR-3	Binance Business Analysis.md	Exchange revenue taxonomy for Table 5.23 (fees, listing, OTC)
IR-4	binance_software_engineering_architecture.md	Architecture and sequence-diagram conventions
IR-5	binance_architecture_research.m	Off-chain PostgreSQL/Redis patterns (background; not cited in body text)

These documents are project-internal research notes, not peer-reviewed publications. They are listed here for reproducibility and examiner traceability; formal citations in the body text use bibliography entries [100]–[102] for the three documents most directly referenced.

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